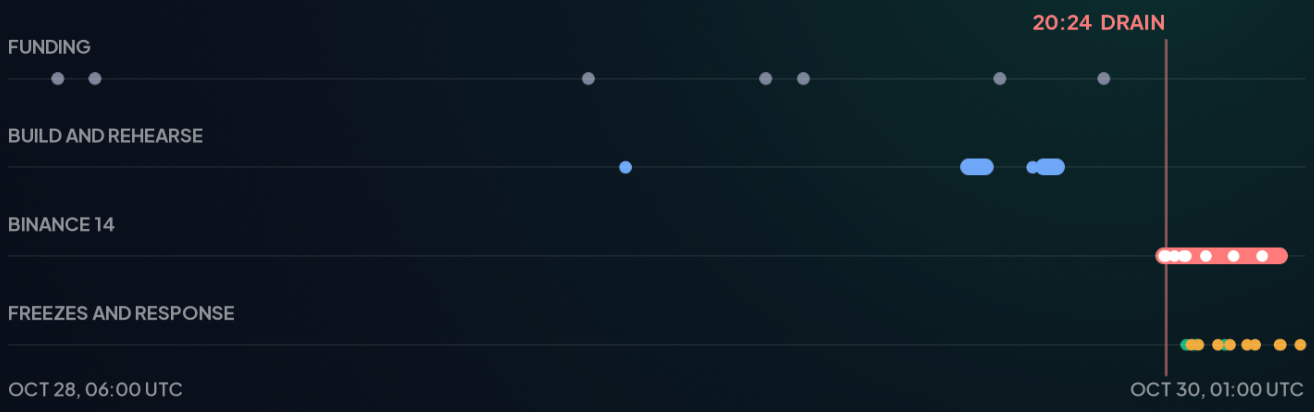
RECONSTRUCTION · OCTOBER 28 TO 30, 2026

# The Binance Hack

## Reconstructed, step by step

From the first Tornado Cash withdrawal to the revocation 40 hours later, rebuilt from the Ethereum record and 53,181 posts across X, TikTok, YouTube, Instagram, Reddit and news.




**6h 29m**
from the first rehearsal to the delegation

**1 of 50**
signed authorizations took effect

**3h 49m**
attacker code live on Binance 14

**8 min**
from the sweep to the first public post

SOURCES: SIX CHAINS READ LIVE, LUNARCRUSH SOCIAL DATA, WHALE ALERT, COINGECKO

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01 · SUMMARY

# A rehearsed attack, a four-hour open door, and a crowd that rebuilt it before Binance spoke

On the evening of October 29, a wallet funded only through Tornado Cash attached its own code to Binance 14, one of the exchange's main Ethereum hot wallets, and swept it in a single transaction. Every step had been rehearsed on mainnet that afternoon. The attacker's code then stayed on the wallet for 3 hours 49 minutes. Stablecoin issuers froze what they could inside the first hour. Binance said at 00:13 UTC that it would cover all losses, and at 00:52 that about $3 billion was frozen.

**18h**
From the sweeper's deployment to the drain

**1 of 50**
Authorizations signed by Binance 14's key took effect

**~$3B**
Verified frozen, per Binance at 00:52 UTC

### 01 It was rehearsed in public

The operator deployed its first sweeper at 02:28 UTC, then rehearsed twice on its own wallets: at 13:51, and at 16:20 the full sequence with the production contract. Delegate, sweep, leave 1 ETH, withdraw. All on mainnet, with the rehearsals starting 6 hours 29 minutes before the delegation.

### 02 Fifty authorizations, one signing key

At 20:20:59 a single transaction delivered 50 EIP-7702 authorizations, every one signed by Binance 14's own key. The one matching the wallet's live nonce applied. Three minutes later one sweep moved 167,464 ETH and 63 tokens for $0.93 in gas.

### 03 The door stayed open for 3h 49m

The attacker's code ran on Binance 14 until 00:10:35. In that window it pulled 823M USDC from a second wallet that trusted Binance 14, re-swept 200.4M USDT, and the wallet kept receiving transfers: 533 of them.

### 04 Issuers moved before the exchange

Tether's $971M freeze was on the feed at 21:05. Binance's first word came at 21:15, from CZ and the company in the same minute. Tether, Circle and World Liberty froze in sequence; Binance also thanked Ripple, though no freeze shows on the traced XRP account; it put the verified total at $2.54B at 23:22 and about $3B at 00:52.

### 05 Social rebuilt every step

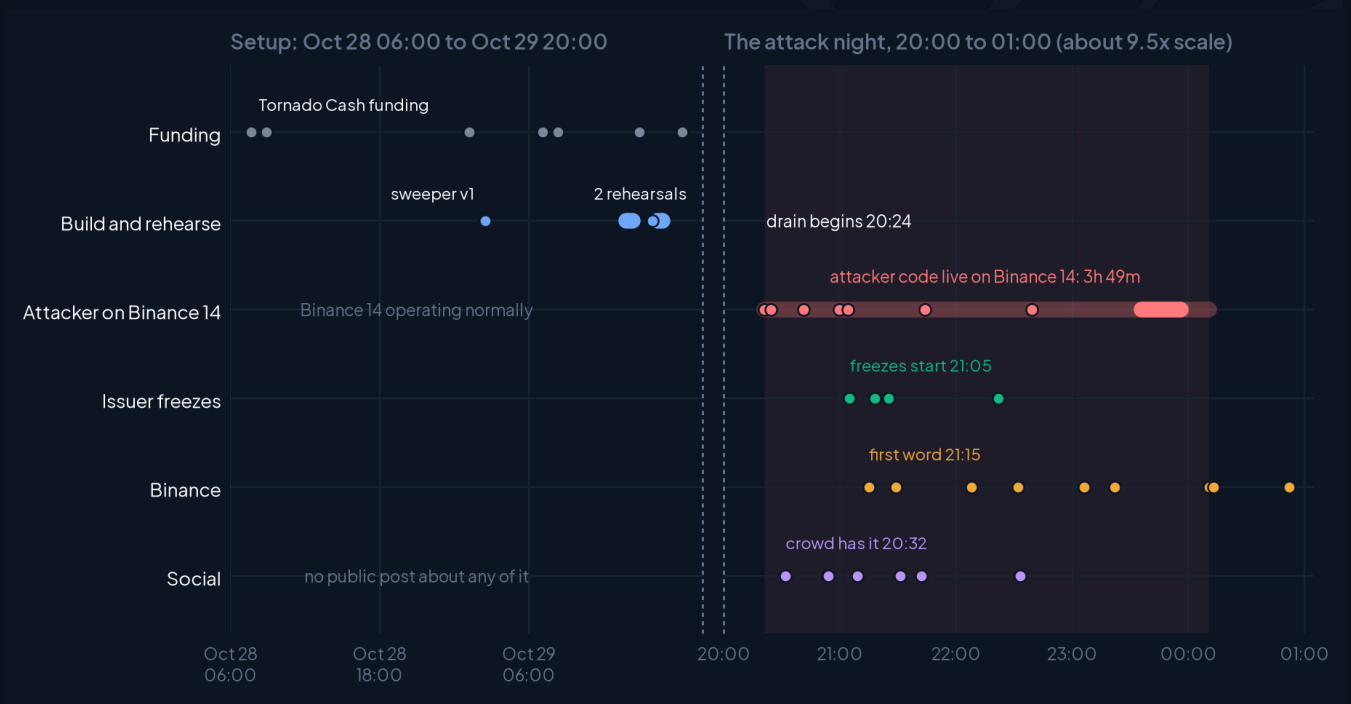
The sweep was described publicly 8 minutes after it landed, and the contract and the fifty authorizations within the hour. The rehearsals were found at 21:31. The setup itself, visible on-chain for 18 hours, drew no post until the money was gone.

02 · OVERVIEW

# The whole hack on one page

Six lanes, one clock. The left panel covers October 28 06:00 to October 29 20:00, when the setup ran; the right panel covers the five hours of the attack at about 9.5 times the scale.

OCTOBER 28 TO 30, ALL LANES




Every mark is a verified transaction or a timestamped public statement.

I
### The setup
Oct 28 07:39 to Oct 29 18:20
Mixer funding, two sweeper contracts, two rehearsals, the second a full run.

II
### The drain
20:05 to 21:00
Delegation, one sweep, 823M USDC through a trusted wallet.

III
### The open door
20:21 to 00:10
Re-sweeps, 533 incoming transfers, then revocation.

IV
### The response
21:05 to 00:52
Issuer freezes, Binance statements, withdrawals paused.

V
### The money
read live 03:20 UTC Oct 30
What is frozen, what is not, and where it sits.

VI
### The public record
20:32 onward
How posts reconstructed each step, and how fast.

LunarCrush

PART I

# The hack

Six acts, from the first mixer withdrawal to the revocation, each step verified on-chain and matched to the first public post that described it.

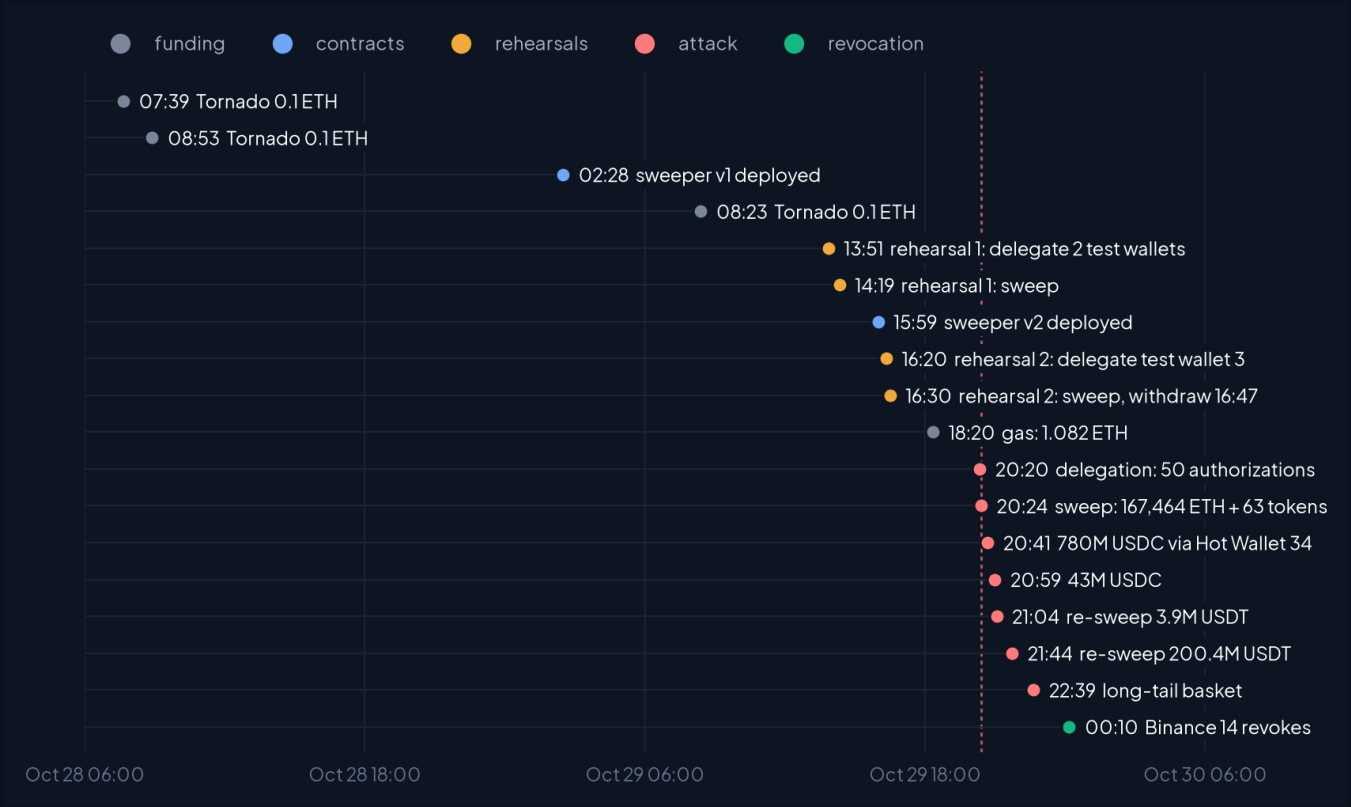
03 · ACT I

# The setup

## Eighteen hours from the first contract to the drain, all on a public chain, with no post about any of it

Everything the attack needed was built and tested in the open on October 28 and 29: funding, two contracts and two rehearsals, the second a full run.

EVERY OPERATOR TRANSACTION, OCT 28 TO 30




The operator `0x7C86` and the wallets that funded it. Dashed line: the sweep, 20:24:23 Oct 29.

**Oct 28 07:39**

### Funded through Tornado Cash

Two 0.1 ETH withdrawals from the Tornado Cash pool reach the operator `0x7C86…5CA0`, at 07:39 and 08:53; a third follows at 08:23 on Oct 29. Two sibling wallets, `0xFD41` and `0xe4F9`, are funded the same way. About 1.49 ETH in total: the operation's entire budget.

FIRST PUBLIC
@spreekaway, 20:32 Oct 29

**Oct 29 02:28**

### Sweeper v1 deployed

The operator deploys its first sweeper contract, `0x19be…f2bf`. It has never been verified on any explorer.

FIRST PUBLIC
@MetaFinancialAI, 21:31

**13:51** — **Rehearsal one**
Two fresh wallets controlled by the operator are delegated to the sweeper with EIP-7702 transactions, seeded with a few dollars of USDT and USDC, and swept at 14:19 and 14:24.
FIRST PUBLIC: @MetaFinancialAI, 21:31; @danupsher, 21:47

**15:59** — **Sweeper v2 deployed**
The production contract, `0x63e8…6fAe`. Only the operator can call it. Its sweep leaves exactly 1 ETH behind, and it has an execute passthrough and a withdraw function.
FIRST PUBLIC: @0xQuit, 21:09; @blockaid_, 21:25

**16:20** — **Rehearsal two, the full sequence**
A third test wallet is delegated, funded with 1.01 ETH, swept at 16:30 (0.01 ETH out, 1 ETH left) and emptied with a withdraw call at 16:47. The exact sequence used on Binance 14 three and a half hours later.
FIRST PUBLIC: @MetaFinancialAI, 21:31

**18:20** — **Funding for the real run**
`0xe4F9` sends the operator 1.082 ETH.
FIRST PUBLIC: no public post found

## REHEARSAL TWO AGAINST THE ATTACK

| STEP | REHEARSAL TWO, OCT 29 | BINANCE 14, OCT 29 |
|---|---|---|
| **Delegate** | 16:20:47, test wallet `0x43AE` | 20:20:59, Binance 14 (50 authorizations, one applied) |
| **Fund** | 16:24, 1.01 ETH from `0xe4F9` | Binance 14's own balances |
| **Sweep** | 16:30:11, 0.01 ETH out | 20:24:23, 167,464 ETH and 63 tokens |
| **Leave 1 ETH** | Yes | Yes, after every sweep |
| **Withdraw** | 16:47:23, 1.0 ETH back to `0xe4F9` | Not used; re-sweeps at 21:04, 21:44 and 22:39 |

04 · ACT II

# The drain

## One delegation, one sweep: 167,464 ETH and 63 tokens left Binance 14 for $0.93 in gas

The attack on Ethereum took 3 minutes 24 seconds from delegation to sweep. Within 40 minutes a second wallet had released 823M USDC to the same address.

**20:05**

### $331M of outflows on two other chains

185,017,485 XRP ($236M) leaves Binance-labeled accounts for a new XRP Ledger account at 20:05, and 965,455 SOL ($95M) moves to a new Solana address at 20:10. Whale Alert labels the senders as Binance; Binance has not said whether these were its own transfers.

FIRST PUBLIC
@hackenclub linked them, 20:51

**20:20:59**

### The delegation

One transaction from the operator to Binance 14 (`0x28C6…1d60`) carries 50 EIP-7702 authorizations. All 50 recover to Binance 14's own key. The one matching the wallet's live nonce, 18914809, applies; Binance 14's next transaction uses 18914810. The wallet now runs the attacker's code.

FIRST PUBLIC
@odysseas_eth, 20:54; @0xQuit, 21:21

**20:24:23**

### The sweep

One call moves 167,464 ETH and 63 tokens to `0x5227…2f8c`, later labeled Binance Hot Wallet Exploiter 2. The largest lines: 1.615B USDT, 62.6M RLUSD, 29,934 wBETH, 11,372 XAUt. Gas: 0.000414 ETH, about $0.93.

FIRST PUBLIC
@spreekaway, 20:32 (+8 min)

**20:41:23**

### 780M USDC through a trusted wallet

Using the execute passthrough, a call leaves Binance 14 to Hot Wallet 34 (`0xEe7a…`), a proxy that accepts Binance 14 as its owner. It releases 780M USDC to `0x5227`.

FIRST PUBLIC
@0xfoobar, 20:48; @kethcode, 22:08

**20:59:47**

### 43M USDC more

The same route releases another 43M USDC.

FIRST PUBLIC
no sampled post

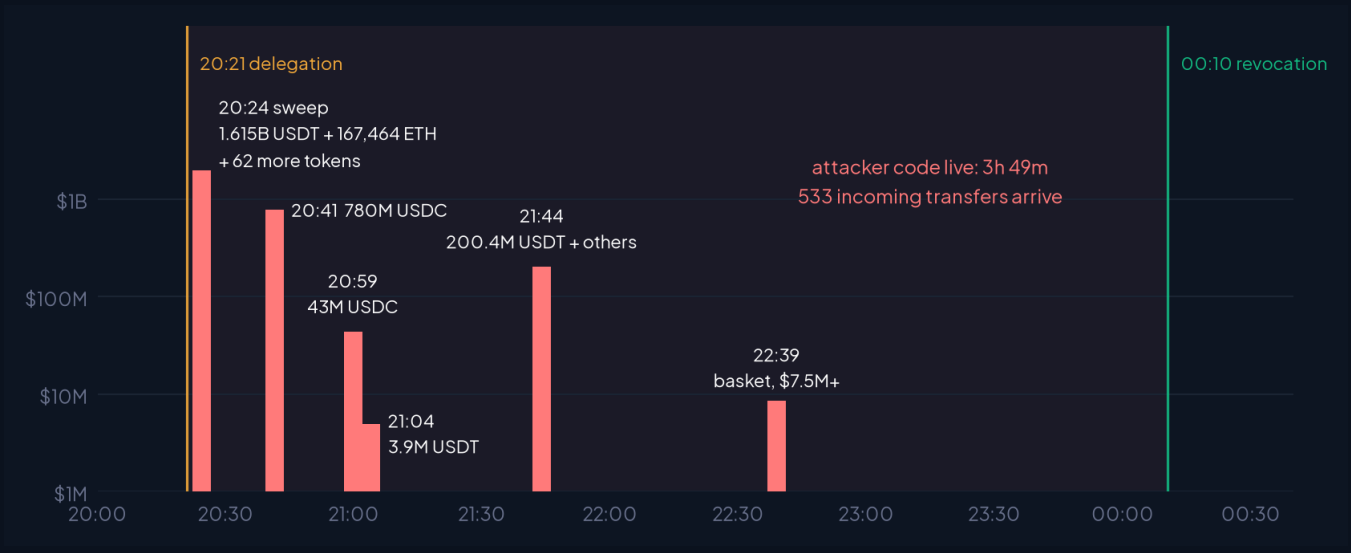
05 · ACT III

# The open door

## For 3 hours 49 minutes the wallet ran the attacker's code and kept receiving funds

Each sweep left exactly 1 ETH, enough for Binance 14 to keep paying for its own transactions. It kept transacting, kept looking normal, and kept taking in transfers.

WHAT LEFT BINANCE 14 WHILE IT RAN THE ATTACKER'S CODE




Value leaving Binance 14 and Hot Wallet 34, log scale. The sweep bar counts the USDT and ETH lines only; 62 smaller tokens moved with them.

**20:21 to 00:10**

### Transfers keep arriving

Blockscout records 533 incoming token transfers to Binance 14 while it is delegated, including 205.7M USDT, 180B PEPE and 859M SHIB. Its own transactions run from nonce 18914810 to 18914903: the key holder is still transacting throughout.

FIRST PUBLIC
@uttam_singhk, 22:00

**21:04**

### First re-sweep

3.9M USDT plus dust.

FIRST PUBLIC
@uttam_singhk on the mechanism, 22:00

**21:44**

### Second re-sweep

200.4M USDT, 6,591 LINK, 7,008 UNI and smaller lines.

FIRST PUBLIC
@uttam_singhk, 22:00

**22:39**

### The long tail

A basket of smaller tokens, worth at least $7.5M on the ten largest lines the explorer lists, goes to a second receiver, `0xA97b…`.

FIRST PUBLIC
no sampled post

**23:36**

## Six empty sweeps

Between 23:36 and 23:56 the operator calls sweep six more times. Nothing moves.

FIRST PUBLIC
no sampled post

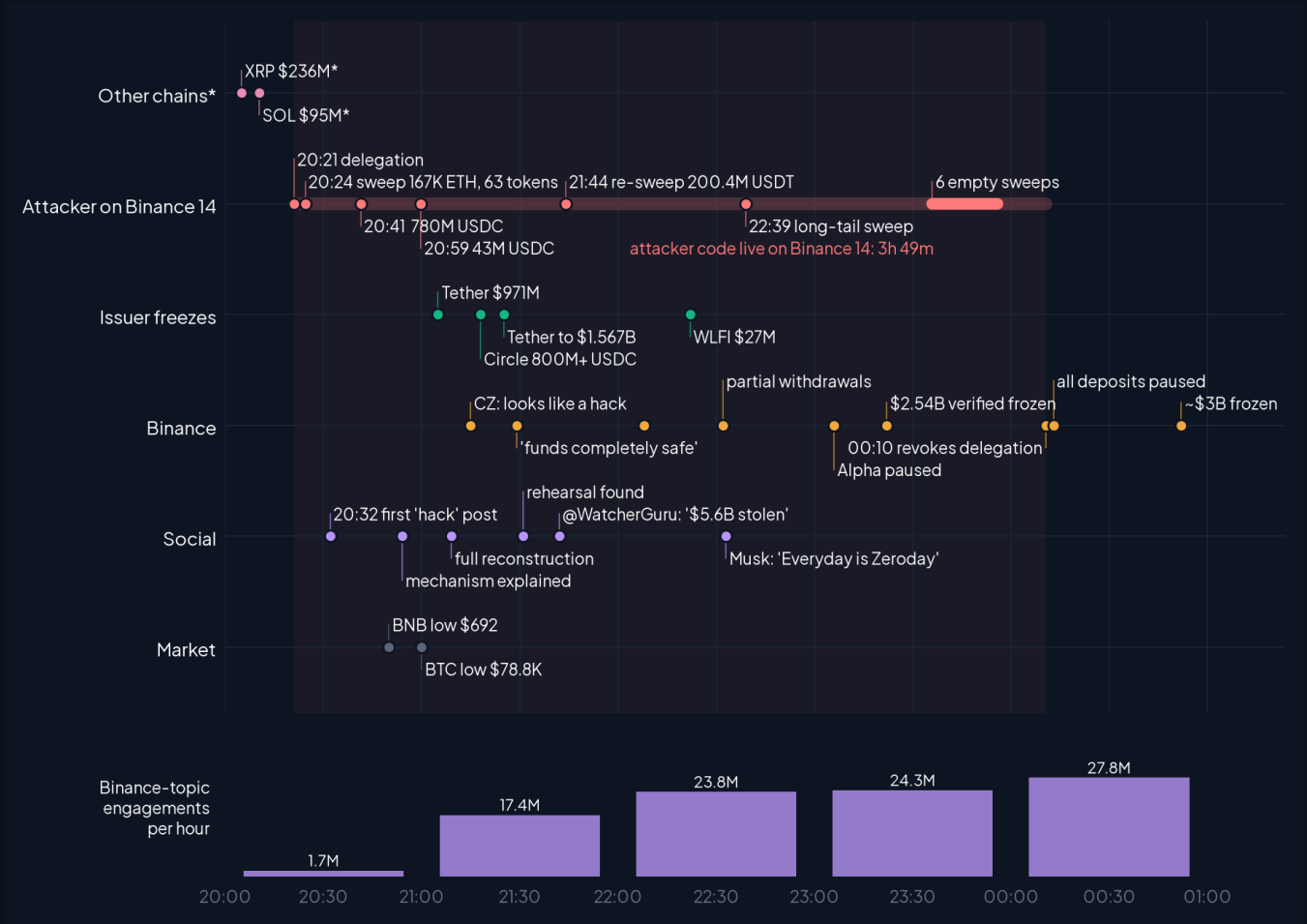
**00:10:35**

## Revocation

Binance 14 signs its own type-4 (EIP-7702) transaction pointing its delegation at the zero address, clearing the attacker's code 3 hours 49 minutes after it landed. Binance 14's own outgoing transfers between 00:47 and 01:53 fail.

FIRST PUBLIC
ChainCatcher, 00:44

### 20:00 TO 01:00 UTC, LANE BY LANE




Shaded: the 3 hours 49 minutes Binance 14 ran the attacker's code. *XRP and SOL senders are Binance by Whale Alert's label; Binance has not said whether these were its own transfers. Bottom: hourly engagements on the Binance topic.

06 · ACT IV

# The response

## The issuers froze first; Binance's verified frozen total reached about $3 billion by 00:52

Tether's first freeze reached the feed ten minutes before any Binance account spoke. Over the next four hours, issuers froze in sequence and Binance moved from holding statements to a full pause.

ANNOUNCED FREEZES VS BINANCE'S VERIFIED TOTAL




Green: running sum of issuer announcements (Ripple's ~200M excluded). Amber: totals Binance verified.

**21:05** — **Tether freezes $971M**
First reported by @TreeNewsFeed: 'Tether freezes $971M USDT in likely Binance hack, with no update from Binance still.'
ENGAGEMENT · SOURCE
1.99M engagements

**21:13** — **Circle freezes 823M USDC**
Jeremy Allaire confirms more than 800M USDC frozen at 21:18, in coordination with law enforcement (per The Block).
ENGAGEMENT · SOURCE
@WatcherGuru, 21:13

**21:15** — **CZ: 'It does look like a hack'**
'User funds are safe! It does look like a hack on Binance. Appreciate the quick freeze from Tether (~$971m) and Circle (~$823m).' The most-engaged post of the event. @binance posts three holding statements at 21:15, 21:16 and 21:24.
ENGAGEMENT · SOURCE
3.19M engagements

**21:25**

### Tether raises its freeze to 1.567B USDT

Paolo Ardoino: 'Tether froze more than 1.567B USDT related to a potential Binance exchange hack.'

ENGAGEMENT · SOURCE
1.03M engagements

**21:29**

### 'User funds are completely safe'

@binance reposts its statement with one added sentence. It draws ten times the engagement of the versions without it.

ENGAGEMENT · SOURCE
904K engagements

**21:52**

### Aave freezes its USDT market

Aave freezes its USDT market, blocking new borrowing against it, per @WatcherGuru.

ENGAGEMENT · SOURCE
@WatcherGuru, 21:52 (222K)

**22:08**

### Binance thanks Ripple; World Liberty freezes

Yi He thanks Ripple for freezing 'approximately 200 million' (unit not stated; no freeze shows on the traced XRP account), and at 22:22 World Liberty Financial for $27M USD1 and 48M WLFI.

ENGAGEMENT · SOURCE
@heyibinance

**22:23**

### 'Will cover'

CZ, replying to a net-loss estimate of about $1B: 'Loss might be a bit higher than that, but will cover.'

ENGAGEMENT · SOURCE
926K engagements

**22:32**

### Some withdrawals processed

Per CryptoTicker, some BTC, ETH and USDT withdrawals were being processed at 22:32; Binance's 22:33 notice said withdrawals would resume once the issue was resolved. Binance Alpha trading is suspended at 23:06.

ENGAGEMENT · SOURCE
CryptoTicker; @binance, 22:33 (351K)

**23:22**

### $2.54B verified frozen

Binance addresses 'differing figures circulating publicly' and puts the verified frozen total at $2.54B.

ENGAGEMENT · SOURCE
529K engagements

**00:13**

### Full pause; about $3B frozen

'Binance will cover all losses. As a precaution, all deposits and withdrawals are temporarily suspended.' At 00:52: 'The current verified total frozen amount is around $3 billion.'

ENGAGEMENT · SOURCE
378K and 156K engagements

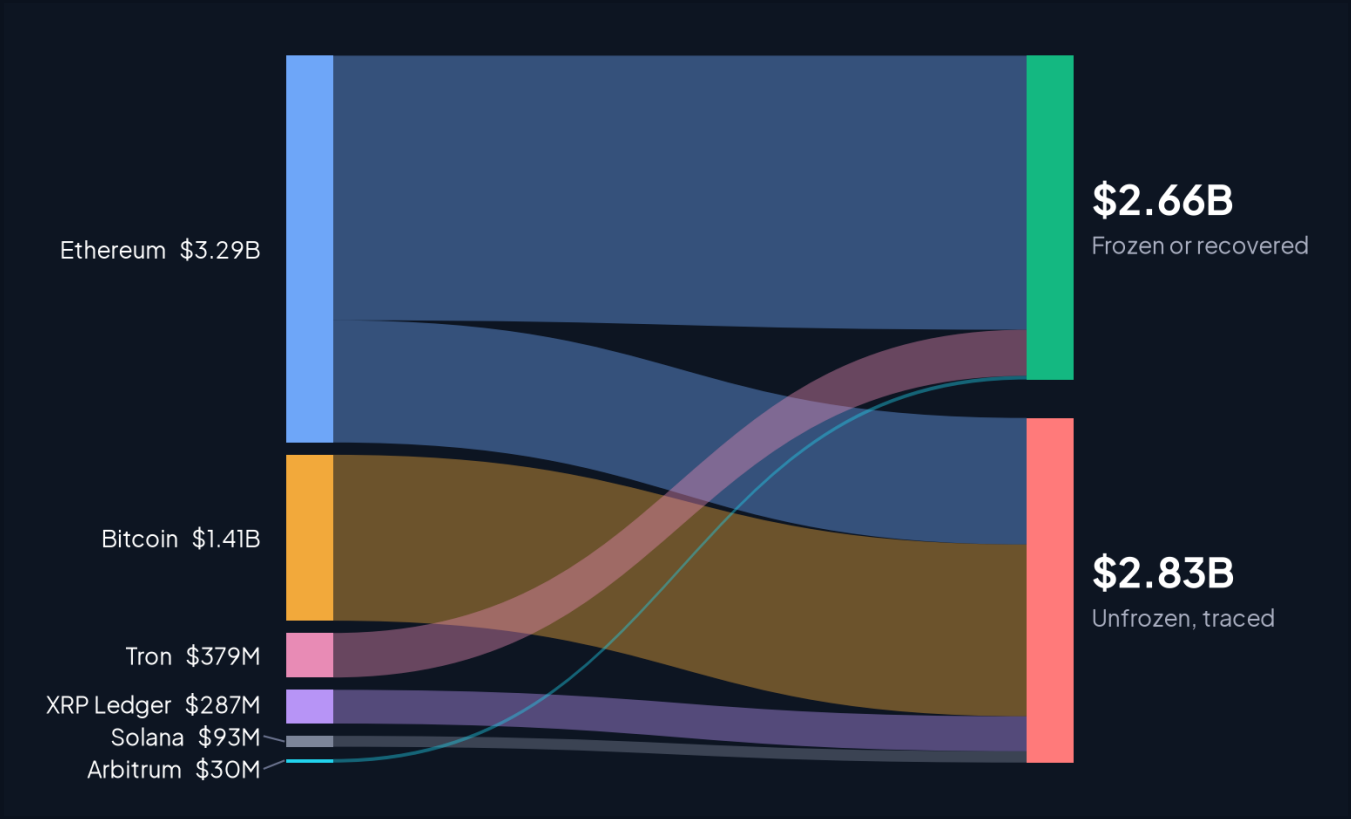
07 · ACT V

# The money

## About $2.66B is frozen or recovered; about $2.83B sits unfrozen in traced addresses

LunarCrush followed the funds across Ethereum, Bitcoin, Tron, XRP Ledger, Solana and Arbitrum and re-read every balance live between 03:20 and 03:27 UTC on Oct 30. Prices are CoinGecko spot at 03:22 UTC; stablecoins at face value.

WHERE THE FUNDS WENT, BY CHAIN AND STATUS




US dollars. Balances read live 03:20 to 03:27 UTC Oct 30; prices CoinGecko 03:22 UTC; stablecoins at face. Freeze status read from each token contract. The BTC, Tron, XRP and SOL legs are attributed to Binance by Whale Alert labels and timing.

**$2.66B**
$2.63B frozen at the token contracts and $30.2M recovered on Arbitrum

**$2.83B**
Unfrozen in traced addresses, including $16.3M of Aave collateral net of debt; BTC, XRP and SOL legs attributed to Binance by Whale Alert

**20:05 UTC**
First transfer to a new wallet, XRP Ledger, 16 min before the Ethereum delegation

The first wallet to empty was not on Ethereum. At 20:05:00 UTC the XRP Ledger account Whale Alert labels as Binance sent 185,017,485 XRP to a new account, rK21t6nG; by 20:09:20 four more accounts sent it 14.7M, 13.1M, 12.0M and 8.7M XRP. Each of the five senders now holds between 10 and 13 XRP. At 20:10:18 a Solana wallet sent 965,455 SOL to a new address.

At 20:20:06 one Bitcoin block (973,732) carried fifteen transactions moving 18,270.2 BTC from one address to one new address, which split it in the same block; four of them, 16,690 BTC, are the ones Whale Alert posted as leaving Binance. The Ethereum delegation followed at 20:20:59, 612.7M USDT reached a new Tron address at 20:22:45, and the Ethereum sweep landed at 20:24:23. The XRP, Solana, Tron and Bitcoin legs carry Whale Alert's 'Binance' label; Binance has confirmed none of them.

Ethereum holds the largest frozen balance. The main receiver, `0x5227…2f8c`, still holds 1,175,464,713 USDT, 823,000,000 USDC, 27,824,040 USD1 and 12,574 XAUt; each token contract's blacklist check returns true for it and false for a control address. A hop from `0x9749…c762` through `0x811f…e84c` parked 174,999,872 USDT at `0xAa24…54a0`, also blacklisted.

A third address, `0x8d53…639a`, supplied 60M USDT to Aave v3 and borrowed 19,763 WETH three minutes before Tether froze it (per Marc Zeller; its aUSDT and debt balances confirm the position). Aave's USDT reserve is frozen, which blocks new supply and borrowing but not withdrawals, so the 60.0M aUSDT remains withdrawable within the position's health-factor limits against 19,762.7 WETH of debt. The ledger counts only the net, about $16.3M, as unfrozen; the borrowed WETH is inside the traced ETH.

On Arbitrum, `0x3E2b…32d5` received 8,426 ETH and 74.56M ARB from the main receiver's address at 21:35 to 21:38. At 00:18:20 both left in L1-originated transactions, about $30.2M, which @zachxbt reported as the Arbitrum Security Council's recovery. Binance's own 'verified frozen' figures were $2.54B at 23:22 and around $3B at 00:52.

What escaped on Ethereum became ETH. In the hour after the sweep, `0x9749` sent about 323.6M USDT to four unverified contracts, and 122,310 ETH later left it for `0xc887…286a`, which holds 137,602 ETH and has never sent a transaction. The other 15,292 ETH there came from `0x7f9d…15e3`, which still holds 29,934 wBETH.

Address `0x77ed…c3eb` swapped about 50M USDT on Uniswap v3 and v4 and sent 41,398 ETH to `0x7Aa4…bfd1`, which forwarded 57,892 ETH to `0xCcBE…a263` at 21:11:59. It moved to `0xb171…c8c3` at 21:16:47 and to `0x897C…8df3` at 21:35:59, where it has stayed; Whale Alert's 21:41 post of '57,891 ETH from Binance Hack 2026' matches that hop. `0x897C` also received 20,523 ETH from `0x42CD…7810`, funded from the `0x811f…e84c` hop, and holds 78,415 ETH with no outgoing transaction.

The 195,460 ETH that left the main receiver at 20:39 sits at `0x8532…43d4`, which holds 197,460 ETH (2,000 arrived separately) and has never sent a transaction. The main receiver holds 16,501 ETH and was still converting long-tail tokens into ETH at 03:17 UTC. About 430,000 ETH and 29,934 wBETH sit downstream of the sweep, none of it freezable.

Bitcoin is the largest unfrozen position, and none of it has moved since 20:48. All 18,270.2 BTC came from the one sending address; the new address split it in the same block, with one more split at 20:48:14. The tree ends in 19 addresses: seventeen holding exactly 1,000 BTC, one 832.5 and one 437.7. None has spent an output. No

exchange-labeled address appears in it; the 650 and 656 BTC Whale Alert showed reaching Coinbase Institutional at 22:28 and 22:59 came from outside it.

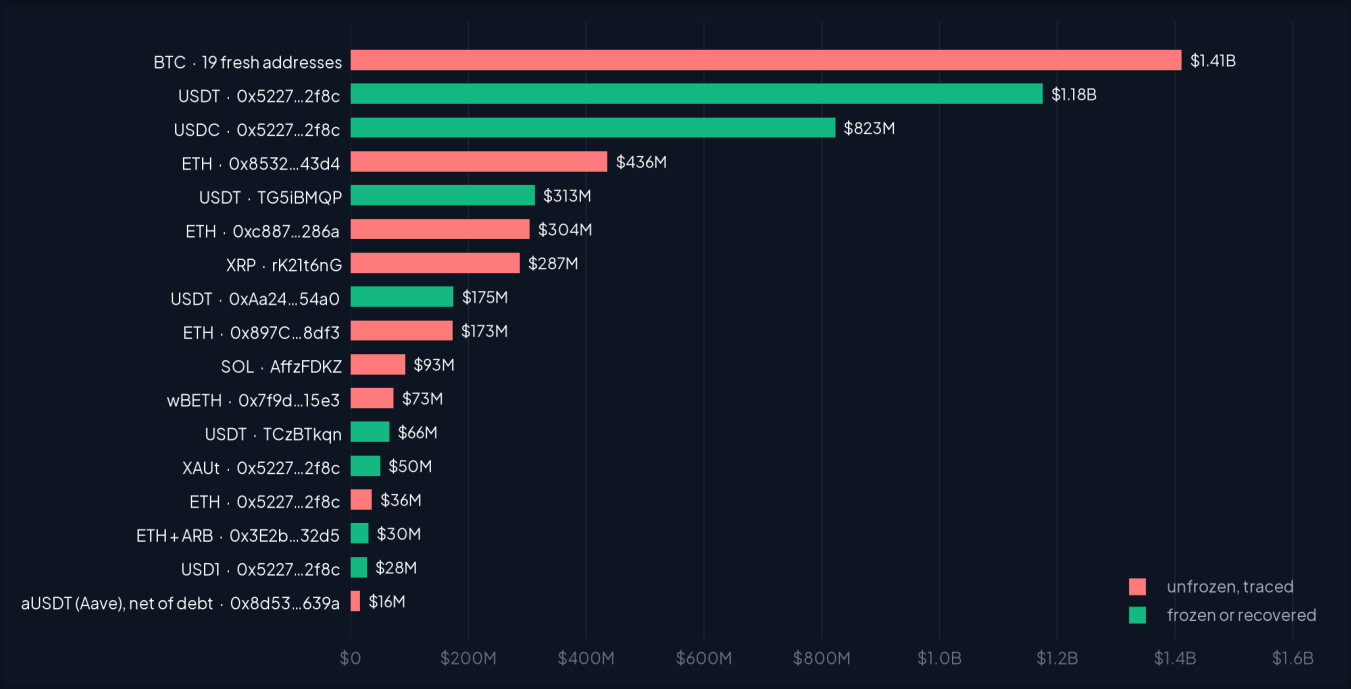
The XRP account rK21t6nG holds 233,461,943 XRP and has sent no transaction. @heyibinance thanked Ripple for freezing ‘approximately 200 million’, but the account carries no freeze flag and native XRP has no issuer freeze, so it counts as unfrozen. The Solana address AffzFDKZ holds 970,545 SOL, 965,455 of it from the 20:10 transfer; its 82 later transactions are small inbound deposits and token-account creations.

On Tron, TG5iBMQP received 612,729,468 USDT at 20:22:45 and sent 300M to TPBkSjkC at 20:45:51 and 20:56:09; the remaining 312,729,468 USDT is blacklisted in place. TPBkSjkC sent the 300M on in eighteen transfers between 20:46 and 21:16: 199M to contract TSUUVjys, 33M to a contract named PoolManager (TVjuTE3V), 2M to contract TFGDbUyP, 10,000 to TXJgMdjV and 65,990,000 to TCzBTkqn, which still holds it, blacklisted. TPBkSjkC is blacklisted and empty. Of 612.7M on Tron, 378.7M is frozen and about 234M reached contracts first.

Frozen, verified at each token contract: about $2.63B (USDT 1.73B across four addresses on two chains, USDC 823M, USD1 27.8M, XAUt $50M). Recovered: $30.2M on Arbitrum. About $2.66B in all. Unfrozen in traced addresses: about $2.83B, made up of BTC $1.41B at $77,253, ETH $950M at $2,210, XRP $287M, SOL $93M, wBETH $73M at $2,447 and Aave collateral net of debt, $16.3M. Gross traced, about $5.49B, sits inside the range of gross estimates posted that night, from $5.3B (Coinglass, via Investing.com) to about $5.9B (@KobeissiLetter’s 22:59 running total).

About $2.58B of stablecoins is blacklisted where it sits. At least $608M of USDT reached swap contracts before an issuer reached it (323.6M from `0x9749`, about 50M from `0x77ed`, about 234M on Tron), and 19,763 WETH was borrowed against Aave collateral. The BTC, ETH, XRP and SOL, about $2.74B, can move without an issuer’s permission; none of it had moved on from where it landed.

## EVERY VERIFIED POSITION




Balances read live 03:20 to 03:27 UTC Oct 30, CoinGecko spot. Red: unfrozen. Green: frozen or recovered.

## EVERY POSITION WE READ LIVE, 03:20 TO 03:27 UTC OCT 30 (COINGECKO SPOT AT 03:22 UTC)

| CHAIN / ADDRESS | ASSET AND AMOUNT | USD | STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Bitcoin, 19 fresh addresses** | 18,270.2 BTC (17 × 1,000 + 832.5 + 437.7) | $1,411M | Held, unfrozen, no output spent; Whale Alert attribution |
| **Ethereum** `0x5227…2f8c` | 1,175.5M USDT + 823M USDC | $1,998M | Frozen (blacklists read from contracts) |
| **Ethereum** `0x8532…43d4` | 197,460 ETH | $436M | Never sent a transaction |
| **Tron TG5iBMQP** | 312.7M USDT | $313M | Frozen (blacklisted); Whale Alert attribution |
| **Ethereum** `0xc887…286a` | 137,602 ETH | $304M | Never sent a transaction |
| **XRP Ledger rK21t6nG** | 233.5M XRP | $287M | No outgoing transaction; Whale Alert attribution |
| **Ethereum** `0xAa24…54a0` | 175.0M USDT | $175M | Frozen (blacklisted) |
| **Ethereum** `0x897C…8df3` | 78,415 ETH (57,892 via `0xCcBE…a263`) | $173M | Never sent a transaction |
| **Solana AffzFDKZ** | 970,545 SOL (965,455 received) | $93M | No outgoing SOL; Whale Alert attribution |
| **Ethereum** `0x7f9d…15e3` | 29,934 wBETH | $73M | Unfrozen; also forwarded 15,292 ETH |
| **Tron TCzBTkqn** | 66.0M USDT | $66M | Frozen (blacklisted); Whale Alert attribution |
| **Ethereum** `0x5227…2f8c` | 12,574 XAUt + 27.8M USD1 | $78M | Frozen (isBlocked / frozen read from contracts) |
| **Ethereum** `0x5227…2f8c` | 16,501 ETH | $36M | Unfrozen, still swapping tokens to ETH |
| **Arbitrum** `0x3E2b…32d5` | 8,426 ETH + 74.56M ARB moved out 00:18 | $30M | Recovered per @zachxbt (Arbitrum Security Council) |
| **Ethereum** `0x8d53…639a` **(Aave)** | 60.0M aUSDT vs 19,763 WETH debt | $60M gross, $16.3M net | Unfrozen; reserve freeze blocks new supply and borrowing, not withdrawals |

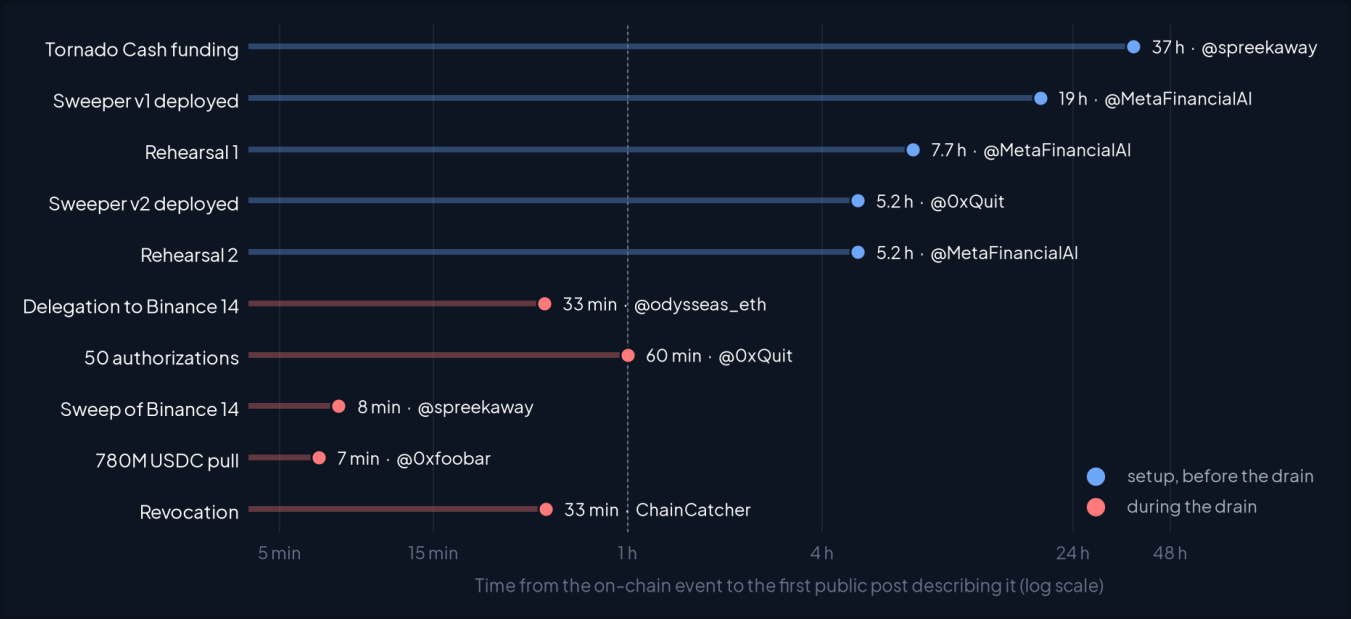
08 · ACT VI

# The public record

## Each step of the drain was public within about an hour; the setup waited 5 to 37 hours

Independent analysts reconstructed the attack from the chain in real time. The record they built is the spine of this report.

FROM CHAIN TO FEED




Minutes from each on-chain event to the first public post that described it. Blue: setup. Red: the attack.

The sweep was public in 8 minutes and the 780M USDC pull in 7. By 21:25, about an hour after the delegation, posts had the mechanism, the contract, the hardcoded operator and the fifty authorizations, and every one of those claims checks out against the chain.

The setup was a different story. The first sweeper sat on-chain for 19 hours before anyone wrote about it, and both rehearsals were found only after the money had moved. The same pattern, a mixer-funded address delegating test wallets to unverified code and sweeping them, was visible from 13:51.

What varied across posts was never the sequence. It was the total: reported outflow estimates ran from $2.53B at 20:39 to $5.57B by 21:12, and $5.7B by 21:58, depending on which chains and which freezes were counted.

09 · COUNTERFACTUAL

# Could it have been stopped?

## Five signals were public before or during the drain; the issuer freezes were what worked

Five signals were public before or during the drain. Preventing the first sweep required a transaction included in the 204-second window after the delegation; later action could have blocked part of the outflows that followed, given monitoring and signing access.

**6h 29m**
First rehearsal to the Binance 14 delegation

**15 min**
From Whale Alert's 20:06 XRP post to the Ethereum delegation

**~$1.03B**
Moved on explorer-visible lines after the 20:32 post

Signal one: the rehearsal, 6 hours 29 minutes before the delegation; the first contract had been on-chain since 02:28. From 13:51 UTC a fresh address funded only by Tornado Cash delegated two dust wallets to an unverified contract with a sweep(address, address) selector, seeded them with a few dollars of USDT and USDC, and swept them. At 16:20 it repeated the run with the second contract: hardcoded operator, leave-one-ether logic, a withdraw. None of it touched a Binance address.

The pattern (mixer-funded sponsor, type-4 delegation to unverified code, sweep selector, dust wallets) matches the drainer behavior wallet-security vendors describe in their 7702 write-ups. A rule for 'type-4 transaction sponsored by a Tornado-funded address, delegating to unverified code' fires at 13:51:35; the full pattern is complete by 14:24. It would not have named Binance as the target. It would have put `0x7C86` on a watchlist that hit again at 20:20:59.

Signal two: the cross-chain start. Whale Alert posted 185,017,485 XRP ($236M) leaving Binance for an 'unknown new wallet' at 20:06 and 965,455 SOL ($95M) to another new wallet at 20:11. The posts drew 59K and 45K engagements and passed as routine; in the sampled posts nobody linked them to anything until @hackenclub at 20:51. @ai_9684xtpa's Chinese-language summary at 00:00 put the first suspicious hot-wallet outflow at 04:10 Beijing, 20:10 UTC.

An exchange can run 'hot wallet to never-seen address, above $50M, on two chains, within ten minutes' against its own signing logs. On Whale Alert's post times that rule fires at 20:11, ten minutes before the Ethereum delegation; on an exchange's own logs, earlier. It also fires on routine cold-wallet rotations, so it is a review trigger, not a kill switch. Whether the XRP and SOL moves were the attacker's or Binance's own is unresolved; the transfers are on-chain, and only their attribution to Binance rests on Whale Alert's label.

Signal three: 3 minutes 24 seconds, seventeen blocks, between delegation (20:20:59) and sweep (20:24:23). A monitor that decodes type-4 transactions in new blocks and matches authorization signers against an exchange's own wallets fires at inclusion. No public account mentioned the delegation until @odysseas_eth at 20:54, thirty minutes after the sweep.

The window allowed a competing type-4 transaction from Binance 14 clearing the delegation, the kind Binance sent at 00:10, or moving balances out. Neither is guaranteed to land inside 17 blocks. A cleared delegation holds until another valid authorization is included on-chain; clearing the code does not invalidate authorizations already signed. An attacker can also put delegation and sweep in one transaction.

Signal four: the open delegation, where the later outflows can be counted. The 20:24 sweep took what Binance 14 held. Everything after moved through a delegation live until 00:10:35 and readable on-chain from inclusion (Etherscan showed a 'Delegate to' label). The 780M USDC at 20:41 and 43M at 20:59 moved because Hot Wallet 34 accepted calls from Binance 14; the 21:04 and 21:44 sweeps took value that arrived after the first sweep, including 200.4M USDT; the 22:39 sweep took long-tail tokens marked at about $7.5M on the ten largest lines the explorer lists.

The ledger: 780M + 43M + 3.9M + 200.4M + about 7.5M, about $1.03B on explorer-visible lines after @spreekaway's 20:32 post; about $255M of that after 20:41; about $208M plus unpriced lines after 21:15, fifty-one minutes after the sweep. A delegation cleared before 20:41 blocks all of it; cleared between 20:41 and 20:59, about $255M. Much of the USDT and USDC was later frozen, so not all of what moved is lost. Blockscout records 533 incoming token transfers to Binance 14 in the window.

Signal five: the mood of the day. Between 17:47 and 18:56 UTC, 84 to 153 minutes before the delegation, posts on X carried a wave of signing-attack news: 'Polymarket hacked, everyone withdraw now' (@TheNotoriousSKi, 144K), 'Polymarket frontend is injecting a malicious script to sell all your positions' (@aaalex, 188K), CZ on a Ledger supply-chain compromise in Singapore (435K) and, at 18:56, CZ describing 'an injection attack on the front end' (640K).

At 04:49 on Oct 28, CZ had listed four data leaks in one day. None of it named Binance's hot wallets, and front-end injection against retail users is a different class of attack from fifty authorization signatures on an exchange hot wallet.

The response that worked came from the issuers. @TreeNewsFeed reported Tether's $971M freeze at 21:05. Whale Alert then posted the freezes: 312.7M USDT on Tron at 21:10, 971M USDT on Ethereum at 21:11 and Circle's 823M USDC at 21:13, about $2.1B, all before Binance posted anything. Two more by 21:31 (66M and 175M USDT) took the feed's total to about $2.35B; Binance later put the verified frozen figure at $2.54B (23:22) and around $3B (00:52).

@odysseas_eth counted about 72 percent of the stablecoins that reached the sweep recipient frozen by 21:43 and, by the same count, 700M USDT already moved on. Yi He thanked Ripple for freezing 'approximately 200 million' and World Liberty for 27M USD1, and @zachxbt reported the Arbitrum Security Council recovering about $30M at midnight.

No freeze touches ETH or BTC. Whale Alert posted 195,460 ETH moving at 20:40 and about 16,690 BTC in four transfers between 20:30 and 20:33, and at 02:00 UTC the main receiver was converting long-tail tokens into

ETH about once every twelve seconds; it was still swapping at 03:17 UTC. Freezes worked where the asset had an issuer and nowhere else.

## WHAT WAS VISIBLE, WHEN, AND WHAT ACTING ON IT WOULD HAVE CHANGED

| SIGNAL (UTC) | WHERE IT WAS VISIBLE | WHO SAW IT IN PUBLIC | WHAT IT WOULD HAVE CHANGED |
|---|---|---|---|
| **13:51 rehearsal: Tornado-funded EOA delegates dust wallets to unverified sweeper** | Ethereum mainnet, any 7702 monitor | Nobody until 21:31 (@MetaFinancialAI), after the fact | Hypothetical earliest trigger for a narrow rule; operator on a watchlist 6.5 hours early |
| **16:20 to 16:47 second rehearsal with the production contract** | Ethereum mainnet | Nobody until 21:31 (@MetaFinancialAI) | Same, with the exact contract address known 4 hours early |
| **17:47 to 18:56 same-day signing-attack wave (Polymarket, Ledger, CZ's 'injection attack' post)** | X, 640K engagements on CZ's post alone | Everyone; nobody tied it to hot-wallet signing | Context for the post-mortem |
| **20:05 XRP $236M and 20:10 SOL $95M to new wallets** | Whale Alert public feed, posted 20:06 and 20:11 (59K, 45K engagements) | Posted by a bot; first human link at 20:51 (@hackenclub) | If the moves were the attacker's (unresolved), an exchange-side rule had about 10 minutes before the Ethereum delegation |
| **20:20:59 type-4 delegation, 50 signatures from Binance 14** | Block 26300753; Etherscan label from 20:21 | @odysseas_eth 20:54, 30 minutes after the sweep | 204 seconds between inclusion and sweep; nobody public mentioned it for 30 minutes |
| **20:24 to 00:10 delegation left live; deposits keep arriving** | Etherscan address page for Binance 14 | @uttam_singhk 22:00 explained the mechanism | Delegation cleared before 20:41 blocks about $1.03B of later transfers; cleared by 20:59, about $255M |
| **21:05 to 21:13 Tether and Circle freezes** | Reported at 21:05 by @TreeNewsFeed; Whale Alert freeze posts 21:10 to 21:13; issuer CEOs on X | Everyone; TreeNewsFeed 21:05 pre-empted Binance | About $2.35B frozen by 21:31; ETH and BTC untouched |

## WHAT THE POSTS SAID

> 185,017,485 $XRP (235,816,974 USD) transferred from #Binance to unknown new wallet
> **@whale_alert · 20:06 UTC · 59K**

> ...it appears to be an injection attack on the front end. injecting incorrect tx, but showing a valid tx for the user to sign.
> **@cz_binance · 18:56 UTC · 640K**

> THE REHEARSAL 02:28 UTC: the attacker deploys a sweeper contract... 13:51 to 16:47: they practise on their own fresh wallets. EIP 7702 delegation, then sweep.
> **@MetaFinancialAI · 21:31 UTC · 1.5K**

> You only get a stack of pre-signed auths like that if the key or the signing system is compromised. They tested the setup on other addresses throughout Oct 29.
> **@Aytunc · 22:06 UTC · 9.7K**

## TAKEAWAYS

### Watch your own signatures

Decode every type-4 transaction in new blocks and match authorization signers against your own wallets: that alert fires at the delegation, not the sweep. Pair it with a rule that a wallet carrying delegated code receives no new inbound routing until the code is cleared.

### The rehearsal is the tell

Mixer-funded fresh address, type-4 delegation to unverified code with a sweep selector, dust wallets seeded, swept and withdrawn: that pattern ran on mainnet from 13:51 UTC, and nobody published it until after the drain.

## NEXT 24 TO 72 HOURS

1 Whether Binance's post-mortem covers inbound routing to Binance 14 during the 3h49m window; the 200.4M USDT swept at 21:44 is the test.

2 Confirmation that the 20:05 XRP and 20:10 SOL outflows were the attacker's would date the compromise before the Ethereum delegation.

3 A published, backtested rehearsal-pattern alert that would have fired at 13:51; every transaction it needs is public.

LunarCrush

PART II

# How the world found out

95 million engagements in the first five hours: who broke the story, how it was framed, where it travelled and what it did to the rest of the market.

10 · CHAPTER

# The night in numbers

## Nine numbers that define the first 4.6 hours

**114.2M**
Engagements, rolling 24h to 01:00 UTC

**95.1M**
Engagements, 20:00 to 00:59 UTC (five hourly buckets)

**27.8M**
Peak hour (00:00 UTC), 27.5x baseline

**9,044**
New posts at 21:00 UTC, 21.6x baseline

**29,329**
Unique creators in 24h, +158% on the prior day

**22,330**
First-time posters, 20:00 to 00:59 UTC, 15.2x normal

**80 to 53**
Sentiment, baseline to the 21:00 UTC low

**3.2M**
Engagements on CZ's 21:15 post, the night's biggest

**96%**
Of engagement on X; TikTok 2%, YouTube 2%



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# Minute by minute

## Chain, social, Binance and issuers on one clock

| UTC | LANE | WHAT HAPPENED | ENG. |
|---|---|---|---|
| 20:20 | Chain | Wallet labeled 'Binance 14' delegated via EIP-7702 to an outside contract (Etherscan, per CryptoTicker). | |
| 20:23 | X | @whale_alert posts the 612.7M USDT transfer alert, following its 20:06 XRP and 20:11 SOL alerts; each alert draws 40K to 90K. | ~1.3M total |
| 20:24 | Chain | 167,464 ETH plus 63 other tokens move in one transaction to an address Etherscan tags 'Binance Hot Wallet Exploiter 2'. | |
| 20:32 | X | @spreekaway: 'Unconfirmed, but possibly massive binance hack. Entire Binance wallet drained into new EOA.' First human framing as a hack. | 1.59M |
| 20:39 | X | @TreeNewsFeed 'POTENTIAL BINANCE HACK ONGOING' (570K); @bwenews puts the figure at ~$2.53B in 60+ tokens (177K). | 747K |
| 20:39 | Chain | ~195,460 ETH moved to a second address, where it still sat at the cut. ETH cannot be frozen. | |
| 20:41 | Chain | ~780M USDC leaves a second linked address. | |
| 20:42 | X | @ASVPXILLZ says their own Binance account was drained of ~$3M. Unverified user claim; the first 'it's happening to users' post. | 664K |
| 20:50 | Market | BNB at $692.32 by 20:50, from $738.90 at 20:15 (CoinMarketCap via CryptoTicker). | |
| 20:54 | X | @odysseas_eth explains the EIP-7702 'sweeper' mechanism (218K); @DarkWebInformer '$2.77 Billion' (176K); at 20:56 @officer_secret '~$3.5B across multiple chains' (204K). | 598K |
| 21:00 | Market | BTC at $78,763 by 21:00, from $80,327 at 20:15. About $628M of leveraged positions closed within an hour, $607M of them longs (CoinGlass via PANews). | |
| 21:05 | X | @TreeNewsFeed: 'TETHER FREEZES $971M USDT IN LIKELY BINANCE HACK, WITH NO UPDATE FROM BINANCE STILL'. The freeze reaches the feed before Binance does. | 1.99M |
| 21:08 | X | @WatcherGuru (21:08) and @KobeissiLetter (21:14) carry the $971M Tether freeze. | 1.19M |
| 21:15 | Binance | @cz_binance: 'User funds are safe! It does look like a hack on Binance. Appreciate the quick freeze from Tether (~$971m) and Circle (~$823m).' Biggest post of the night. | 3.19M |
| 21:15 | Binance | @binance posts three near-identical holding statements ('aware of reports of a potential security issue') at 21:15, 21:16 and 21:24. | 91K avg |
| 21:18 | Issuers | Circle CEO Jeremy Allaire: more than 800M USDC frozen, in coordination with law enforcement (per The Block). | |
| 21:25 | Issuers | @paoloardoino: 'Tether froze more than 1.567B USDT related to a potential Binance exchange hack.' | 1.03M |
| 21:26 | X | @0xngmi: with USDT and USDC frozen, net loss ~$1B against ~$144B under custody, under 1 percent. The counter-narrative. | 621K |
| 21:29 | Binance | @binance reposts its statement with one added sentence: 'User funds are completely safe.' | 904K |
| 21:42 | X | @WatcherGuru: 'World's largest crypto exchange Binance hacked with over $5.6 billion stolen'. | 1.98M |
| 21:58 | X | @KobeissiLetter: outflows of '–$5.7 billion' across Ethereum, Bitcoin and TRON. | 2.22M |
| 22:08 | Binance | @heyibinance thanks the Ripple team for freezing 'approximately 200 million'; at 22:22 thanks World Liberty Financial for $27M USD1 and 48M WLFI frozen. | 217K |
| 22:23 | Binance | @cz_binance, replying to the ~$1B net estimate: 'Loss might be a bit higher than that, but will cover.' | 926K |
| 22:32 | Binance | Per CryptoTicker, some BTC, ETH and USDT withdrawals were being processed at 22:32; Binance's 22:33 notice said withdrawals would resume once the issue was resolved. | |
| 22:33 | X | @elonmusk quote-posts the $5.7B figure: 'Everyday is Zeroday'. | 2.10M |
| 23:06 | Binance | @binance: Binance Alpha trading temporarily suspended as a security measure. | 243K |
| 23:22 | Binance | @binance addresses 'differing figures circulating publicly regarding the amount frozen, including references to $1.8 billion': verified frozen total $2.54B. | 529K |
| 00:04 | Binance | @heyibinance: 'User funds are safe. Binance will cover all hacking losses. Deposits and withdrawals are temporarily suspended.' @binance says the same at 00:13. | 623K |
| 00:38 | Market | BTC $77,160 (–4.9% on 24h), BNB $684.21 (–9.9%) (CoinMarketCap via CryptoTicker). | |
| 00:52 | Binance | @binance: 'The current verified total frozen amount is around $3 billion.' Last statement before the data cut. | 156K |

12 · CHAPTER

# The attention shock

## Binance engagements hit 27.5x baseline by 00:00 UTC, three hours after new posts peaked

The sweep landed at 20:24 UTC. Within the hour the Binance topic ran at 17 times its normal engagement, and the audience kept growing after new posts began to fall.

**27.5x**
Engagements vs baseline, 00:00 UTC hour

**21.6x**
New posts vs baseline, 21:00 peak

**95.1M**
Engagements, 20:00 to 00:59 UTC

Binance became a mass event inside one hour. In the 21:00 UTC hour, the first full hour after the 20:24 sweep, the topic drew 17.4M engagements (likes, reposts, comments and views-weighted engagement summed across networks), 17.2 times its baseline of 1.0M an hour, the mean of the 162 full hours before 20:00 UTC. The busiest hour of the previous week had drawn 1.7M. The 20:00 hour, with only 36 minutes of event time, already passed that at 1.73M.

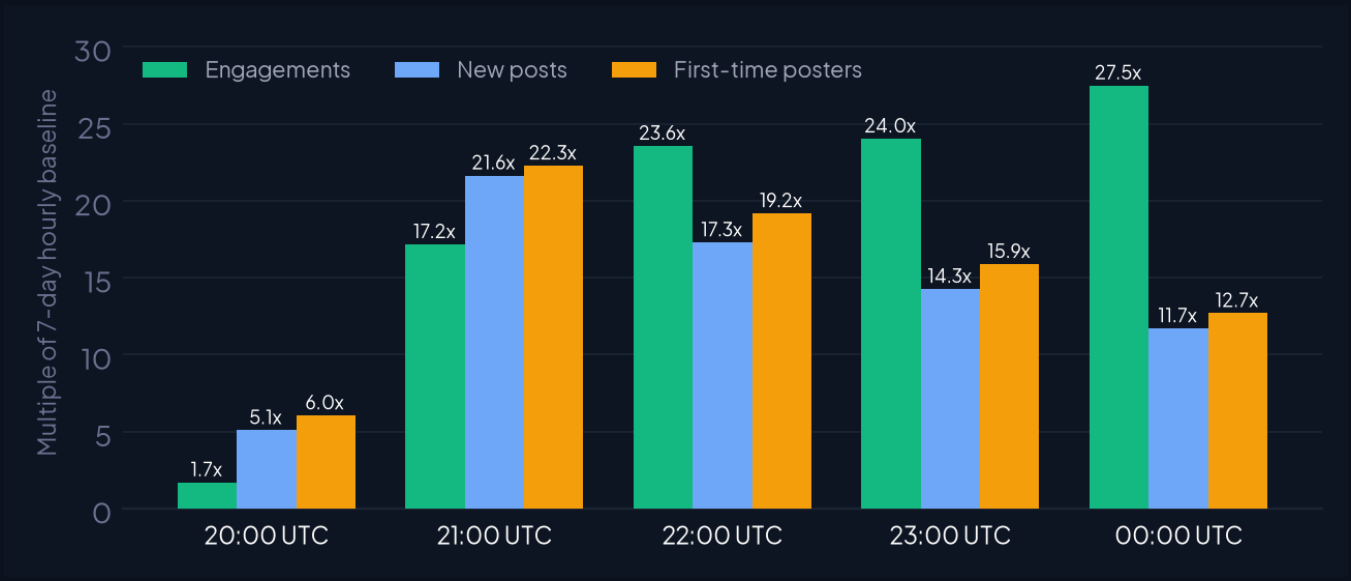
Publishing peaked first. New posts hit 9,044 at 21:00, 21.6 times the baseline of 418 an hour, then fell every hour: 7,226, 5,964 and 4,893. Engagements moved the other way: 23.8M (23.6x) at 22:00, 24.3M (24.0x) at 23:00 and 27.8M (27.5x) at 00:00. Hourly engagement counts every post engaged that hour, including older ones. Posts receiving engagement rose from 22,014 to 37,092, and accounts with an engaged post from 13,449 to 22,735.

Much of that audience was new to the topic. The 21:00 hour brought 6,538 first-time posters, 22.3 times the baseline of 293, and 49 percent of active creators against about 5 percent normally. From 20:00 to 00:59 (five hourly buckets) the topic drew 95.1M engagements, 29,255 new posts and 22,330 first-time posters, an engagement total equal to 58 percent of the previous 162 hours combined. Against the same UTC hour on the prior six days, the 00:00 hour ran at 32.0x.

Authorship was front-loaded. Of the 55.4M engagements on the 686 sampled event-window posts, 43 percent went to posts published within 60 minutes of 20:24, half within 65 minutes and 81 percent within two hours; posts after the third hour took 3 percent. The steps in the minute curve are single posts: @spreekaway at +8 minutes (1.6M), @TreeNewsFeed's Tether freeze headline at +41 (2.0M), @cz_binance at +51 (3.2M) and @KobeissiLetter at +94 (2.2M).

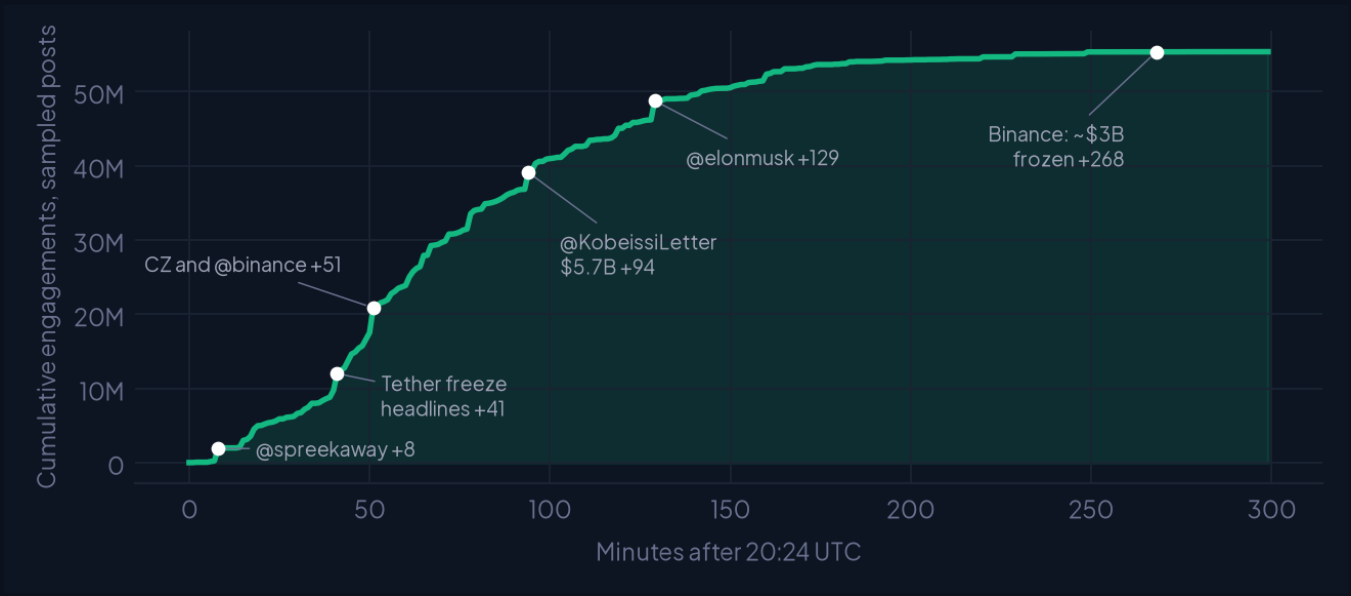
Opinion moved less than attention. Sentiment, the engagement-weighted positive share of non-neutral engagement, fell from 80 to 67 in the 20:00 hour and 53 at 21:00, then recovered to 58, 61 and 57. Oct 29 UTC, with 3.6 event hours, closed at 87.2M engagements against 21.0M to 25.1M on each of Oct 24 to 28. At the cut, hourly engagement was still rising.

## EVENT HOURS VS BASELINE




Each event hour against the Binance topic's own 7-day hourly mean.

## MINUTE BY MINUTE, SAMPLED POSTS




Cumulative engagement of the 686 sampled posts by posting minute.

## BINANCE TOPIC BY HOUR VS BASELINE (UTC)

| HOUR (UTC) | ENG. (X BASELINE) | NEW POSTS (X) | FIRST-TIME POSTERS (X) | SENTIMENT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Baseline (mean/hour)** | 1.0M | 418 | 293 | 80 |
| **Oct 29 20:00** | 1.7M (1.7x) | 2,128 (5.1x) | 1,775 (6.0x) | 67 |
| **Oct 29 21:00** | 17.4M (17.2x) | 9,044 (21.6x) | 6,538 (22.3x) | 53 |
| **Oct 29 22:00** | 23.8M (23.6x) | 7,226 (17.3x) | 5,629 (19.2x) | 58 |
| **Oct 29 23:00** | 24.3M (24.0x) | 5,964 (14.3x) | 4,662 (15.9x) | 61 |
| **Oct 30 00:00** | 27.8M (27.5x) | 4,893 (11.7x) | 3,726 (12.7x) | 57 |

## WHAT THE POSTS SAID

> Entire Binance wallet drained into new EOA. Contract call was funded by Tornado Cash
> **@spreekaway · 20:32 UTC · 1.6M**

> TETHER FREEZES $971M USDT IN LIKELY BINANCE HACK, WITH NO UPDATE FROM BINANCE STILL
> **@TreeNewsFeed · 21:05 UTC · 2.0M**

> It does look like a hack on Binance. Appreciate the quick freeze from Tether (~$971m) and Circle (~$823m).
> **@cz_binance · 21:15 UTC · 3.2M**

> BREAKING: Binance has been hacked with wallets across the Ethereum, Bitcoin, and TRON networks seeing outflows of –$5.7 billion.
> **@KobeissiLetter · 21:58 UTC · 2.2M**

## TAKEAWAYS

### Publishing peaked, attention did not

New posts halved from 9,044 at 21:00 to 4,893 at 00:00 while engagements rose from 17.2x to 27.5x baseline. A falling post count does not mean a story is fading. Hourly engagements had not turned by the cut.

### The audience formed within one hour

The first viral post came 8 minutes after the sweep. The next full hour ran at 17.2x baseline, with 49 percent of active creators posting about Binance for the first time. Later statements met an audience whose first impression had already formed.

## NEXT 24 TO 72 HOURS

1 Hourly engagements through Asia hours (02:00 to 08:00 UTC): holding above 20x baseline (20M an hour) makes this a second-day story.

2 New posts per hour: a rebound above the 21:00 peak of 9,044 would mark a fresh wave of authors.

3 Hourly sentiment against its 53 floor: a break lower while engagements hold means opinion is hardening.

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# The first hour: who broke it

## 39 posts published before any Binance account spoke went on to reach 100K engagements each

The first hour had a clear order: automated transfer alerts, a 39.5K-follower on-chain account naming it a hack, aggregators attaching numbers, and a Tether freeze headline. Binance-linked accounts spoke last.

**+8 min**
First viral post, @spreekaway

**39**
Pre-statement posts that reached 100K by the cut

**40**
Engagements per follower, @spreekaway

On-chain watchers broke the story, aggregators packaged it, and a stablecoin freeze hit the feed before Binance said anything. In the sampled posts, 39 published before the first Binance-linked post at 21:15 UTC, 51 minutes after the sweep, each passed 100K engagements by the cut, 13.8M together. None came from an official account: 18 were mid-size accounts (50K to 500K followers), 9 news aggregators, 8 small accounts and 4 large ones.

The machine signal came first and did not travel. Whale Alert's bot posted transfers out of #Binance from 20:23, including, per its own figures, 7,636 BTC at 20:30 and 780,000,000 USDC at 20:42. Each drew 40K to 90K engagements. At 20:32 (+8 minutes) @spreekaway, an on-chain account with 39.5K followers, wrote "Unconfirmed" and "Entire Binance wallet drained into new EOA", with a funding detail attached. It drew 1.6M engagements, about 40 per follower.

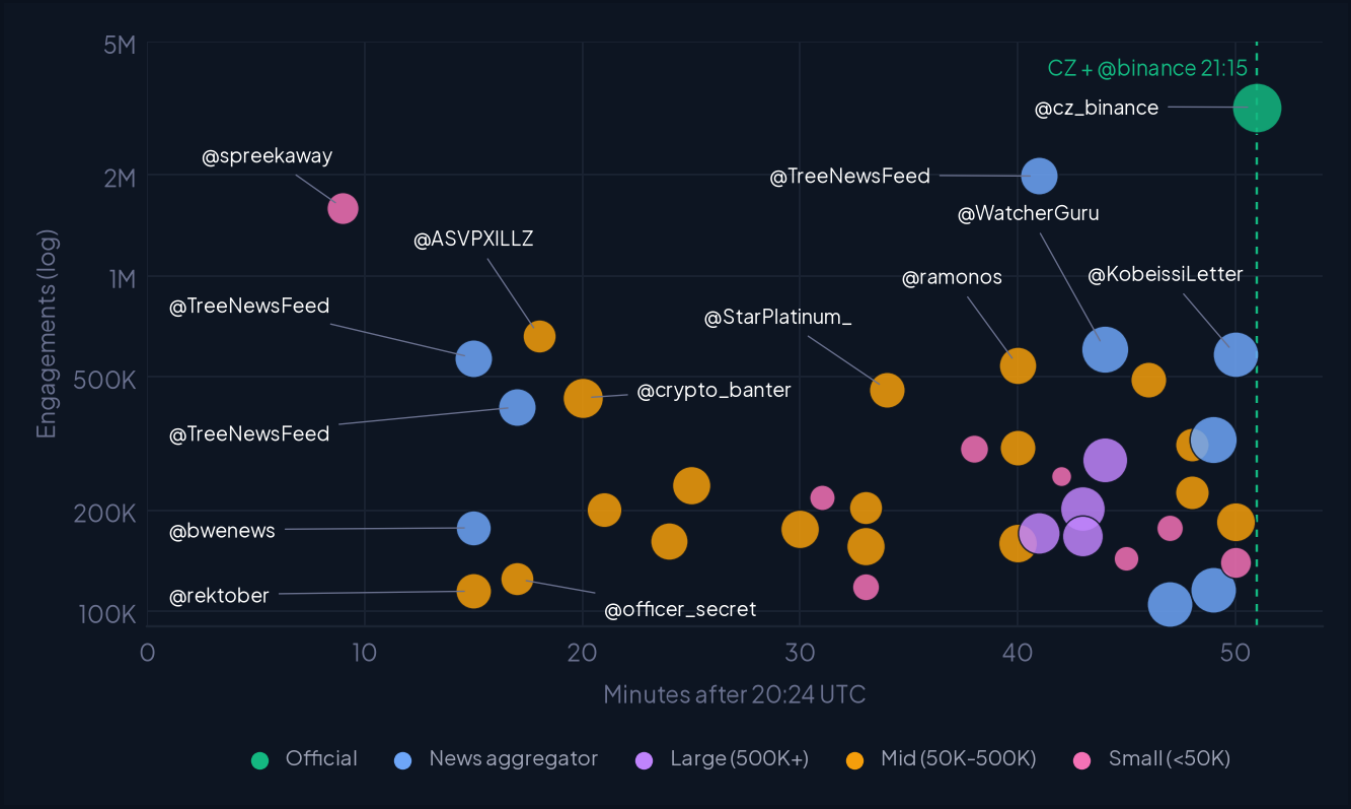
From +15 to +34 minutes, aggregators and mid-size accounts turned the alert into a number. @bwenews, @rektober and @crypto_banter repeated a reported "$2.53B in 60+ tokens"; @DarkWebInformer posted "$2.77 Billion" at +30 and @officer_secret "around $3.5B" at +32. At +18, @ASVPXILLZ said their own account had been compromised with about $3M withdrawn, an unverified individual claim, and drew 664K, more than any aggregator post in that window.

The first pushback came at +25 from @KillaXBT ("It's just fud", 238K). The first mechanism thread came at +30 from @odysseas_eth, an 8.7K-follower account whose EIP-7702 explanation drew 218K.

The freeze reached the feed before the company did. At 21:05 (+41), @TreeNewsFeed posted that Tether had frozen $971M USDT "WITH NO UPDATE FROM BINANCE STILL": 2.0M engagements, the largest post before Binance's first statement. @Deltaone (21:06) and @WatcherGuru (21:08, "No official statement from Binance yet", 605K) followed. At 21:15 @cz_binance quoted the TreeNewsFeed post and drew 3.2M, the biggest single post of the event; @binance's first statement in the same minute drew 95K.

By posting time, sampled posts published before CZ's earned 32 percent of the 55.4M engagements on all 686 sampled event-window posts; posts from the first 60 minutes earned 43 percent. The framing (hack, multi-billion figure, issuer freeze, company silence) was set before the first Binance voice appeared.

## BEFORE BINANCE SPOKE




Every sampled post over 100K engagements published through 21:15 UTC, when Binance first spoke.

## FIRST-HOUR SEQUENCE: POSTS THAT PASSED 100K ENGAGEMENTS

| MINUTES AFTER 20:24 (UTC) | ACCOUNT (FOLLOWERS) | CLASS | ENG. | WHAT IT SAID |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **+8 (20:32)** | @spreekaway (39.5K) | Small | 1.6M | Possible hack, wallet drained, unconfirmed |
| **+15 (20:39)** | @TreeNewsFeed (198K) | Aggregator | 570K | Potential Binance hack ongoing, on-chain |
| **+15 (20:39)** | @bwenews (92.3K) | Aggregator | 177K | Hot wallet drained for about $2.53B (its estimate), unconfirmed |
| **+18 (20:42)** | @ASVPXILLZ (54.1K) | Mid | 664K | Own account compromised, about $3M (unverified user claim) |
| **+25 (20:49)** | @KillaXBT (241K) | Mid | 238K | "It's just fud" |
| **+30 (20:54)** | @odysseas_eth (8.7K) | Small | 218K | EIP-7702 mechanism thread |
| **+32 (20:56)** | @officer_secret (53.9K) | Mid | 204K | Around $3.5B across chains (its estimate) |
| **+41 (21:05)** | @TreeNewsFeed (198K) | Aggregator | 2.0M | Tether freezes $971M USDT, no update from Binance |
| **+44 (21:08)** | @WatcherGuru (4.9M) | Aggregator | 605K | Tether freeze, no official statement from Binance yet |
| **+51 (21:15)** | @cz_binance (13.0M) | Official | 3.2M | User funds are safe, does look like a hack |

## WHAT THE POSTS SAID

> 612,729,468 $USDT (612,130,218 USD) transferred from #Binance to unknown wallet
> **@whale_alert · 20:23 UTC · 50K**

> Entire Binance wallet drained into new EOA. Contract call was funded by Tornado Cash
> **@spreekaway · 20:32 UTC · 1.6M**

> My Binance account appears to have been compromised just now, with approximately $3M USD in funds withdrawn without my authorization.
> **@ASVPXILLZ · 20:42 UTC · 664K**

> It's just fud. @Binance are good.
> **@KillaXBT · 20:49 UTC · 238K**

## TAKEAWAYS

### The 51-minute gap became the headline

39 posts published before any Binance-linked account spoke passed 100K engagements each. The first institutional fact the crowd received was Tether's freeze, packaged with "no update from Binance". The silence was written into the most-engaged pre-statement post (2.0M).

### Interpretation traveled, raw alerts did not

Whale Alert's automated transfer posts were early and drew 40K to 90K engagements each. A 39.5K-follower account calling it a possible hack drew 1.6M. Small on-chain accounts with high engagements per follower were the earliest layer that moved attention.

## NEXT 24 TO 72 HOURS

**1** Binance's post-mortem: whether it confirms or corrects the first-hour EIP-7702 framing, and whether the correction approaches 1.6M engagements.

**2** More unverified user claims like @ASVPXILLZ's would shift the story from a hot wallet loss to account security.

**3** The "EIP7702" keyword (1 to 27 posts in 24 hours): growth means the vector story is spreading to other wallets.

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# Who carried the reach

## Mid and small accounts drew 37 percent of sampled engagement, twice the official accounts

Official accounts posted the single biggest posts of the night, but the volume of attention moved through news aggregators and the crowd. Follower count was a poor guide to who traveled furthest.

**37.0%**
Mid and small accounts' share, sampled

**18.8%**
Official accounts' share, sampled

**14.9**
Engagements per follower, @TreeNewsFeed

The story traveled through aggregators and the crowd more than through institutions. Of 55.4M engagements on 686 sampled event-window posts, news aggregators took 29.0 percent (16.1M on 103 posts) and mid-size accounts with 50K to 500K followers 25.0 percent (13.9M on 245). Official accounts (Binance, CZ, Yi He, Tether's CEO and other company accounts) took 18.8 percent (10.5M on 28).

Small accounts under 50K followers took 12.0 percent (6.6M on 239), large accounts over 500K 9.9 percent (5.5M on 69), and Elon Musk 5.4 percent (3.0M on two posts). Mid and small accounts together drew 37.0 percent, about twice the official share. Per post the order flips: official posts averaged 373K, aggregators 156K, large accounts 80K, mid 57K and small 28K.

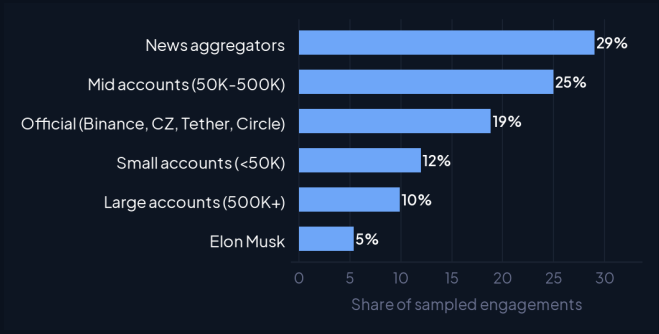
@cz_binance led the event window with 6.0M on 7 posts, then @WatcherGuru (4.9M on 10) and @KobeissiLetter (4.0M on 8). Over 24 hours @binance was the largest creator at 12.9M across 148 posts, including routine posts before the event: 11.3 percent of the topic's 114.2M. The top 10 creators held 39.2 percent; 60.8 percent came from everyone else.

@TreeNewsFeed, with 198K followers, drew 3.0M on 3 posts: 14.9 per follower. @spreekaway drew 40.4, @ASVPXILLZ 12.3 and @0xQuit 6.0 across its four posts. @cz_binance drew 0.46, @binance 0.14 on its eight sampled posts and Elon Musk, with 241.5M followers, 0.01. Large accounts sat near or below 1.

The crowd carried both the calm and the alarm. @0xngmi (197K followers) put losses net of the USDT and USDC freezes at "around ~1bn" against $144B of assets under custody (621K); @cz_binance quoted it at 22:23 with "Loss might be a bit higher than that, but will cover" (926K). @digitalbuzzfab, a 20.7K-follower account, posted "TAKE YOUR MONEY OUT OF BINANCE [translated from Spanish]" at 21:31 and drew 454K, 21.9 per follower. @coinbase's "Coinbase is safe and secure" drew 329K at 22:43.

Aggregators also reframed. Elon Musk's "Everyday is Zeroday" at 22:33 (2.1M) quoted @KobeissiLetter's $5.7B post. Thirteen minutes later @WatcherGuru reposted it as "Elon Musk says 'everyday is zeroday' following Binance hack" (401K), turning an ambiguous post into a hack headline.

### ENGAGEMENT BY ACCOUNT CLASS




Share of sampled engagement by account class.

### TOP 10 CREATORS IN THE EVENT WINDOW (SAMPLED POSTS)

| CREATOR (CLASS) | ENG. (POSTS) | FOLLOWERS | ENG. PER FOLLOWER | FIRST POST UTC |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **@cz_binance (official)** | 6.0M (7) | 13.0M | 0.46 | 21:15 |
| **@WatcherGuru (aggregator)** | 4.9M (10) | 4.9M | 0.99 | 21:08 |
| **@KobeissiLetter (aggregator)** | 4.0M (8) | 2.7M | 1.49 | 21:14 |
| **@elonmusk (individual)** | 3.0M (2) | 241.5M | 0.01 | 22:33 |
| **@TreeNewsFeed (aggregator)** | 3.0M (3) | 198K | 14.94 | 20:39 |
| **@binance (official)** | 2.3M (8) | 16.1M | 0.14 | 21:15 |
| **@spreekaway (small)** | 1.6M (1) | 39.5K | 40.41 | 20:32 |
| **@whale_alert (aggregator)** | 1.3M (26) | 2.8M | 0.47 | 20:23 |
| **@heyibinance (official)** | 1.1M (11) | 653K | 1.63 | 21:17 |
| **@paoloardoino (official)** | 1.0M (1) | 362K | 2.84 | 21:25 |

### WHAT THE POSTS SAID

> Entire Binance wallet drained into new EOA. Contract call was funded by Tornado Cash
> **@spreekaway · 20:32 UTC · 1.6M**

> TETHER FREEZES $971M USDT IN LIKELY BINANCE HACK, WITH NO UPDATE FROM BINANCE STILL
> **@TreeNewsFeed · 21:05 UTC · 2.0M**

> ...with USDT and USDC frozen the total loss now is around ~1bn, which is only 0.69% of their total assets under custody
> **@0xngmi · 21:26 UTC · 621K**

> TAKE YOUR MONEY OUT OF BINANCE [translated from Spanish]
> **@digitalbuzzfab · 21:31 UTC · 454K**

TAKEAWAYS

### Aggregators acted as the wire

News aggregators drew 29.0 percent of sampled engagement; @WatcherGuru, @KobeissiLetter and @TreeNewsFeed drew 11.9M between them. Their dollar figures became the night's reference numbers, ahead of the on-chain sources and company statements behind them.

### Follower count did not predict reach

@binance, with 16.1M followers, drew 0.14 engagements per follower on its sampled event-window posts; @spreekaway, with 39.5K, drew 40.4. Ranking accounts by engagements per follower on recent posts surfaces the first-hour framers a follower-count list misses.

NEXT 24 TO 72 HOURS

1 Top-10 creator concentration (39.2 percent of 24h engagement): rising means officials and aggregators are taking over; falling means the crowd.

2 Engagement per @binance update, down from 904K (21:29) to 156K (00:52): a recovery means readers are returning to the source.

3 Small-account withdrawal calls like "TAKE YOUR MONEY OUT OF BINANCE [translated from Spanish]", especially in other languages, as withdrawals reopen.

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# The official response

## Binance's statement saying funds were safe drew 904K; three without that line averaged 91K

Binance's founder, co-founder and corporate account each told the story their own way in the first five hours. The founder carried the most reach.

**3.2M**
CZ's 21:15 post, event's biggest

**904K**
@binance post with 'User funds are completely safe'

**91K**
Average of three earlier statements

The biggest post of the event came from a founder who says he no longer manages the exchange. At 21:15 UTC @cz_binance wrote that user funds were safe and "It does look like a hack on Binance", thanked Tether ($971M) and Circle ($823M), and said that "as a shareholder" he expected all user funds to be fully covered. Quoting @TreeNewsFeed's freeze headline, it drew 3.2M engagements.

In the sampled event-window posts, CZ's 7 drew 6.0M, @binance's 8 drew 2.3M and Yi He's (@heyibinance) 11 drew 1.1M. @binance's last post before the event, at 19:59, was a Write to Earn promotion (225K).

@binance posted holding statements at 21:15, 21:16 and 21:24 that drew 95K, 93K and 85K, an average of 91K. At 21:29 it added one sentence, "User funds are completely safe." That post drew 904K. The 21:16 version had said "At this stage, we have not confirmed any impact to user funds"; @WatcherGuru quoted it at 21:27 and drew 323K, more than three times Binance's own post.

Timing counted as much as wording. The 21:29 post came after CZ's, and @binance's identical withdrawal notices at 22:15 and 22:33 drew 141K and 351K.

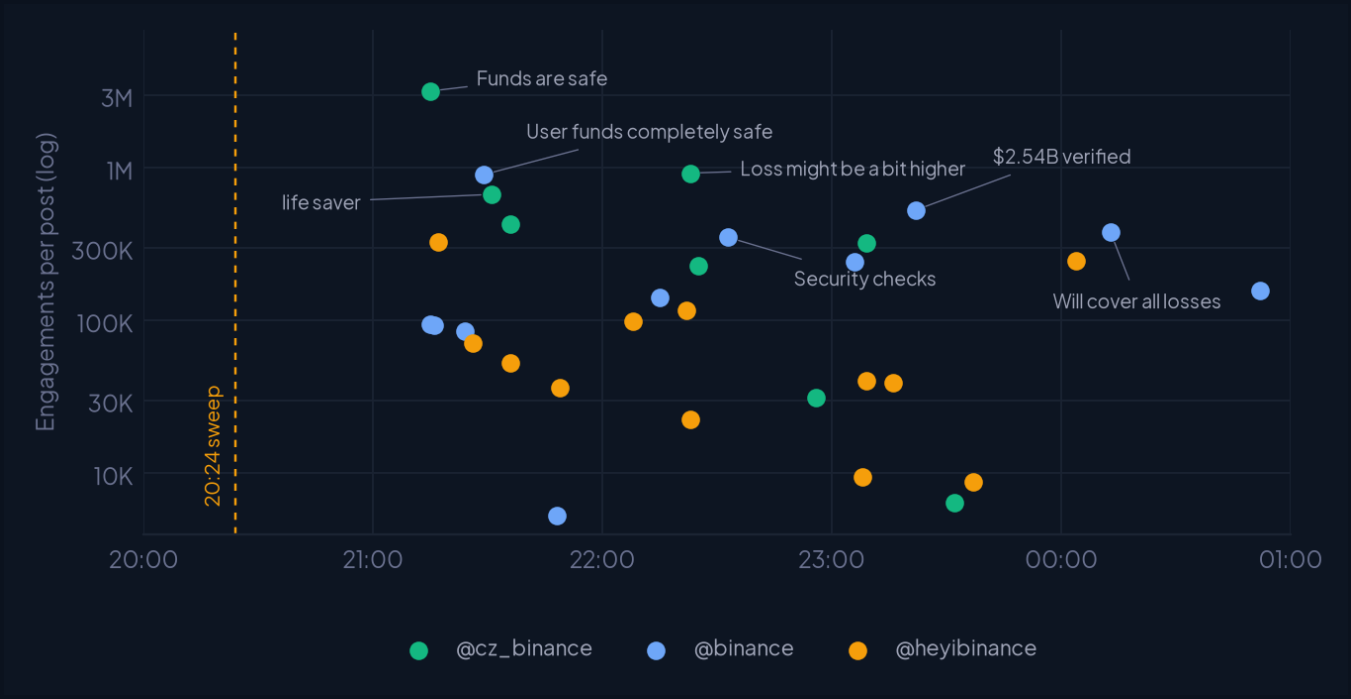
CZ's replies thanked the issuers: Tether's CEO (21:31, "life saver", 671K), Circle (21:36, 426K), the USD1 freeze (22:25, 229K) and Ripple (23:09, 321K). At 22:23 he quoted @0xngmi's estimate of about $1B in net losses after freezes: "Loss might be a bit higher than that, but will cover" (926K). The corporate account matched that at 00:13, "Binance will cover all losses" (378K), nine minutes after Yi He's "Binance will cover all hacking losses" (245K).

Yi He handled operations and partners. Her 21:17 holding statement drew 329K, more than any of @binance's three. She thanked Ripple at 22:08 for freezing "approximately 200 million" (100K) and World Liberty Financial at 22:22 for "$27m USD1 frozen and 48m (~$2m) WLFI frozen" (117K). @binance answered "references to $1.8 billion" at 23:22 with a verified frozen figure of $2.54 billion (529K), then at 00:52 "around $3 billion" (156K).

Official reach thinned as the audience grew. @binance's updates drew 904K at 21:29, 529K at 23:22, 378K at 00:13 and 156K at 00:52, while the topic rose to 27.5x baseline at 00:00. Its 21:48 notice blaming withdrawal

issues on “a technical error” drew 5.3K, the night’s lowest; by 22:15 the wording was “security checks”. Official accounts drew 18.8 percent of sampled engagement.

## EVERY OFFICIAL POST




Every post by @cz_binance, @binance and @heyibinance, log scale.

## OFFICIAL POST LEDGER, OCT 29 TO 30 (UTC)

| UTC | ACCOUNT | WHAT IT SAID | ENG. |
|---|---|---|---|
| **21:15** | @cz_binance | User funds are safe, does look like a hack; thanks Tether ($971M) and Circle ($823M) | 3.2M |
| **21:15 to 21:24** | @binance | Three holding statements, no funds-safe line | 95K / 93K / 85K |
| **21:17** | @heyibinance | Aware of reports, actively investigating | 329K |
| **21:29** | @binance | Same statement plus “User funds are completely safe” | 904K |
| **22:08 / 22:22** | @heyibinance | Thanks Ripple (~200 million) and WLFI ($27m USD1) for freezes | 100K / 117K |
| **22:15 / 22:33** | @binance | Identical notice: security checks, withdrawals resume when resolved | 141K / 351K |
| **22:23** | @cz_binance | Loss might be a bit higher than that, but will cover | 926K |
| **23:22** | @binance | Differing figures; verified frozen total $2.54 billion | 529K |
| **00:04 / 00:13** | @heyibinance / @binance | Binance will cover all (hacking) losses; deposits and withdrawals suspended | 245K / 378K |
| **00:52** | @binance | Verified total frozen around $3 billion | 156K |

## WHAT THE POSTS SAID

> It does look like a hack on Binance. Appreciate the quick freeze from Tether (~$971m) and Circle (~$823m).
> **@cz_binance · 21:15 UTC · 3.2M**

> At this stage, we have not confirmed any impact to user funds.
> **@binance · 21:16 UTC · 93K**

> Our teams are aware of reports of a potential security issue and are actively investigating. User funds are completely safe.
> **@binance · 21:29 UTC · 904K**

> Loss might be a bit higher than that, but will cover.
> **@cz_binance · 22:23 UTC · 926K**

## TAKEAWAYS

### The funds line traveled

The @binance statement adding "User funds are completely safe" drew 904K against 91K for three versions without it. It also followed CZ's 3.2M post, and identical later notices varied 2.5x on timing alone. Plain reassurance outperformed hedged holding language.

### The founder's account outran the company

@cz_binance drew 6.0M in the sampled event-window posts against 2.3M for @binance, and his thank-you replies (229K to 671K) outdrew most corporate statements. CZ made his commitments "as a shareholder"; the corporate "Binance will cover all losses" came at 00:13.

## NEXT 24 TO 72 HOURS

1 Binance's full post-mortem: whether it states a loss figure, and whether it approaches the 904K of the 21:29 statement.

2 The frozen total, revised from $2.54 billion (23:22) to around $3 billion (00:52): further revisions mean issuers are still freezing.

3 @binance notices reopening deposits and withdrawals, measured against the 378K of the 00:13 suspension post.

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# Narrative forks

## The freeze outran the FTX script: freeze posts drew 21.2M engagements, insolvency talk 318K

Within an hour of the sweep, the crowd had four stories to pick from: a theft, a record, a rescue and a run. Three gathered reach in the first five hours; the run never left the margins.

**21.2M**
Freeze-post engagements, sampled posts

**318K**
Insolvency and FTX-comparison engagements

**1 to 403**
“largest hack” posts, prior 24h vs 24h

The theft dominated; the second-biggest story was a rescue, not a panic. LunarCrush matched the 686 most-engaged event-window posts against a set of narrative themes (a post can match several). In the sampled posts, 525 using hack or drain language drew 43.4M engagements. Next came 188 posts on Tether and Circle freezing funds, with 21.2M, more than twice the 9.5M on “funds are safe” or SAFU posts. Freeze posts averaged about 113K each, the highest of any theme.

The freeze frame arrived before Binance spoke: @TreeNewsFeed’s 21:05 headline that Tether had frozen $971M drew 2.0M, ten minutes before the first official post, and Tether CEO @paoloardoino’s 21:25 post that Tether froze “more than 1.567B USDT” drew 1.03M.

The record frame rose late: 119 sampled posts using largest, biggest or record language drew 12.2M and peaked at 22:00, an hour after most themes. Its fuel was the dollar figure: @WatcherGuru’s 21:42 “over $5.6 billion stolen” (1.98M) and @KobeissiLetter’s 21:58 outflows of “−$5.7 billion” (2.22M), both on-chain tallies.

The keyword “largest hack” went from 1 post in the prior 24 hours to 403, with 5.4M engagements and an X sentiment of 13, the most negative phrase tracked. It would be the largest crypto hack on record only if confirmed; Binance had confirmed no loss figure by the cut.

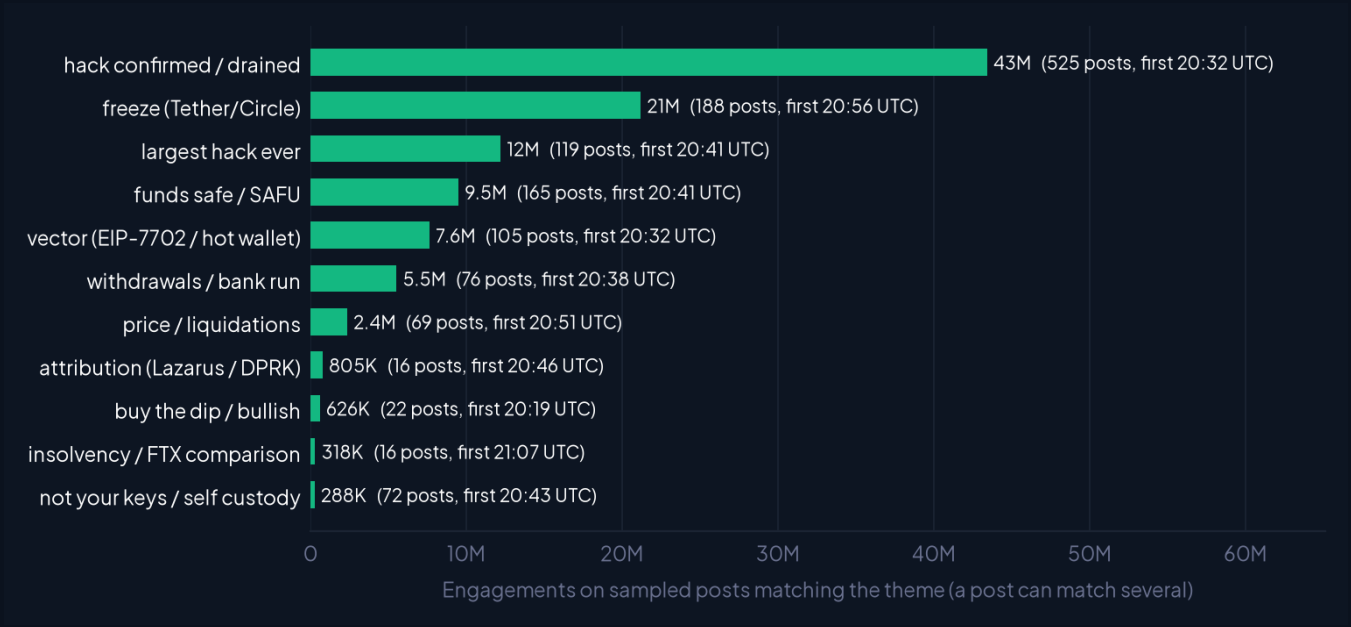
The FTX script did not run. Insolvency and FTX-comparison posts numbered 16 in the sample, with 318K engagements, about 20K each. “Bank run” rose from 164 posts to 236 in 24 hours. The two most direct FTX comparisons, at 22:19 and 22:55, drew 20.5K and 47.5K. @0xngmi’s 21:26 estimate that net loss after freezes was “around ~1bn”, 0.69 percent of assets under custody, drew 621K, about seven times the top insolvency post (88K).

Two frames had volume without reach. “Not your keys” and self-custody posts numbered 72 in the sample but drew 288K, about 4K each, the lowest of any theme; the keyword rose from 286 to 946 posts with 428K engagements, roughly 450 per post against about 13,400 for “largest hack”. Attribution drew 16 sampled posts

and 805K. One 20:46 post speculating about a state-linked group drew 33.9K, and attribution keywords barely moved against “binance hack”, which went from 1 to 4,152 posts.

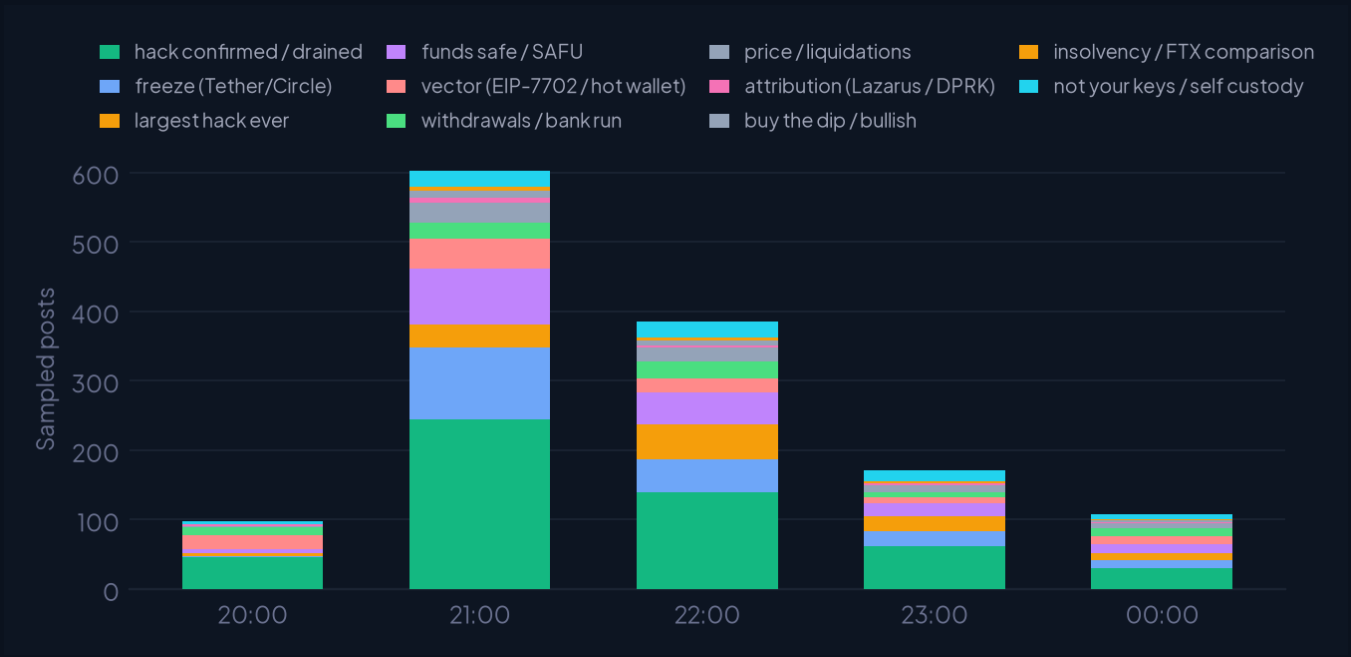
The technical story came first and stayed specialist. The vector theme (EIP-7702 delegation, hot wallets) appeared at 20:32 in @spreekaway’s first viral post and drew 7.6M across 105 sampled posts; “hot wallet” posts rose from 227 to 1,680, while “EIP7702” reached 27. Buy-the-dip posts numbered 22, with 626K, led by @GordonGekko’s 22:00 thread (166K). At the cut, 4.6 hours in, the leading reading was a theft contained by issuers and covered by Binance; deposits and withdrawals stayed suspended per Binance’s 00:13 post.

THEMES BY ENGAGEMENT



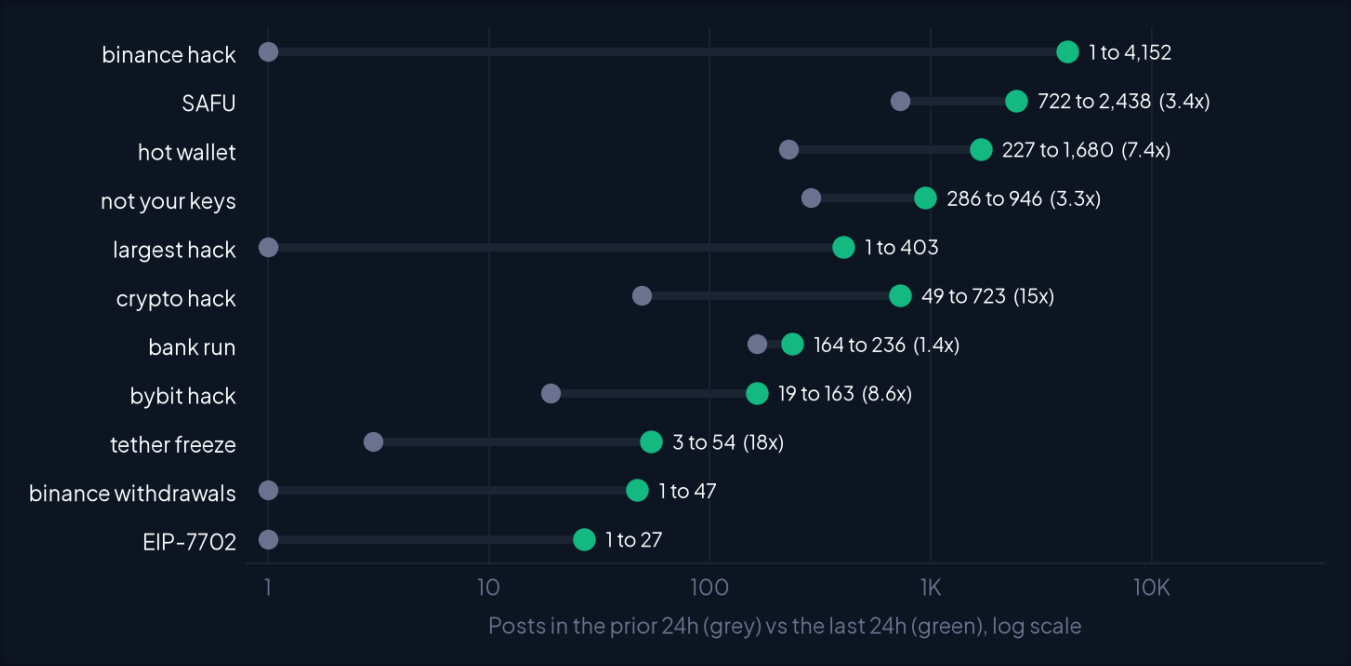

Keyword-matched themes in the sampled posts.

## THEMES BY HOUR




Theme mentions by posting hour.

## PHRASES, 24H VS PRIOR 24H




Rolling 24h post counts, last 24h vs prior 24h. Log scale.

## NARRATIVE THEMES IN THE SAMPLED POSTS, 20:14 UTC TO CUT

| THEME | SAMPLED POSTS | ENG. | FIRST SEEN (UTC) | PEAK HOUR (UTC) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Hack / drained | 525 | 43.4M | 20:32 | 21:00 |
| Freeze (Tether, Circle) | 188 | 21.2M | 20:56 | 21:00 |
| Largest hack ever | 119 | 12.2M | 20:41 | 22:00 |
| Funds safe / SAFU | 165 | 9.5M | 20:41 | 21:00 |
| Vector (EIP-7702, hot wallet) | 105 | 7.6M | 20:32 | 21:00 |
| Withdrawals / bank run | 76 | 5.5M | 20:38 | 22:00 |
| Attribution speculation | 16 | 805K | 20:46 | 21:00 |
| Buy the dip / bullish | 22 | 626K | 20:19 (pre-event) | 21:00 |
| Insolvency / FTX comparison | 16 | 318K | 21:07 | 21:00 |
| Not your keys / self custody | 72 | 288K | 20:43 | 21:00 and 22:00 |

## WHAT THE POSTS SAID

> TETHER FREEZES $971M USDT IN LIKELY BINANCE HACK, WITH NO UPDATE FROM BINANCE STILL
> **@TreeNewsFeed · 21:05 UTC · 2.0M**

> Tether froze more than 1.567B USDT related to a potential Binance exchange hack.
> **@paoloardoino · 21:25 UTC · 1.03M**

> BREAKING: Binance has been hacked with wallets across the Ethereum, Bitcoin, and TRON networks seeing outflows of –$5.7 billion.
> **@KobeissiLetter · 21:58 UTC · 2.22M**

> with USDT and USDC frozen the total loss now is around ~1bn, which is only 0.69% of their total assets under custody
> **@0xngmi · 21:26 UTC · 621K**

## TAKEAWAYS

### The run vocabulary barely moved

"Bank run" posts rose from 164 to 236 in 24 hours, and insolvency posts drew 318K engagements in the sampled posts against 21.2M for freezes. Prolonged suspended withdrawals are the condition under which that frame grows.

### The superlative outran the source

The "largest hack" frame drew 12.2M engagements in the sampled posts, built on tracker estimates of $5.6B (per @WatcherGuru) and $5.7B (per @KobeissiLetter). Binance had confirmed no loss figure by the cut; @0xngmi put net exposure after freezes near $1B.

## NEXT 24 TO 72 HOURS

1 "Bank run" posts while withdrawals stay suspended: above 328 per 24h, double the pre-event day of 164, would mean the FTX frame is waking.

2 "Largest hack" posts (403 in 24h) after Binance publishes a loss figure, and whether a lower confirmed number gets comparable reach.

3 An official attribution from investigators would open a new fork; in the event window attribution drew 16 sampled posts and 805K engagements.

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# The sentiment regime

## Binance sentiment fell to 53 at 21:00, from a prior-week average of 80

Sentiment fell hard for Binance, Tether and Bybit and barely moved for BNB or Bitcoin. In the sampled posts the crowd split close to evenly; official reassurance kept the score above 50.

**53**
Binance sentiment low, 21:00 UTC

**79**
BNB sentiment, unchanged through event

**50%**
Positive share, sampled crowd excluding officials

Opinion on Binance dropped fast but did not collapse. Sentiment is the engagement-weighted share of non-neutral engagement that was positive, 0 to 100. Binance averaged 80 across the 162 baseline hours and never fell below 76 in the prior week. It read 67 at 20:00, 53 at 21:00 (the week's lowest hourly reading), then 58, 61 and 57. Oct 29 UTC scored 63 for the day, against post-event lows of 48 for Bybit in Feb 2025, 32 for Binance in Nov 2022 and 29 for FTX.

The tilt was broad and shallow. In the 686 sampled posts, 275 scored below neutral on the 1 to 5 post scale and carried 17.2M engagements, 31 percent of sampled engagement; only 78 scored below 2.8, with 3.9M. The most negative high-reach posts restated tracker estimates: @Kalshi_Crypto's 21:43 "over $5.6B stolen" (138K) scored 2.14. "Largest hack" carried a sentiment of 13 on X across 403 posts; "user funds are safe" carried 89 across 1,636 posts and 7.3M engagements.

Official posts supplied much of the positive weight. In the sample, official accounts (Binance, @cz_binance, @heyibinance, Tether's CEO) drew 10.4M positive-scored engagements and no negative ones; CZ's 21:15 post (3.2M) scored 3.27. Elon Musk's two sampled posts added 3.0M positive, including "Everyday is Zeroday". Without them the crowd split almost exactly even: 17.4M positive, 17.2M negative, a 50 percent share. Small accounts leaned negative, 3.4M against 1.6M.

Distrust was targeted. Tether fell from a prior-week 83 to 59 at 22:00 and USDC from 85 to 71 by 00:00. Bybit fell from 75 to 47 at 22:00 as "bybit hack" posts rose from 19 to 163.

The crowd separated the exchange from its token and from other exchanges. BNB stayed between 78 and 81 every event hour; Bitcoin moved from 69 to a low of 66 and the crypto category from 74 to 71. Kraken rose from 81 to about 91 and OKX from 77 to 80.

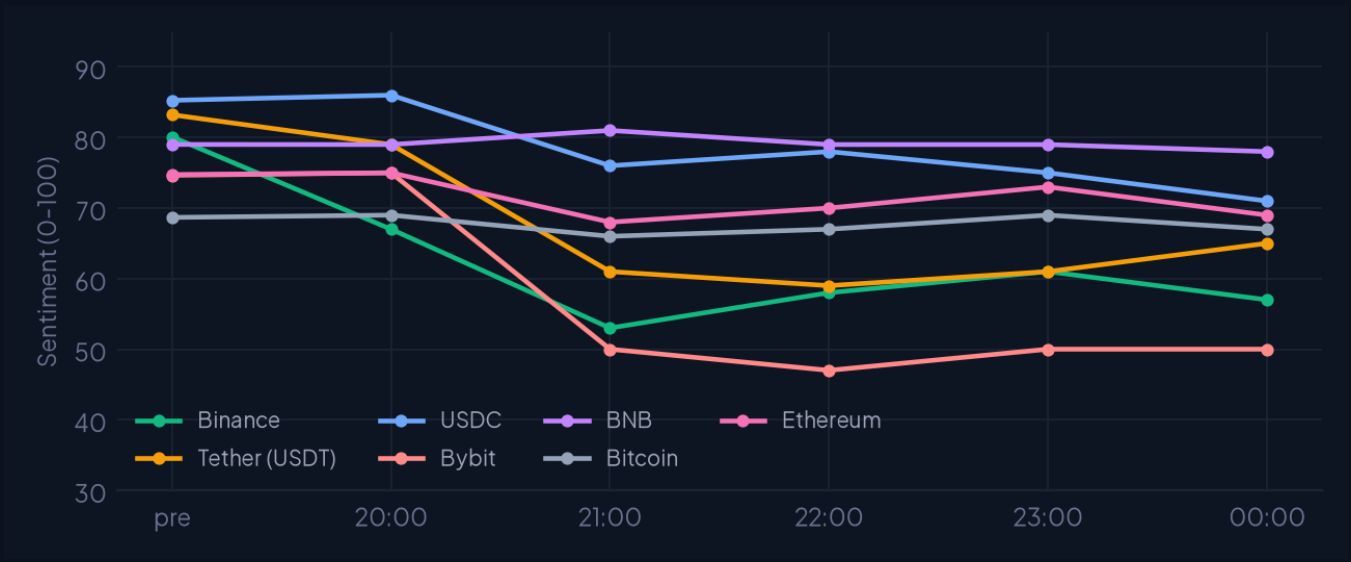
By network, Reddit was most negative at 51 over 24 hours, against 67 on X and TikTok, 70 on YouTube and 76 on Instagram; news scored 61 on 12 posts. Sampled Reddit posts averaged 2.86 on the 1 to 5 scale against 2.99 on X. For three full hours after the low, Binance sentiment held between 57 and 61.

## SENTIMENT, SEVEN DAYS



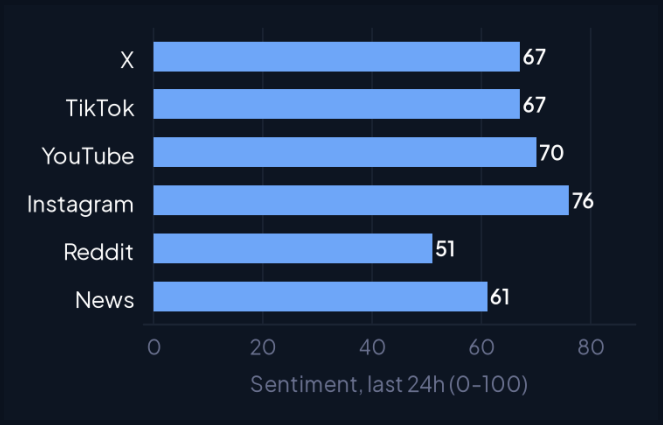

Engagement-weighted sentiment per hour, 0 to 100.

## SENTIMENT BY HOUR AND TOPIC

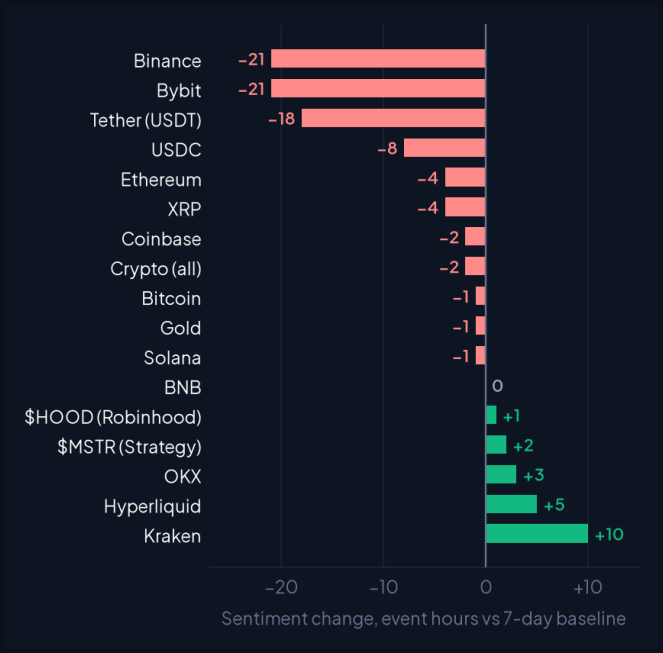



Sentiment per hour for Binance and related topics; ‘pre’ is the 7-day mean.

## SENTIMENT BY NETWORK




## SENTIMENT CHANGE BY TOPIC




Binance topic, last 24h. Right: Event hours vs 7-day mean.

## SENTIMENT BEFORE AND DURING THE EVENT, BY TOPIC

| TOPIC | PRIOR-WEEK AVG | EVENT-HOURS AVG (20:00 TO 00:00) | EVENT LOW (UTC HOUR) |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Binance** | 80 | 59 | 53 (21:00) |
| **Tether (USDT)** | 83 | 65 | 59 (22:00) |
| **USDC** | 85 | 77 | 71 (00:00) |
| **Bybit** | 75 | 54 | 47 (22:00) |
| **Ethereum** | 75 | 71 | 68 (21:00) |
| **Bitcoin** | 69 | 68 | 66 (21:00) |
| **BNB** | 79 | 79 | 78 (00:00) |
| **Crypto (all)** | 74 | 72 | 71 (00:00) |
| **Kraken** | 81 | 91 | 90 (22:00) |

## WHAT THE POSTS SAID

> It does look like a hack on Binance. Appreciate the quick freeze from Tether (~$971m) and Circle (~$823m).
> **@cz_binance · 21:15 UTC · 3.2M**

> It's just fud. @Binance are good.
> **@KillaXBT · 20:49 UTC · 238K**

> BREAKING: Binance hacked with over $5.6B stolen
> **@Kalshi_Crypto · 21:43 UTC · 138K**

> im confused ... is Binance SAFE or HACKED??
> **@inno_sol · 21:10 UTC · 177K**

TAKEAWAYS

### Reassurance is carrying the score

Official accounts supplied 10.4M positive-scored engagements in the sampled posts and no negative ones; without them and Elon Musk's two posts, the sampled crowd split about evenly. Binance's 53 to 61 band rests partly on its own messaging.

### BNB's own score did not move

BNB's sentiment stayed between 78 and 81 in event hours, against a prior-week 79, while the Binance topic fell to 53. BNB's price fell about 6 percent from 20:15 to 20:50, per CoinMarketCap via CryptoTicker.

NEXT 24 TO 72 HOURS

1 Binance hourly sentiment against the 53 low: a new low after withdrawals reopen means the crowd is turning on Binance.

2 Tether's score, 65 at 00:00 from 83: whether freezes keep reading as rescue or start reading as control risk.

3 Negative replies and quotes on official posts would weaken the support under the score.

18 · CHAPTER

# The newcomers

## At 21:00, 49 percent of active Binance posters were first-timers: 6,538 vs 293 a normal hour

First-time posters are accounts posting about Binance for the first time in LunarCrush's lookback. In the first full hour they were nearly half of everyone active on the topic, and by 00:00 the spam share had halved.

**22.3x**
First-time posters at 21:00 vs baseline

**49%**
First-time share of active creators, 21:00

**5.4%**
Spam share at 00:00, from 10.7%

The first hour was written largely by people who had never posted about Binance before. In a normal hour 293 accounts post on the topic for the first time in LunarCrush's lookback, about 5 percent of 5,697 active creators. At 21:00 UTC there were 6,538 first-time posters, 22.3 times baseline, of 13,449 active creators: 49 percent. From 20:00 to 00:59 UTC, 22,330 first-time posters joined, 15.2 times the baseline rate (the 20:00 hour includes 24 pre-exploit minutes).

Arrivals were front-loaded. First-time posters fell each hour, from 6,538 to 5,629, 4,662 and 3,726, while active creators rose from 13,449 to 17,471, 20,248 and 22,735, and the first-time share slid from 49 to 16 percent. An account counts as first-time only once, so part of that is mechanical; the rest is a standing crowd that kept engaging as hourly engagements climbed to 27.8M at 00:00.

Over 24 hours 29,329 accounts posted on Binance, up 158 percent from 11,361, and LunarCrush's 24-hour count of first-time posters reached 23,581, 3.7 times the prior day's 6,303: 80 percent of creators against 55 percent a day earlier. That 24-hour figure is a separate measure from the hourly counts above, which total 22,330 for 20:00 to 00:59. Oct 29 UTC, with 3.6 event hours, logged 26,626 active creators, more than Binance's two bigger-engagement days of the year (17,448 on Mar 18, 9,752 on Jul 12) and about twice the 13,314 on Bybit's peak day in Feb 2025.

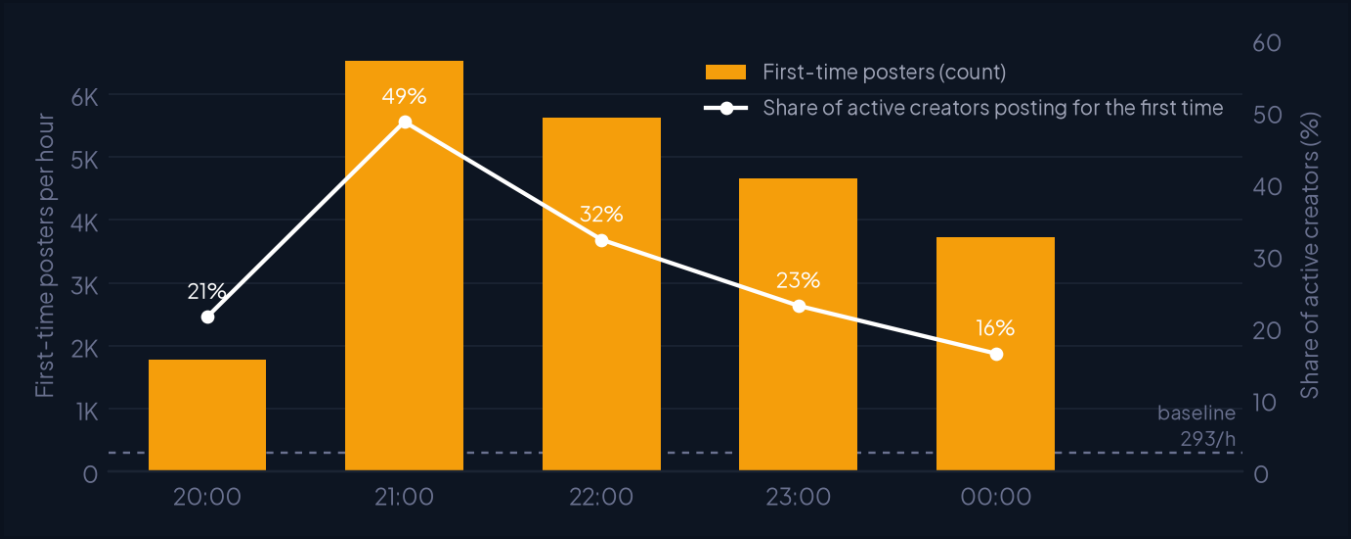
The newcomers came for the exchange and its stablecoin rails: first-time posters on Tether rose 6.5 times (261 to 1,694), while BNB (4,039 to 4,966) and Bitcoin (23,231 to 27,786) rose about 20 percent.

Spam did not keep up. In a normal hour 1,024 spam-flagged posts make up 10.7 percent of active Binance posts. Spam roughly doubled to 2,014 at 00:00, but active posts rose from about 9,600 an hour to 37,092, so the flagged share fell steadily to 5.4 percent. This window was cleaner than an ordinary Binance hour.

Small accounts held the floor. In the sampled posts, 239 from accounts under 50K followers drew 6.6M engagements, and 15 passed 100K. @spreekaway (39.5K followers) supplied the first viral alert at 20:32 (1.6M);

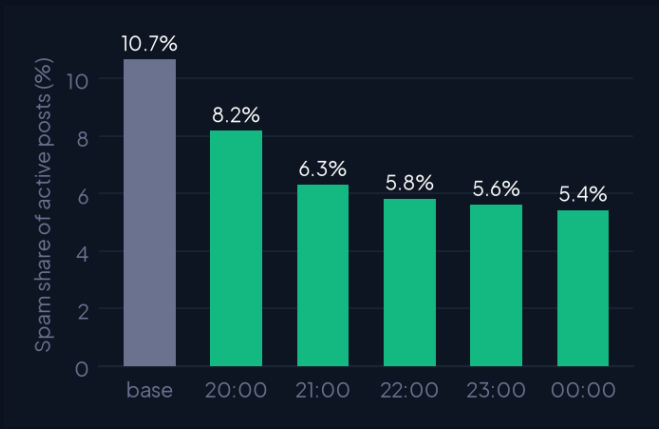
@NPC_68 (3.2K followers) explained at 21:06 why frozen stablecoins mattered (253K); @inno_sol asked whether Binance was “SAFE or HACKED” (177K); @digitalbuzzfab told Spanish-speaking readers to take their money out (454K). Loss estimates then ran from $2.53B (per @bwenews at 20:39) to $5.7B (per @KobeissiLetter at 21:58).

### FIRST-TIME POSTERS




Accounts posting on Binance for the first time in LunarCrush’s lookback.

### SPAM SHARE




Spam-classified share of active posts.

## FIRST-TIME POSTERS AND SPAM ON THE BINANCE TOPIC, BY HOUR

| HOUR (UTC) | FIRST-TIME POSTERS | ACTIVE CREATORS | FIRST-TIME SHARE | SPAM SHARE |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Baseline (avg hour) | 293 | 5,697 | 5.2% | 10.7% |
| Oct 29 20:00 | 1,775 | 8,256 | 21.5% | 8.2% |
| Oct 29 21:00 | 6,538 | 13,449 | 48.6% | 6.3% |
| Oct 29 22:00 | 5,629 | 17,471 | 32.2% | 5.8% |
| Oct 29 23:00 | 4,662 | 20,248 | 23.0% | 5.6% |
| Oct 30 00:00 | 3,726 | 22,735 | 16.4% | 5.4% |

## WHAT THE POSTS SAID

> Entire Binance wallet drained into new EOA. Contract call was funded by Tornado Cash
> **@spreekaway · 20:32 UTC · 1.6M**

> The Binance hacker is depositing stolen $USDT on Aave and borrowing $ETH against it. ... USDT can be frozen by Tether. ETH can't.
> **@NPC_68 · 21:06 UTC · 253K**

> im confused ... is Binance SAFE or HACKED??
> **@inno_sol · 21:10 UTC · 177K**

> TAKE YOUR MONEY OUT OF BINANCE [translated from Spanish]
> **@digitalbuzzfab · 21:31 UTC · 454K**

## TAKEAWAYS

### A new audience, unanchored

Nearly half the accounts active on Binance at 21:00 had never posted about it. They arrived while loss figures ran from $2.53B (per @bwenews) to $5.7B (per @KobeissiLetter), none confirmed by Binance.

### The surge was organic

Spam-flagged posts doubled in absolute terms, yet their share of active Binance posts fell from 10.7 percent to 5.4 percent by 00:00. Post and creator counts from this window are less distorted than in a normal Binance hour.

## NEXT 24 TO 72 HOURS

1 First-time posters per hour: falling toward 293 by +24h fits a short shock; a second spike marks a new wave.

2 Active creators (22,735 at 00:00) holding above 10,000 an hour after first-timers fade means the new audience stayed.

3 Spam share above the 10.7 percent baseline would mean opportunist accounts catching up.

19 · CHAPTER

# Where it lived

## X carried 96 percent of 114.2M engagements; on TikTok, Russian and Spanish beat English

Almost the entire first night happened on X, where on-chain trackers and aggregators work in real time. Median video posting times ran 39 to 60 minutes behind X, and when they did, much of the audience was not English-speaking.

**109.8M**
X engagements in 24h, of 114.2M

**+8 min**
First human hack claim on X

**12**
News articles indexed in 24h

The Binance story lived on X. Of the topic's 114.2M engagements in the 24 hours to the 01:00 UTC cut, 109.8M (96.1 percent) came from X, along with 48,977 of 53,181 posts (92.1 percent). TikTok added 2.5M, YouTube 1.9M, Reddit 35K, Instagram 9K, and news, which counts published articles, 46.7K across 12 articles.

X was first because chain readers post there. Whale Alert's bot posted a pre-sweep transfer alert at 20:23, 612.7M USDT moving "from #Binance to unknown wallet", and a run of BTC outflow alerts from 20:30 to 20:33. The first human claim in the sample was @spreekaway at +8 minutes (1.6M on a 39.5K-follower account), then TreeNewsFeed and bwenews at +15. About half of the 442 hack-related X posts sampled after 20:24 (227) landed in the 21:00 hour; the median came 79 minutes after 20:24.

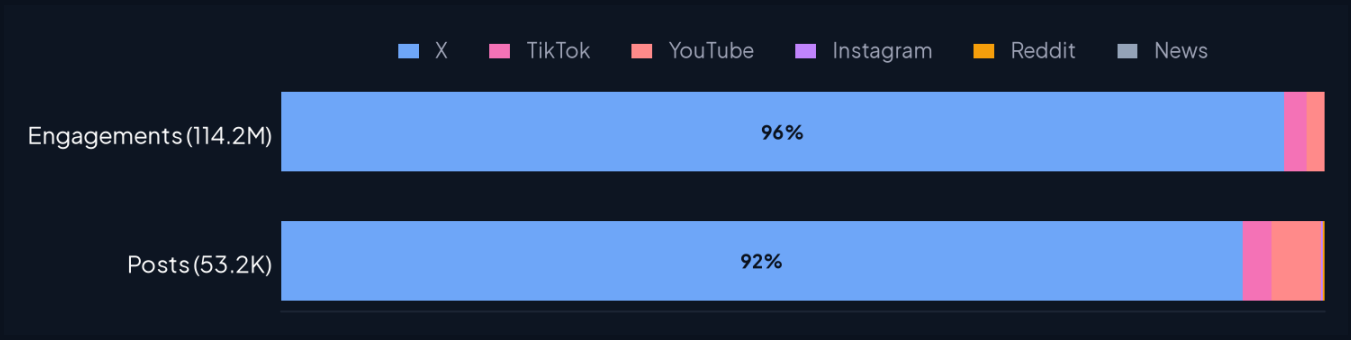
Video and forums ran slower. The first hack-related TikTok in the sample came at +19 minutes, the first YouTube video at +28 (@cryptobymathieu) and the first Reddit thread at +46. Median lags were 118 minutes for TikTok, 101 for Reddit and 139 for YouTube, against 79 for X. YouTube was still publishing at 00:00 (19 of 91 sampled videos) when X had dropped to 10 sampled posts.

The video networks reached a different audience. Among the event-window Binance TikToks, six Russian-language posts drew about 454K and 14 Spanish-language posts about 424K, against about 261K for 10 English posts. The biggest was @lorennews2's Russian post at 21:36 (209K), headlined that more than 3 billion had left the exchange. Among the 686 sampled posts, six in Arabic script drew 655K, more than eight in Chinese (438K).

YouTube's top video was a German live stream (40.1K) whose title was edited after the stream began to carry a dollar figure that appeared only later in the evening.

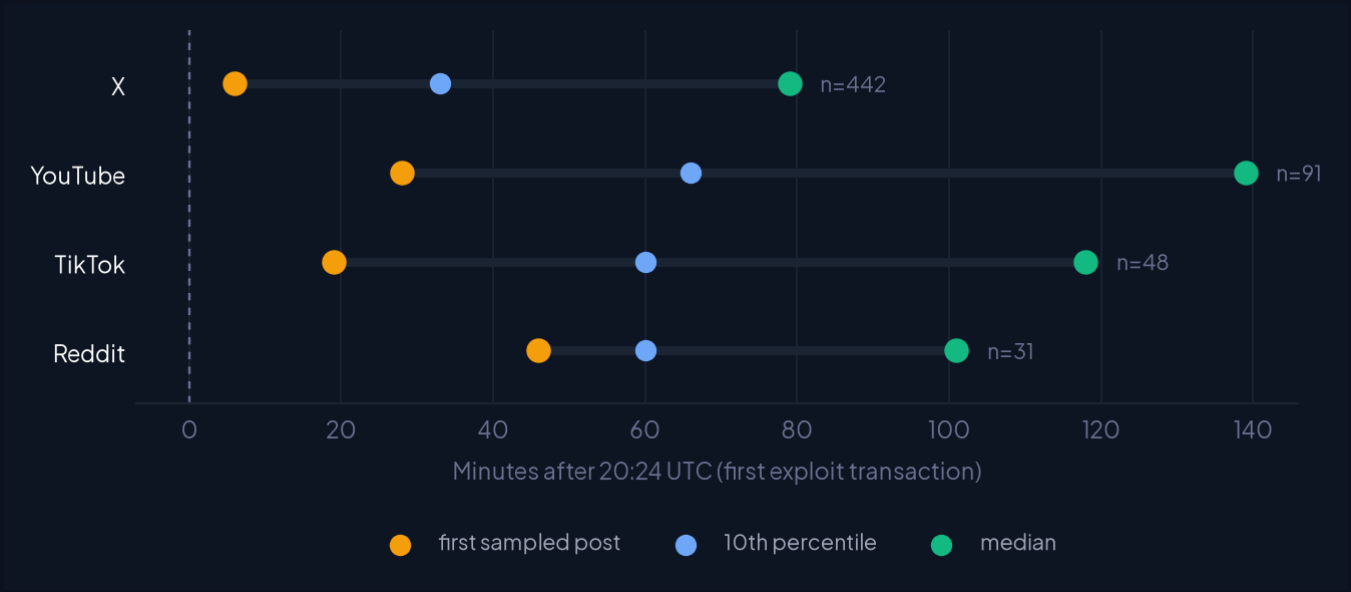
Reddit was the slowest text network and the most negative, at 51 over 24 hours: its first thread, at 21:09 (+46 minutes), was a one-line all-caps question asking whether Binance had been hacked. Reddit and Instagram counts were low (121 and 82 posts).

## ENGAGEMENTS AND POSTS BY NETWORK, 24H




Binance topic, last 24h.

## WHEN EACH NETWORK ARRIVED




Posting time of sampled posts, by network.

## BINANCE TOPIC BY NETWORK, 24H TO 01:00 UTC OCT 30

| NETWORK | POSTS / ENG. (24H) | SHARE OF ENG. | SENTIMENT (24H) | FIRST HACK POST / MEDIAN (SAMPLE) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **X** | 48,977 / 109.8M | 96.1% | 67 | +8 min / 79 min |
| **TikTok** | 1,476 / 2.5M | 2.2% | 67 | +19 min / 118 min |
| **YouTube** | 2,513 / 1.9M | 1.6% | 70 | +28 min / 139 min |
| **News** | 12 / 46.7K | 0.04% | 61 | none in sample |
| **Reddit** | 121 / 35K | 0.03% | 51 | +46 min / 101 min |
| **Instagram** | 82 / 9K | 0.01% | 76 | none in sample |

## WHAT THE POSTS SAID

> 612,729,468 $USDT (612,130,218 USD) transferred from #Binance to unknown wallet
> **@whale_alert · 20:23 UTC · 50.5K**

> Entire Binance wallet drained into new EOA. Contract call was funded by Tornado Cash
> **@spreekaway · 20:32 UTC · 1.6M**

> MORE THAN 3 BILLION LEFT THE EXCHANGE [translated from Russian]
> **@lorennews2 (TikTok) · 21:36 UTC · 209K**

> Billions of dollars left wallets linked to Binance, setting off alarms over a historic hack. [translated from Spanish]
> **@franciscofrias.oficial (TikTok) · 22:22 UTC · 130K**

## TAKEAWAYS

### X for speed, video for spread

In the sample, the first 19 minutes were visible only on X, in bot alerts and on-chain posts. The second wave, an hour or two later, ran on TikTok and YouTube, led by Russian- and Spanish-language posts and mostly carrying the biggest loss figures.

### News coverage lagged the social record

By the 01:00 UTC cut, LunarCrush had indexed 12 news articles worth 46.7K engagements, against 109.8M on X, for a story four and a half hours old and past its peak publishing hour.

## NEXT 24 TO 72 HOURS

1 Binance news article count, 12 in 24h: past 100 means newsrooms have caught up.

2 Non-English TikTok and YouTube posts still citing $5.6B to $5.8B after Binance's ~$3B frozen update: if they keep appearing, the gross estimates are outliving Binance's own figures.

3 Reddit sentiment, 51 and lowest: staying near 50 while X recovers means the slower crowd is not buying the reassurance.

20 · CHAPTER

# The freeze became the story

## Tether's engagements hit 79.8x baseline, nearly 3x Binance's own peak, as freezes took over

Within 41 minutes of the sweep, the story was also about what stablecoin issuers could stop. The freeze became the night's second-largest theme and the main thing official accounts had to say.

**79.8x**
Tether topic, 22:00 UTC vs baseline

**21.2M**
Engagements on freeze posts (sample)

**1.03M**
Paolo Ardoino's single freeze post

The issuers' freezes turned a wallet drain into a second story. Tether's topic, normally about 33.4K engagements an hour, reached 2.7M in the 22:00 UTC hour: 79.8 times baseline, the highest multiple of the topics tracked and nearly three times Binance's 27.5x peak. USDC rose 14.0x by 00:00, to 5.1M an hour; Tether's base is small, and in absolute terms USDC added more per hour.

The freeze figures arrived before Binance spoke. @TreeNewsFeed posted "TETHER FREEZES $971M USDT" at 21:05 (2.0M), @WatcherGuru repeated it at 21:08 (605K), Whale Alert logged an address holding 971,149,299 USDT as frozen at 21:11, and WatcherGuru reported Circle freezing $823M of USDC at 21:13 (326K). Binance's first post came at 21:15.

The figure climbed by source. @WazzCrypto put the combined total at $1.8B at 21:12; Tether CEO Paolo Ardoino said at 21:25 that Tether "froze more than 1.567B USDT" (1.03M); Binance said at 23:22 that "the current verified total frozen is $2.54 billion" (529K), and at 00:52 "around $3 billion" (156K).

In the 686 sampled posts, the freeze theme drew 188 posts and 21.2M engagements, second only to "hack / drained" (43.4M) and ahead of "largest ever" (12.2M) and "SAFU / funds safe" (9.5M); 103 of the 188 landed in the 21:00 hour.

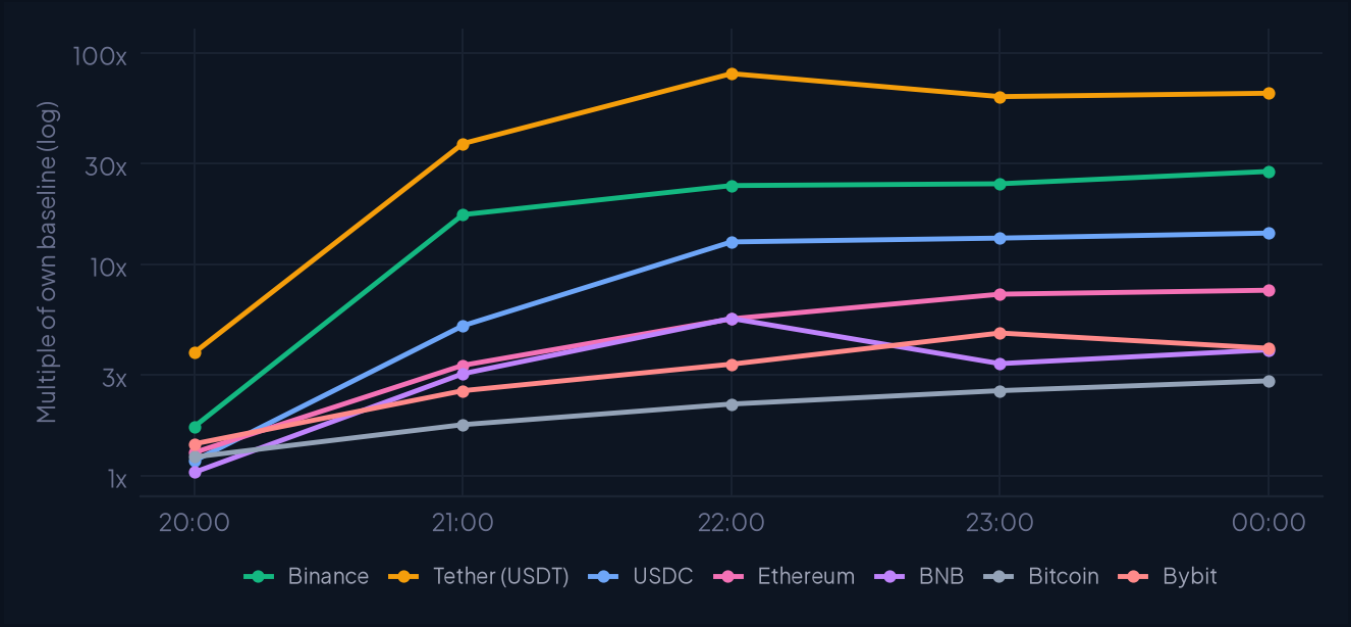
The freeze gave the official accounts their script. CZ's 21:15 post (3.2M) thanked Tether ($971M) and Circle ($823M) in its second sentence. Yi He (@heyibinance) thanked Tether at 21:26 and 21:36, Ripple for freezing "approximately 200 million" at 22:08 (99.7K) and World Liberty Financial for $27M of USD1 at 22:22 (117K). @ZachWitkoff's USD1 freeze note reached 264K.

A counter-narrative ran alongside. @NPC_68 (253K on a 3.2K-follower account) wrote at 21:06 that the attacker was borrowing ETH on Aave against USDT: "USDT can be frozen by Tether. ETH can't." @BalaiBB made the same point at 22:09 (451K). Per on-chain checks reported by CryptoTicker, about 195,460 ETH sat

untouched in a separate address as of 01:11 UTC and roughly 700M USDT moved before the freeze; Aave froze its USDT market (per @WatcherGuru, 21:52, 222K).

Tether's audience and tone shifted most. Over 24 hours its active creators rose from 486 to 1,985 and first-time posters from 261 to 1,694; from 20:00 to 00:59 UTC first-time posters ran 27.3x baseline. Tether's sentiment fell from 83 to 59 at 22:00 and was 65 at 00:00; USDC's moved from 85 to between 71 and 78. Over 24 hours USDT's price slipped 0.1 percent; USDC's was flat.

### RELATED TOPICS, HOUR BY HOUR




Hourly engagements as a multiple of each topic's 7-day mean, log scale.

### STABLECOIN TOPICS VS BINANCE, EVENT HOURS (UTC)

| METRIC | TETHER (USDT) | USDC | BINANCE |
|---|---|---|---|
| Baseline engagements per hour | 33.4K | 363K | 1.0M |
| Peak hour multiple (hour) | 79.8x (22:00) | 14.0x (00:00) | 27.5x (00:00) |
| Peak hour engagements | 2.7M | 5.1M | 27.8M |
| New posts, 5 event hours vs baseline | 15.8x | 3.7x | 14.0x |
| First-time posters, 5 event hours vs baseline | 27.3x | 4.6x | 15.2x |
| Sentiment baseline to 00:00 | 83 to 65 | 85 to 71 | 80 to 57 |
| Active creators, prior 24h to 24h | 486 to 1,985 | 6,969 to 10,274 | 11,361 to 29,329 |
| 24h price change | −0.1% | 0.0% | n/a |

## WHAT THE POSTS SAID

> TETHER FREEZES $971M USDT IN LIKELY BINANCE HACK, WITH NO UPDATE FROM BINANCE STILL
> **@TreeNewsFeed · 21:05 UTC · 2.0M**

> Tether froze more than 1.567B USDT related to a potential Binance exchange hack.
> **@paoloardoino · 21:25 UTC · 1.03M**

> USDT can be frozen by Tether. ETH can't.
> **@NPC_68 · 21:06 UTC · 253K**

> Thanks to the Ripple team for promptly freezing approximately 200 million. User Funds are SAFU.
> **@heyibinance · 22:08 UTC · 99.7K**

## TAKEAWAYS

### The freeze headline beat the exchange

Tether's $971M freeze was on X at 21:05, ten minutes before Binance posted, and drew 2.0M engagements. Binance and CZ adopted the freeze in their own messaging within minutes. Issuers acted as first responders in the public record.

### Frozen totals are not one number

The frozen figure moved from $971M (21:05) to $1.8B combined (21:12), 1.567B USDT from Tether alone (21:25), Binance's $2.54B (23:22) and then about $3B (00:52), each from a different source and scope.

## NEXT 24 TO 72 HOURS

1. Tether or Circle confirming totals that match Binance's ~$3B frozen figure; a mismatch restarts the numbers argument.
2. Tether sentiment, 65 at 00:00 against 83 baseline: above 75 within 72h means the freeze reads as protection.
3. Movement from the address holding about 195,460 ETH; ETH cannot be frozen.

21 · CHAPTER

# Exchange spillover

## Bybit fell from 75 to 47 as posts compared the hacks; Kraken and OKX rose, Coinbase slipped

First-night distrust stayed with Binance and the exchange it was most often compared to. Elsewhere in the category, the biggest movers had their own news that day, before the exploit.

**37.7%**
Binance share of exchange conversation, 24h

**75 to 47**
Bybit sentiment, baseline to 22:00 UTC

**6.5x**
Hyperliquid at 20:00, before Binance moved

Distrust did not spread across centralized exchanges on the first night. It stayed on Binance and on Bybit, venue of the last comparable hack. Across the five hourly buckets from 20:00 UTC, Bybit's new posts ran 8.4 times baseline and its first-time posters 9.2 times; its sentiment fell from 75 to 50 at 21:00 and 47 at 22:00. Its engagements peaked at 4.7x (1.5M an hour at 23:00). "Bybit hack" went from 19 posts to 163 in 24 hours.

Bybit was pulled in by comparison. Posts set the night's estimates beside its Feb 2025 loss of about $1.5B: @3orovik at 21:43 (88.6K), @TedPillows at 22:33 (66.1K) and Cointelegraph's "if confirmed" ranking at 22:33 (59.1K). One list post at 21:11 (315K) claimed Bybit and Bitget had also been hacked "today"; nothing in our sources supports that, and Bitget's 24h sentiment was 94. Bybit's Reddit sentiment was 48, its lowest network.

Kraken and OKX improved; Coinbase slipped slightly. Kraken's sentiment rose from 81 to between 90 and 92 in event hours and OKX's from 77 to between 79 and 81, while Coinbase's slipped to 75 to 76 from 78. OKX engagements peaked at 1.9x. Coinbase posted at 22:43 that it was "safe and secure" and had offered Binance support (329K).

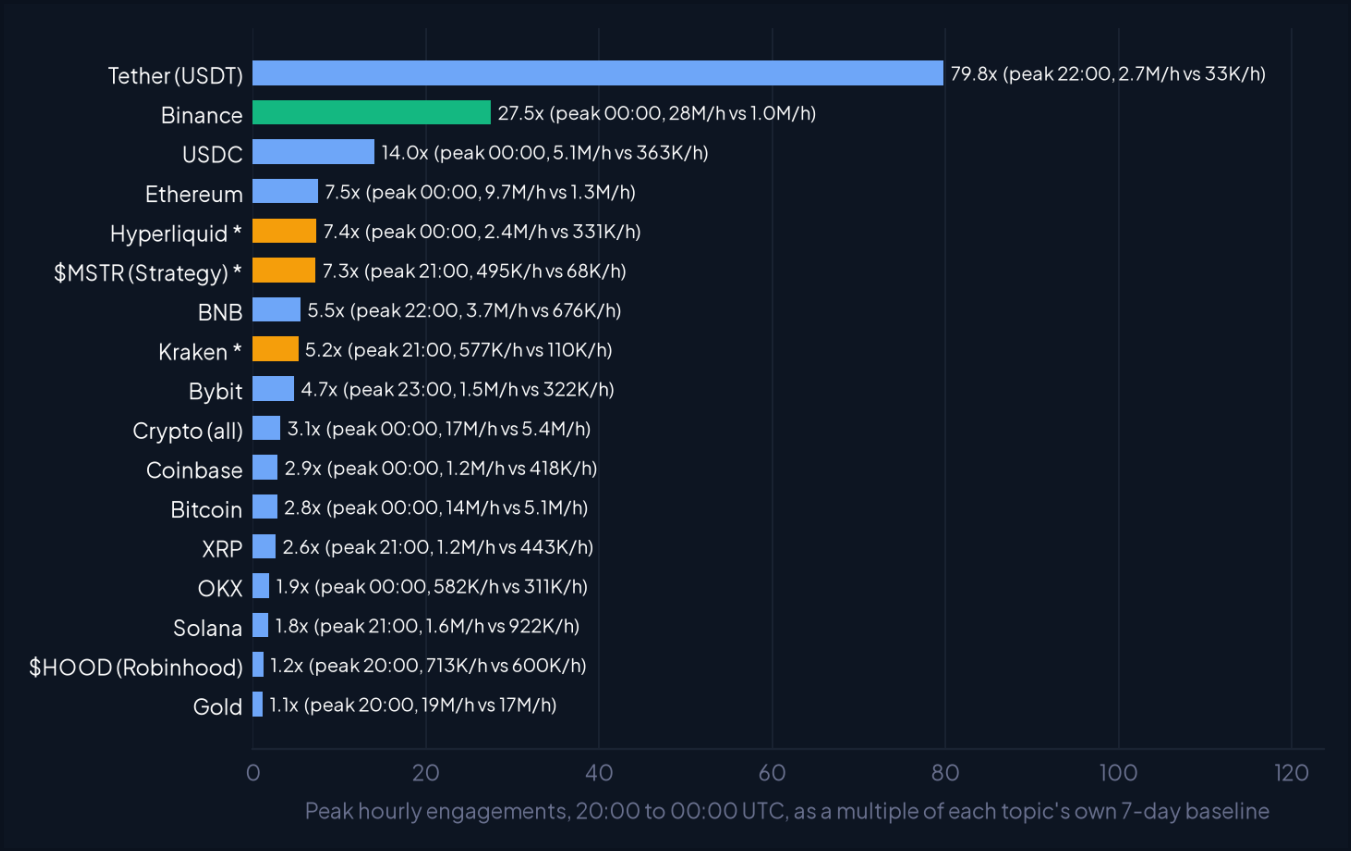
Kraken was already at 3.9x in the 20:00 hour, which includes 36 minutes after the sweep, when Binance itself was at 1.7x. Coinbase was at 2.1x after its Q3 earnings landed shortly after 20:00 UTC, with a post on insider 10b5-1 sale plans drawing 261K at 20:13; its 2.9x peak mixes earnings and Binance.

Hyperliquid's move predates the event. It was at 6.5x in the 20:00 hour and peaked within the event window at 7.4x at 00:00, but its busiest hour of the full day was 16:00 UTC, four hours before the exploit. Posts point to same-day news: Stan Druckenmiller and Elon Musk discussing it, an ICE and trade[XYZ] partnership, and @smileycapital's 20:57 "USA fully adopts Hyperliquid" (44.9K). Its 24h posts rose from 7,854 to 24,382 and its price 12.2 percent, per LunarCrush.

Over 24 hours Binance held 37.7 percent of exchange conversation (114M engagements), Hyperliquid 12.2 percent (36.7M in the exchanges category; 42.3M for its coin topic), MEXC 8.2, Bitget 4.7, Coinbase 4.5, Bybit

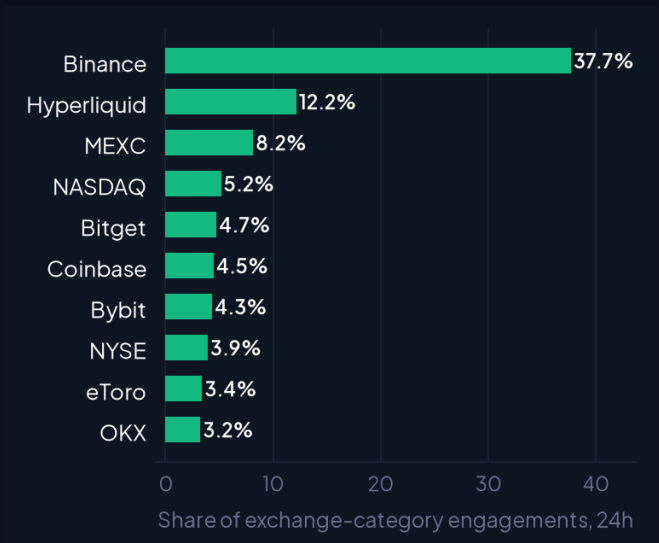
4.3, OKX 3.2 and Kraken 2.1. Binance's 24h sentiment of 67 was second lowest of 12 exchanges, above eToro (66); in the category's 24-hour scores Kraken read 97, MEXC 98, Bitget 94 and OKX 90.

### ATTENTION SPILLOVER




Peak hourly multiple, 20:00 to 00:00 UTC. Amber: already elevated at 20:00.

### SHARE OF EXCHANGE CONVERSATION




Share of the exchange category's engagements, last 24h.

## EXCHANGE TOPICS: PRE-EVENT SIGNAL, PEAK, TONE, VOLUME

| EXCHANGE | 20:00 / PEAK MULTIPLE (UTC) | SENTIMENT BASELINE TO EVENT-HOUR LOW | POSTS, PRIOR 24H TO 24H | SHARE OF EXCHANGE VOICE (24H) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Binance | 1.7x / 27.5x (00:00) | 80 to 53 | 21,913 to 53,181 | 37.7% |
| Hyperliquid (pre-elevated) | 6.5x / 7.4x (00:00) | 79 to 83 | 7,854 to 24,382 | 12.2% |
| Coinbase (earnings ~20:00) | 2.1x / 2.9x (00:00) | 78 to 75 | 10,067 to 13,222 | 4.5% |
| Bybit | 1.4x / 4.7x (23:00) | 75 to 47 | 2,704 to 4,534 | 4.3% |
| OKX | 1.7x / 1.9x (00:00) | 77 to 79 | 4,870 to 6,840 | 3.2% |
| Kraken (pre-elevated) | 3.9x / 5.2x (21:00) | 81 to 90 | 1,893 to 2,415 | 2.1% |

## WHAT THE POSTS SAID

> Coinbase is safe and secure. We're actively monitoring the Binance situation, and have reached out to their team to offer our support.
> **@coinbase · 22:43 UTC · 329K**

> The largest hack before today was Bybit, for $1.5 billion last year...
> **@3orovik · 21:43 UTC · 88.6K**

> Here's how it compares to the Bybit hack last year.
> **@TedPillows · 22:33 UTC · 66.1K**

> interesting timing for Binance hack, right as USA fully adopts Hyperliquid
> **@smileycapital · 20:57 UTC · 44.9K**

## TAKEAWAYS

### Bybit drew comparisons, not contagion

Bybit's sentiment drop coincided with posts measuring the night's figures against its Feb 2025 hack and with one unsupported 'Bybit hacked today' list post (315K). Kraken and OKX rose and Coinbase slipped only slightly: no category-wide flight narrative on the first night.

### Two exchanges were elevated in the 20:00 hour

Hyperliquid (6.5x) and Kraken (3.9x) were already elevated in the 20:00 UTC hour, which includes 36 minutes after the sweep, when Binance itself was at 1.7x. Hyperliquid had its own news that day; Coinbase, at 2.1x, was reporting earnings.

## NEXT 24 TO 72 HOURS

1 Bybit sentiment, 47 to 50 in event hours: back above 70 by +24h confirms the hit was comparison.

2 Claims that other exchanges were hacked: one unsupported list reached 315K; a second claim with on-chain evidence changes the picture.

3 Binance's 37.7% share of exchange voice against Hyperliquid's 12.2% while Binance withdrawals stay paused.

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# Bitcoin, BNB and the tape

## Binance drew 81 percent of Bitcoin's 24h engagements while Bitcoin itself rose only 2.8x

For one night an exchange's conversation came close to Bitcoin's, the largest topic in crypto. Bitcoin's own conversation grew without changing tone, and BNB's sentiment did not move.

**114M vs 141M**
Binance vs Bitcoin engagements, 24h

**+9.3M/h**
Bitcoin's added engagements at 00:00 UTC

**79**
BNB sentiment, before and during

The Binance story absorbed a large share of crypto's attention without changing how the rest of the market talked. In the 24 hours to the 01:00 UTC cut, Binance drew 114M engagements, 81 percent of Bitcoin's 141M and twice Ethereum's 55.9M; its median day over the past year is 20.6M. The general 'crypto' topic rose to 3.1 times baseline by 00:00 UTC (16.8M an hour against 5.4M).

Bitcoin's multiple looks small because its base is large. Its 2.8x peak at 00:00 on a 5.1M-an-hour baseline is 14.4M an hour, about 9.3M more every hour, against 26.8M more for Binance. Bitcoin climbed steadily (1.2x, 1.7x, 2.2x, 2.5x, 2.8x) and was still rising at the cut, with sentiment between 66 and 69 against a baseline of 69. Ethereum, where the reported 195K ETH sat unfrozen, rose to 7.5x (9.7M an hour), sentiment 68 to 73 against 75.

BNB holders did not turn. BNB's topic peaked at 5.5x at 22:00 (3.7M an hour against 676K) and its sentiment read 79 before the event and 78 to 81 in every event hour. Its new posts rose only 1.4 times, so most extra BNB engagement went to posts tagged BNB, led by CZ's. In Chinese, @giantcutie666 told 146K followers at 20:56 the funds came from a hot wallet and losses "would not be large" (our translation; 48.1K); @BenTodar's 21:28 post about selling out of crypto (47.6K) was the minority voice.

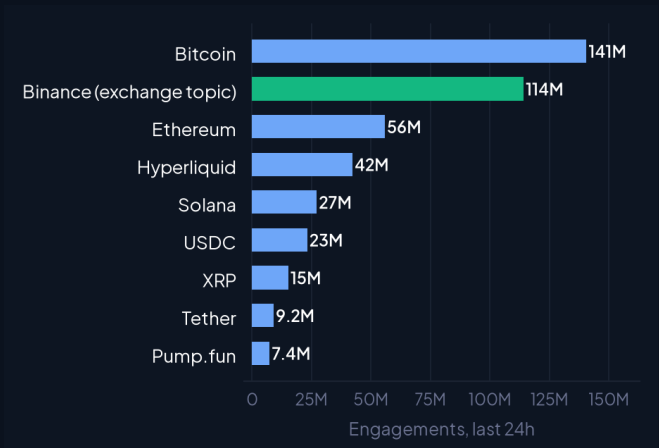
Per CoinMarketCap via CryptoTicker, BTC fell from $80,327 at 20:15 to $78,763 by 21:00 and to about $77.0K by 01:11; BNB fell from $738.90 at 20:15 to $692.32 by 20:50, about 6 percent, and was down 9.9 percent over 24 hours by 00:38. CoinGlass, via PANews, counted about $628M of liquidations in one hour. @WatcherGuru's 20:52 "Crypto market crashing" drew 532K.

The same hour carried US after-hours earnings, including Amazon and Intel (@amitisinvesting, 171K), Strategy's Q3 (@saylor at 20:05, 232K) and Coinbase's Q3. In the sampled posts, price and liquidations drew 2.4M engagements against 43.4M for hack and drained posts.

Outside crypto-native topics the event barely registered. Gold peaked at 1.1x at 20:00 and ran near 0.9x after, and $HOOD peaked at 1.2x at 20:00 before falling to 0.9x. $MSTR hit 7.3x at 21:00 but was already 6.1x at

20:00, the hour Saylor posted results; $COIN peaked at 2.9x on its earnings night; Hyperliquid, with a 12.2 percent price gain and 42.3M engagements, was already elevated at 20:00 UTC, before the event. Alphabet drew 378M engagements in 24 hours, more than three times Binance.

## TOP CRYPTO TOPICS, 24H




Cryptocurrencies by 24h engagements, Binance inserted for scale.

## TOP CRYPTO TOPICS BY 24H ENGAGEMENTS, WITH BINANCE

| TOPIC | 24H ENG. | 24H SENTIMENT | 24H PRICE CHANGE | EVENT PEAK VS BASELINE (UTC) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Bitcoin** | 141M | 72 | −4.9% | 2.8x (00:00) |
| **Binance (exchange)** | 114M | 67 | n/a | 27.5x (00:00) |
| **Ethereum** | 55.9M | 74 | −5.9% | 7.5x (00:00) |
| **Hyperliquid (pre-elevated)** | 42.3M | 90 | +12.2% | 7.4x (00:00); 6.5x at 20:00 |
| **Solana** | 27.3M | 82 | −7.4% | 1.8x (21:00) |
| **USDC** | 23.3M | 80 | 0.0% | 14.0x (00:00) |
| **XRP** | 15.3M | 81 | −7.8% | 2.6x (21:00) |
| **Tether** | 9.2M | 68 | −0.1% | 79.8x (22:00) |
| **Pump.fun** | 7.4M | 76 | −12.9% | not tracked |

## WHAT THE POSTS SAID

“ JUST IN: Crypto market crashing. $SOL falls under $96 $XRP falls under $1.25 $ETH falls under $2,250 $BTC falls under $78,500
**@WatcherGuru · 20:52 UTC · 532K**

“ today’s after hours is the ugliest print of Q3 earnings so far amazon, that small $2.7T company, wicked down 12% within seconds of the print
**@amitisinvesting · 21:05 UTC · 171K**

“ Strategy announces Q3 2026 results: $21 billion operating income, our largest quarter ever
**@saylor · 20:05 UTC · 232K**

“ What was stolen from Binance is a hot wallet; the losses won’t be large. [translated from Chinese]
**@giantcutie666 · 20:56 UTC · 48.1K**

TAKEAWAYS

### Read Bitcoin in absolute terms

A 2.8x Bitcoin multiple added about 9.3M engagements an hour, more than the whole BNB topic at its peak. Bitcoin's conversation was still rising at the cut while sentiment held near 69: more attention, same tone.

NEXT 24 TO 72 HOURS

1 Bitcoin's hourly multiple, 2.8x and rising at 00:00: above 4x through European hours means spread past crypto-native accounts.

2 BNB sentiment, steady at 79: below 70 while deposits and withdrawals stay suspended would show holders turning.

3 Buy-the-dip posts (22 sampled, 626K) against "bank run" (164 to 236 in 24h): whichever grows first sets day two.

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# How it compares

## Binance reached 27.5x baseline in four hours, past Bybit's 17.7x peak on twice the base

Against the Bybit hack, the FTX collapse and Binance's own 2022 and 2023 crises, this attention shock built faster and larger hour for hour than Bybit's, the only comparison with hourly data. Its sentiment floor, so far, is shallower than any of them.

**27.5x**
Binance peak full hour vs baseline

**17.7x**
Bybit hourly peak, Feb 2025

**87.2M**
Oct 29 engagements, 3rd biggest day

Against the Bybit hack, the one comparable with hourly data, the Binance event built faster and reached more than three times the absolute hourly attention. Four hours after onset the Binance topic drew 27.8M engagements in the 00:00 UTC hour, 27.5x its baseline of 1.0M an hour. Bybit's February 2025 hack peaked at 17.7x, six hours after onset.

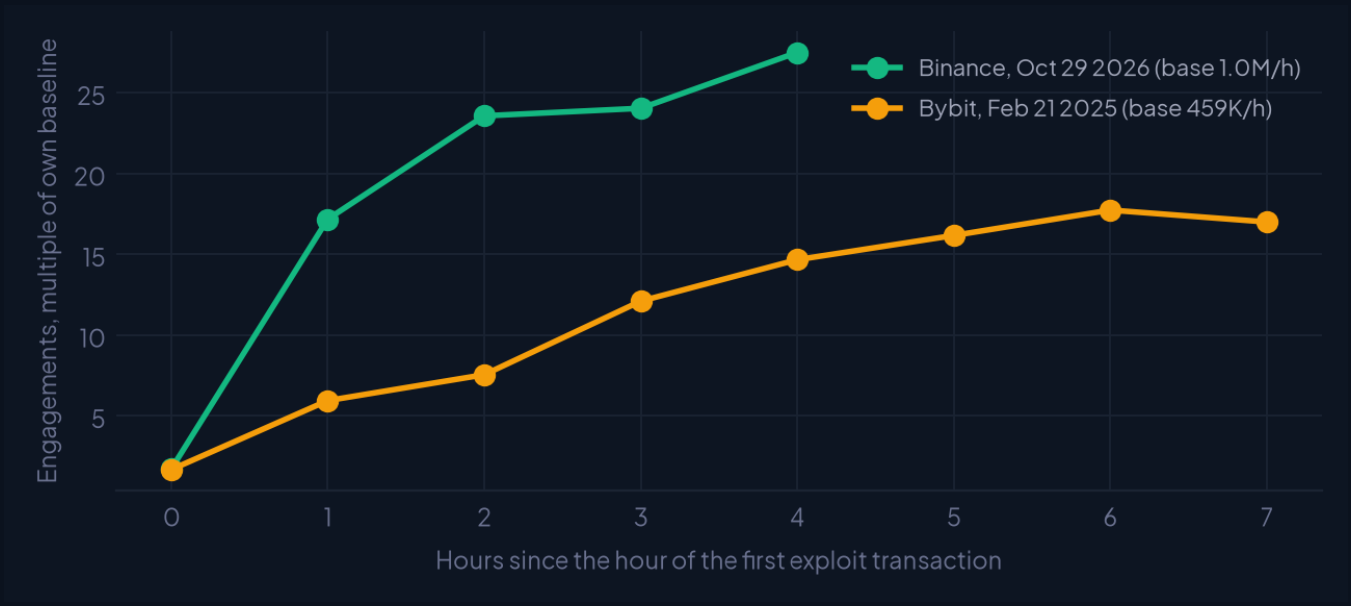
The bases differ. Bybit's hourly baseline was 459K; Binance's is 1.0M, 2.2x larger. Bybit's biggest hour drew 8.1M. Aligned to onset, Binance ran 17.2x against Bybit's 5.9x in the first hour and 23.6x against 7.5x in the second.

On daily figures, FTX's November 2022 collapse peaked at 124.5x on a baseline of only 634K a day; its peak day was 78.9M. Binance's November 2022 stress peaked at 4.9x, and the November 2023 plea and settlement at 5.5x on a 21.7M base, with a 118.1M peak day. Bybit's peak day was 135.6M (8.5x). Those are daily figures; the Binance comparison above is hourly until Oct 30 closes.

Against Binance's own year, Oct 29 UTC, with about three and a half event hours, closed at 87.2M engagements: the third biggest day of the past 365 and 4.2x the median day of 20.6M. Only Jul 12 (161.3M) and Mar 18 (152.4M) were larger.

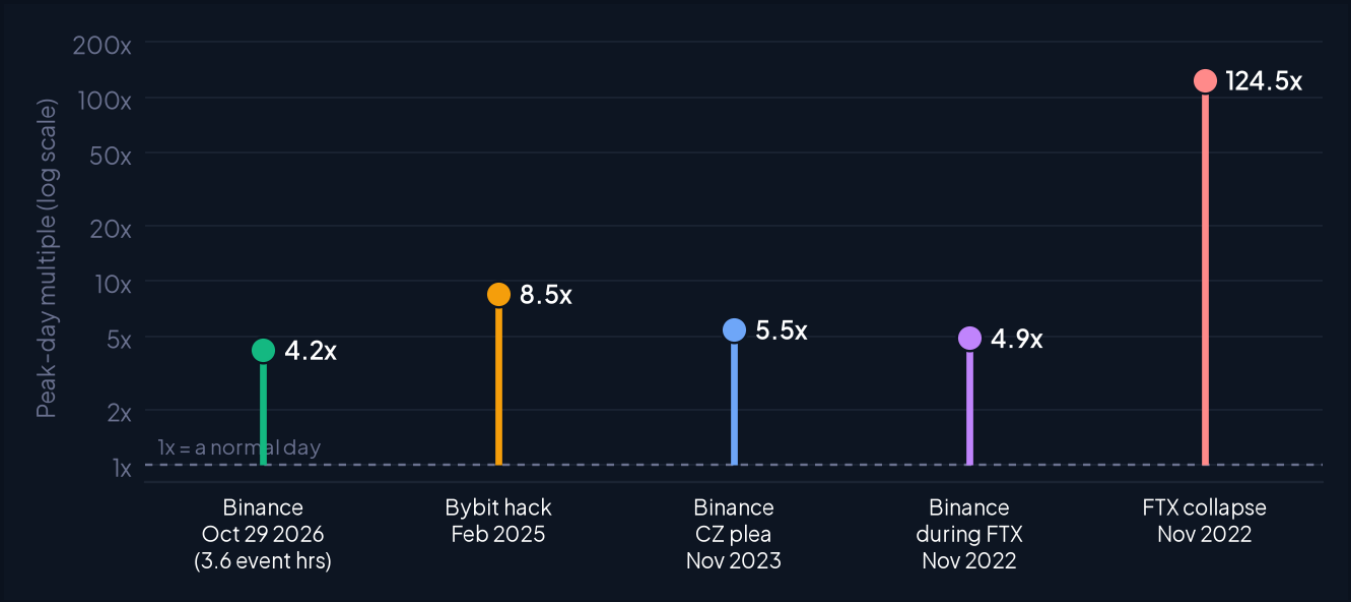
Sentiment is where the event departs from history. On daily scores, Binance's Oct 29 reading of 63 sits above every comparable floor: FTX at 29, Binance at 32 in November 2022, Binance at 41 in November 2023 and Bybit at 48. Hour for hour, Binance bottomed at 53 at 21:00 UTC against Bybit's hourly low of 44. Large accounts called this the biggest hack in crypto history; by gross outflow it would be, if the reported figures are confirmed. @KobeissiLetter's 21:58 post (2.2M) said 'if confirmed'.

## HOUR FOR HOUR VS BYBIT



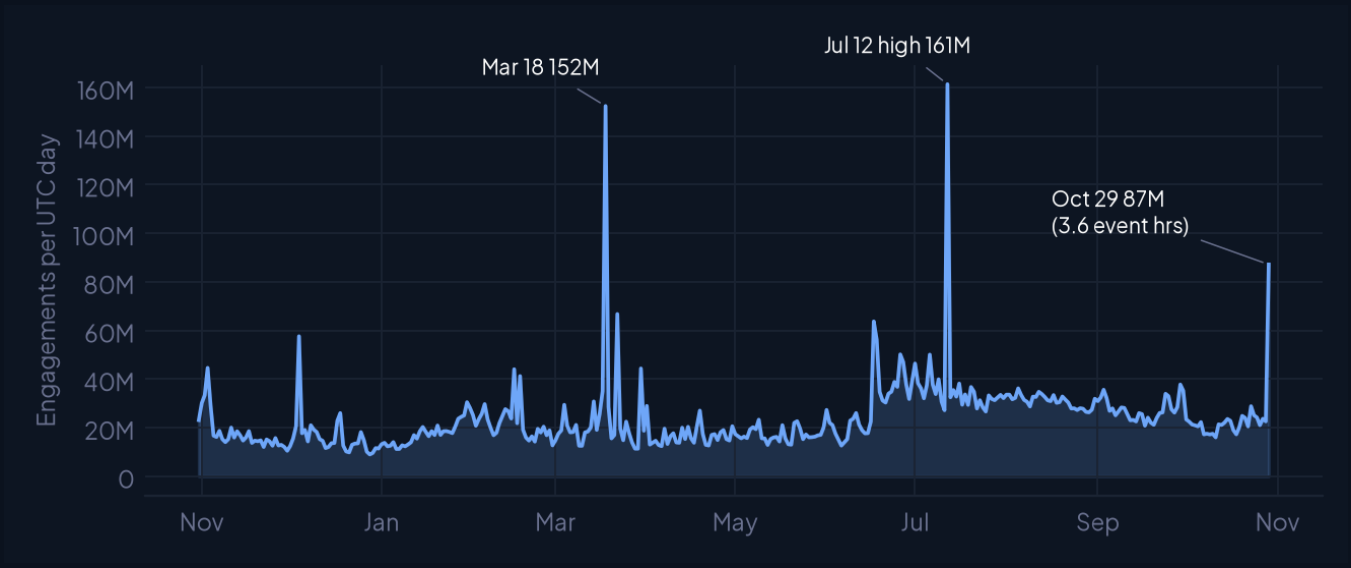

Both events aligned to the first exploit hour, scaled to their own prior-week means.

## PEAK DAY VS BASELINE, FIVE EVENTS




Peak day as a multiple of the prior 14 days (Binance: 1-year median day).

## BINANCE, 365 DAYS




Engagements per UTC day.

## COMPARABLES: PEAK ATTENTION AND SENTIMENT FLOOR

| EVENT | PEAK MULTIPLE | PEAK ENG. | SENTIMENT FLOOR | DAYS ABOVE 2X |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Binance hack, Oct 2026 (hourly, 5 full hours)** | 27.5x at +4h | 27.8M/hour | 53 (hourly) | Too early |
| **Bybit hack, Feb 2025 (hourly, first 8 hours)** | 17.7x at +6h | 8.1M/hour | 44 (hourly) | n/a |
| **Bybit hack, Feb 2025 (daily)** | 8.5x | 135.6M/day | 48 | 5 |
| **FTX collapse, Nov 2022 (daily)** | 124.5x | 78.9M/day | 29 | 10 |
| **Binance, Nov 2022 (daily)** | 4.9x | 11.8M/day | 32 | 8 |
| **Binance plea, Nov 2023 (daily)** | 5.5x | 118.1M/day | 41 | 9 |
| **Binance 1-year high, Jul 12 2026** | n/a | 161.3M/day | n/a | n/a |
| **Binance, Oct 29 2026 UTC (3.6 event hours)** | 4.2x median day | 87.2M/day | 63 (daily) | n/a |

## WHAT THE POSTS SAID

> If confirmed, this would mark the biggest hack in crypto history.
> **@KobeissiLetter · 21:58 UTC · 2.2M**

> Binance just got $2.7 BILLION out in 24 seconds If confirmed this could be the biggest hack of 2026
> **@StarPlatinum_ · 20:58 UTC · 458K**

> BREAKING: World's biggest crypto exchange Binance was just hacked for $5.6 billion. The largest hack in crypto history.
> **@BullTheoryio · 22:15 UTC · 231K**

> So far, total outflows as part of this hack are sitting ~$5.9 billion.
> **@KobeissiLetter · 22:59 UTC · 244K**

## TAKEAWAYS

### Compare volumes, not just multiples

FTX's 124.5x came off 634K engagements a day; Binance's 27.5x comes off 1.0M an hour. The absolute hourly figure, 27.8M against Bybit's 8.1M peak hour, is the cleaner comparison and puts the Binance event well ahead after four hours.

### The sentiment floor has not broken

Every comparable crisis took daily sentiment below Binance's Oct 29 daily score of 63: Bybit to 48, Binance 2023 to 41, Binance 2022 to 32, FTX to 29. Hourly, Binance's low of 53 sits above Bybit's 44. A slide toward 30 would match the trust crises, not the hacks.

## NEXT 24 TO 72 HOURS

1 Whether Oct 30 UTC passes Jul 12's 161.3M; its first full hour was 27.8M.

2 Days above 2x baseline: Bybit lasted 5, FTX 10. Past 5 puts this beyond Bybit's shape.

3 Hourly sentiment against Bybit's hourly floor of 44: a break below ends the event's main difference from every comparable.

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# The claim ledger

## Outflow estimates went from $2.53B to $5.57B in 33 minutes; Binance has confirmed none

Loss figures were on-chain estimates posted within minutes, and the biggest drew the most engagement. The net-exposure estimate and Binance's frozen-funds figures came later and reached a fraction of the audience.

**33 min**
From $2.53B to $5.57B posted

**8.5M**
Engagements on sampled $5.5B+ posts

**1.5M**
Engagements on the ~$1B net estimate and CZ's reply to it

Most of the audience saw the largest loss figure in circulation; Binance has confirmed none. In the sampled posts, 81 cited a loss between $5.5B and $5.9B and drew 8.5M engagements. @0xngmi's roughly $1B net-of-freezes estimate drew 621K, and CZ's 22:23 quote of it 926K, about 1.5M together: more than five to one in favor of the bigger numbers.

The number more than doubled in 33 minutes. At 20:39 UTC @bwenews posted that a Binance hot wallet 'looks to be getting drained for about $2.53B', marked unconfirmed (177K). @DarkWebInformer had $2.77B at 20:54 (176K), @officer_secret about $3.5B 'across multiple chains' at 20:56 (204K), and @WazzCrypto 'at least $5.57B across 3 chains' at 21:12 (226K). Each was an on-chain tally of outflows. Compiled estimates range from about $2.8B on Ethereum alone (CryptoTicker) to $5.8B (Conor Grogan), with @KobeissiLetter's running total reaching about $5.9B at 22:59.

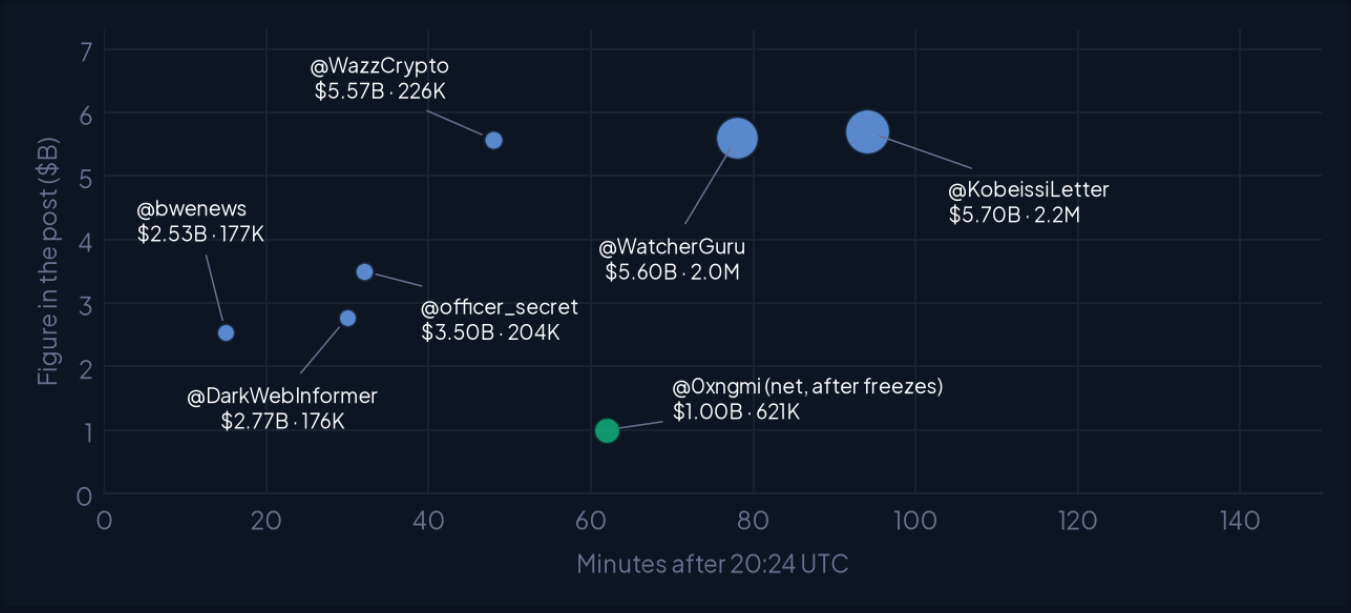
Reach arrived with the large aggregators. @WatcherGuru's 21:42 'Binance hacked with over $5.6 billion stolen' drew 1.98M; @KobeissiLetter's 21:58 post on '~$5.7 billion' of outflows drew 2.22M and was among the few to add 'if confirmed'. Elon Musk's 22:33 'Everyday is Zeroday' (2.1M) quoted the Kobeissi post, putting $5.7B in front of his audience. The figures were repeated in Arabic (@Eyaaaad, 359K; @AZK_SA, 240K) and Japanese (@coinspace_, 219K).

The net estimate, which assumes frozen funds are recovered, reached fewer people. At 21:26 @0xngmi posted (621K) that with USDT and USDC frozen 'the total loss now is around ~1bn', about 0.69 percent of Binance's $144B in custody. CZ quoted it at 22:23: 'Loss might be a bit higher than that, but will cover' (926K). It carried no number, and @KobeissiLetter's 22:59 post (244K) folded it into a running total of '~$5.9 billion'.

Freeze figures drifted the same way. Tether's freeze, first reported by @TreeNewsFeed at ~$971M (21:05), became more than 1.567B USDT per Tether's CEO at 21:25, and posts circulated a combined $1.8B.

Binance's own numbers came last. At 23:22 it said the 'current verified total frozen is $2.54 billion', addressing the $1.8B figure (529K), 100 minutes after @WatcherGuru's $5.6B post. At 00:52 it said 'around $3 billion' (156K). Together those drew 685K, about 16 percent of the 4.2M on the two largest loss-figure posts. Binance has stated frozen amounts and said it will cover losses; it has not published a loss figure.

### THE LOSS FIGURE BY MINUTE




Loss figures as posted, by minute; dot size is engagement. Green: net of freezes.

### THE CLAIM LEDGER: FIGURES BY TIME AND SOURCE

| UTC | FIGURE | SOURCE | ENG. | STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **20:39** | ~$2.53B, 60+ tokens on Ethereum | @bwenews | 177K | On-chain estimate, marked unconfirmed |
| **20:54** | $2.77B | @DarkWebInformer | 176K | Unconfirmed |
| **20:56** | ~$3.5B across chains | @officer_secret | 204K | Unconfirmed |
| **21:12** | At least $5.57B, 3 chains | @WazzCrypto | 226K | Unconfirmed |
| **21:26** | ~$1B net after freezes | @0xngmi | 621K | Net-exposure estimate |
| **21:42** | Over $5.6B stolen | @WatcherGuru | 1.98M | Unconfirmed |
| **21:58** | $5.7B outflows | @KobeissiLetter | 2.22M | Unconfirmed, 'if confirmed' |
| **22:23** | 'A bit higher than that' (quoting ~$1B) | @cz_binance | 926K | No figure stated |
| **23:22** | $2.54B verified frozen | @binance | 529K | Binance statement, frozen not lost |
| **00:52** | ~$3B verified frozen | @binance | 156K | Latest Binance statement |

## WHAT THE POSTS SAID

> BWENEWS: Binance Hot Wallet looks to be getting drained for about $2.53B in 60+ tokens on Ethereum...
> **@bwenews · 20:39 UTC · 177K**

> BREAKING: World's largest crypto exchange Binance hacked with over $5.6 billion stolen...
> **@WatcherGuru · 21:42 UTC · 1.98M**

> ...seeing outflows of –$5.7 billion. The hack includes $1.45 billion worth of Bitcoin and $875 million worth of ETH.
> **@KobeissiLetter · 21:58 UTC · 2.22M**

> with USDT and USDC frozen the total loss now is around ~1bn, which is only 0.69% of their total assets under custody
> **@0xngmi · 21:26 UTC · 621K**

## TAKEAWAYS

### Cite the source and the minute

Every gross loss figure that night was an outflow estimate, from about $2.5B to $5.9B depending on who counted and when. Gross outflow and net loss after freezes are different numbers. Binance's only stated figures are frozen amounts: $2.54B at 23:22 and around $3B at 00:52.

### A lower estimate needs its own number

The net-loss frame peaked with CZ's 22:23 quote, which said only 'a bit higher than that'. Without a figure it was absorbed into larger running totals within 36 minutes. A verified number, posted early, is what competes with the biggest estimate.

## NEXT 24 TO 72 HOURS

1. A loss figure from Binance or its post-mortem: the first confirmed number resets this ledger and tests whether corrections travel.
2. The $5.6B and $5.7B figures still circulating in non-English posts and video after Binance's $3B frozen update.
3. Engagement on Binance's next figure against 1.98M for @WatcherGuru's $5.6B post.

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# The unfinished curve

## New posts fell 46 percent from their peak while hourly engagements rose 60 percent

At the cut, 4.6 hours in, new posts about Binance are falling while engagement keeps rising. Five signals, each with a threshold, will show whether this becomes a fast fade, a trust crisis or a series of waves.

**95.1M**
Engagements, 20:00 to 00:59 UTC

**−46%**
New posts, 21:00 to 00:00 UTC

**+60%**
Hourly engagements, same span

The curve has not turned. From 20:00 to 00:59 UTC (five hourly buckets) the Binance topic drew 95.1M engagements, 29,255 new posts and 22,330 first-time posters. Engagements rose every hour: 17.4M at 21:00, 23.8M at 22:00 (up 37 percent), 24.3M at 23:00 (up 2 percent) and 27.8M at 00:00 (up 14 percent).

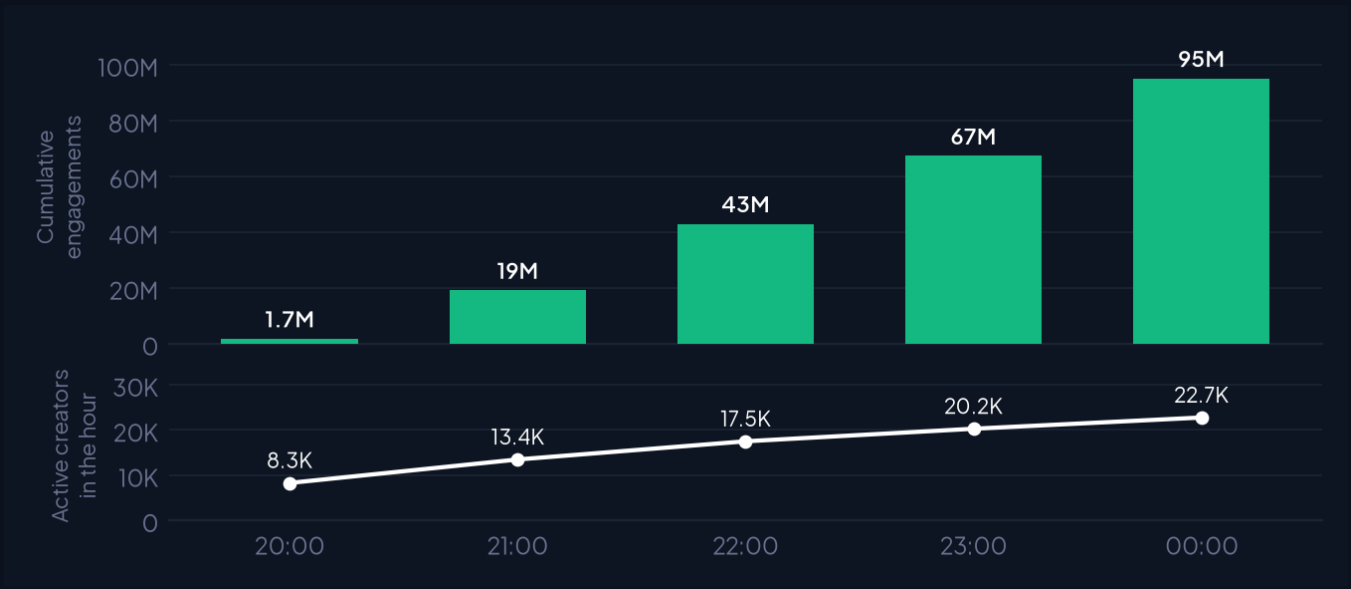
Publishing and attention have split. New posts peaked at 9,044 at 21:00 and fell to 4,893 at 00:00, down 46 percent, while hourly engagements rose 60 percent and accounts with an engaged post grew from 13,449 to 22,735. The audience is still reading posts from the first two hours, such as CZ's 21:15 post (3.2M).

Past events give three scenarios. The Bybit path: after its February 2025 hack, daily engagements peaked the next day at 135.6M (8.5x baseline), fell to 46 percent of peak a day later and 19 percent four days after, stayed above 2x for 5 days, and sentiment recovered from 48 to 83 within a week. The FTX path: in November 2022 daily engagements rose nine straight days, from 1.3M to 78.9M, stayed above 2x for 10 days and took sentiment to 29.

The waves path, Binance's own November 2022 stress: spikes of 9.6M and 11.8M on Nov 8 and Nov 15, 8 days above 2x, a sentiment floor of 32. Deposits and withdrawals were suspended per Binance's 00:13 post (378K), and each reopening, freeze update or post-mortem is a new trigger. The frozen totals of $2.54B (23:22) and around $3B (00:52) each drew their own audience.

The signals: "bank run" posts rose only from 164 to 236 in 24h. "Binance withdrawals" went from 1 to 47. LunarCrush's news network carried 12 Binance posts in 24h, with 46.7K engagements. TikTok and YouTube carried 4.36M of 114.2M 24h engagements (3.8 percent), with median sampled posts at 118 and 139 minutes after onset against 79 on X. Hourly sentiment, 57 at 00:00 against a floor of 53, has not crossed Bybit's hourly floor of 44.

## CUMULATIVE ENGAGEMENTS




Cumulative engagements since 20:00 UTC (bars), active creators per hour (line).

## WATCH LIST: FIVE SIGNALS AND THEIR THRESHOLDS

| SIGNAL | METRIC | CURRENT VALUE | THRESHOLD | WHY IT MATTERS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Withdrawal reopening** | 'binance withdrawals' posts, 24h | 47 (prior 24h: 1) | Above 470 with Binance sentiment under 50 | Reopening complaints would shift the story from loss to access |
| **Bank run language** | 'bank run' posts, 24h | 236 (prior 24h: 164) | Above 328 (double the pre-event day, 164) | The FTX script has not run; this is the first sign it would |
| **Newsroom catch-up** | News-network posts on Binance, 24h | 12 posts, 46.7K engagements | Above 100 posts | Wire and newsroom coverage would bring a second, broader audience |
| **Video share** | TikTok + YouTube share of 24h engagements | 3.8% (4.36M of 114.2M) | Above 7.6% (doubles) | Median video posts ran 39 to 60 minutes behind X and reach non-English audiences |
| **Sentiment floor** | Binance hourly sentiment (0-100) | 57 at 00:00; floor 53 at 21:00 | Below 44 (Bybit's hourly floor) | Comparable trust crises reached 29 to 41 |

## WHAT THE POSTS SAID

> Binance will cover all losses. As a precaution, all deposits and withdrawals are temporarily suspended...
> **@binance · 00:13 UTC · 378K**

> We will share a full post-mortem once the investigation is complete.
> **@heyibinance · 00:04 UTC · 245K**

> Update: The current verified total frozen amount is around $3 billion.
> **@binance · 00:52 UTC · 156K**

> They'll cover it from balance sheet easily
> **@0xngmi · 21:26 UTC · 621K**

## TAKEAWAYS

### Read engagements, not post counts

Post counts peaked at 21:00 and have fallen since. Engagements rose every hour to 27.8M. The turn to watch is the first full hour where engagements fall below the prior hour.

### Every Binance update is a trigger

With deposits and withdrawals suspended and a post-mortem promised, Binance controls the timing of the next waves. Its 23:22 frozen-figure post drew 529K engagements on its own.

## NEXT 24 TO 72 HOURS

**1** "Bank run" posts above 328 in 24h, double the pre-event day of 164, would start the FTX-style trust script.

**2** Sentiment after withdrawals reopen: below 44, Bybit's hourly floor, marks the move into trust-crisis territory.

**3** TikTok and YouTube share of 24h engagement, 3.8 percent: above 7.6 percent means the story has moved onto video.

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# The technical record

## Two mainnet rehearsals, then attacker code ran on Binance 14 for 3 hours 49 minutes

LunarCrush checked every transaction cited in posts against Ethereum mainnet through public nodes and Blockscout. The chain shows an eighteen-hour build-up, one valid authorization out of fifty, and a delegation that kept sweeping for nearly four hours.

**02:28 UTC**
Sweeper v1 deployed, 18 hours before the drain

**2**
Rehearsals on the attacker's own wallets (13:51, 16:20)

**3h 49m**
Binance 14 under attacker code until 00:10 UTC

The operator address, `0x7C86…5CA0`, has a history that fits on one screen. Three withdrawals from the Tornado Cash 0.1 ETH pool funded it: Oct 28 at 07:39 and 08:53 UTC, and Oct 29 at 08:23. Two sibling wallets were funded the same way in the same 31 hours: `0xFD41` (0.1 ETH at 01:15 Oct 29) and `0xe4F9` (0.1 ETH at 07:08, then 0.994 ETH from the 1 ETH pool at 14:54). About 1.49 ETH from the mixer funded the whole operation.

@spreekaway's first post at 20:32 said the contract call 'was funded by Tornado Cash'. That was correct, and it was the detail that led on-chain readers to treat the move as hostile rather than housekeeping.

The preparation was public for eighteen hours. At 02:28:59 UTC on Oct 29 the operator deployed a first sweeper contract (`0x19be…f2bf`, never verified). At 13:51 it sent two type-4 (EIP-7702) transactions delegating two fresh wallets it controlled, `0x8378` and `0x9C29`, to that contract. From 13:57, `0xFD41` funded them with 0.001 and 0.002 ETH and seeded them with a few dollars of USDT and USDC. At 14:19:59 and 14:24:11 the operator swept both; the internal calls touched DAI, USDC and USDT.

Posts reconstructed the rehearsal 67 minutes after the sweep: @MetaFinancialAI had the timeline by 21:31, @danupsher summarized it at 21:47 ('rehearsed this afternoon on 2.54 USDT'), and @Aytunc described the test addresses at 22:06.

At 15:59:11 the operator deployed the contract it would use, `0x63e8…6fAe`. Its code lets only `0x7C86` call sweep, withdraw or an execute passthrough, and its sweep leaves exactly 1 ETH behind.

From 16:20 it ran the full sequence on a third test wallet, `0x43AE`: delegate (16:20:47 and 16:25:59), fund with 1.01 ETH from `0xe4F9` (16:24), sweep (16:30:11, 0.01 ETH out), withdraw (16:47:23, 1.0 ETH back to `0xe4F9`). At 18:20:47, `0xe4F9` sent the operator 1.082 ETH, funding for the real run. @0xQuit's 21:09 reconstruction (492K engagements) had the deploy time and four-step sequence right; @blockaid_ posted the contract address and hardcoded operator at 21:25.

The delegation is transaction `0xad99…298b` at 20:20:59 UTC: a type-4 transaction from the operator to Binance 14 (`0x28C6…1d60`) carrying 50 authorizations. Decoded from a public node, all 50 point to the same delegate on chain 1, their nonces run in sequence, and every signature recovers to Binance 14's key.

An EIP-7702 authorization applies only if its nonce equals the signer's current nonce. Binance 14 was sending several transactions a block, and its live nonce when the tuples were processed was 18914809. That tuple applied and the other 49 were skipped. Binance 14's next own transaction, at 20:21:11, carried 18914810. Exactly one authorization took effect.

An authorization signs a different message from a transaction, so these fifty could not have been harvested from the wallet's withdrawal traffic; they were produced as authorizations. @0xQuit reached a related conclusion at 21:21 ('likely the attacker collected all 50 over some period of time'), as did @blockaid_ at 21:50 ('the hot wallet was still firing. One nonce in that window landed'). A stolen key, a compromised signing service and a deceived signing step all fit the record.

Seventeen blocks later, at 20:24:23, the operator called sweep on Binance 14. The receipt holds 63 Transfer events from 63 token contracts plus the ETH move, matching the '167,464 ETH + 63 tokens' @odysseas_eth posted at 20:54. Everything went to `0x5227…2f8c`, which Etherscan later labeled 'Binance Hot Wallet Exploiter 2'. The ten largest lines the explorer shows for this first sweep: 1.615B USDT, 62.6M RLUSD, 29,934 wBETH, 11,372 XAUt, 6.19M UNI, 27.8M USD1, 198M ENA, 7.18T PEPE, 2.26M LINK and 128K AAVE.

The sweep cost 0.000414 ETH (2,455,349 gas at 0.17 gwei), about $0.93. At 20:41:23 the operator used the execute passthrough to send a call from Binance 14 to `0xEe7a…4055`, an ERC-1967 proxy that posts called 'Hot Wallet 34'. It already trusted Binance 14 as a permitted caller and released 780M USDC to `0x5227`; @kethcode had the owner relationship by 22:08. At 20:59:47 another 43M USDC came the same way.

The code stayed on Binance 14 for 3 hours 49 minutes, until 00:10:35 on Oct 30, when the account signed its own authorization pointing at the zero address. That clears the code; it does not rotate the key or revoke token allowances, and it holds until another valid authorization is included on-chain; clearing the code does not invalidate authorizations already signed. Throughout the window Binance 14 kept sending its own transactions (its own transactions ran from nonce 18914810 to 18914903): the key holder kept control, and the account also ran the attacker's code.

The attacker swept again at 21:04 (3.9M USDT plus dust), at 21:44 (200.4M USDT, 6,591 LINK, 7,008 UNI and others) and at 22:39 (POL, GRT, SKY, SENT, ENSO, XUSD, STRK, FF, CAKE and SYN, at least $7.5M on the ten largest lines the explorer lists) to a second receiver, `0xA97b`. Six more sweeps between 23:36 and 23:56 returned nothing.

Value kept arriving. Blockscout records 533 incoming token transfers to Binance 14 between 20:24 and 00:10, including 205.7M USDT, 180B PEPE and 859M SHIB. The 1 ETH floor in the sweep logic paid gas for the wallet's own outgoing transactions, so Binance 14 kept transacting and looked normal. @uttam_singhk described it at 22:00: 'The wallet stayed operational and kept receiving deposits the attacker could take again.'

After the revocation, Binance 14's own outgoing transfers of USDT, SingularityNET, PlayDapp and WLFI between 00:47 and 01:53 failed with status 'error' and no revert reason.

## THE OPERATOR'S DAY, FROM THE CHAIN (0x7C86, ETHEREUM MAINNET, UTC)

| TIME | NONCE | WHAT THE CHAIN SHOWS | FIRST PUBLIC MENTION |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Oct 28 07:39, 08:53** | funding | Two 0.1 ETH withdrawals from Tornado Cash to the operator; a third at 08:23 Oct 29. Sibling wallets `0xFD41` and `0xe4F9` funded the same way (01:15, 07:08, 14:54 Oct 29) | @spreekaway 20:32, 8 min after the sweep |
| **Oct 29 02:28:59** | 0 | Deploys sweeper v1 (`0x19be…f2bf`) | @MetaFinancialAI 21:31 |
| **13:51:35, 13:51:59** | 1, 2 | Type-4 delegations of two own test wallets to sweeper v1 | @MetaFinancialAI 21:31; @Aytunc 22:06 ('tested the setup on other addresses') |
| **13:57 to 14:06** | (`0xFD41`) | Test wallets funded with 0.001 and 0.002 ETH, then seeded with a few dollars of USDT and USDC | @danupsher 21:47 ('rehearsed on 2.54 USDT') |
| **14:19:59, 14:24:11** | 3, 4 | sweep() called on both test wallets; internal calls to DAI, USDC, USDT | @MetaFinancialAI 21:31 |
| **15:59:11** | 5 | Deploys sweeper v2 (`0x63e8…6fAe`), hardcoded operator, leaves 1 ETH | @0xQuit 21:09; @blockaid_ 21:25 |
| **16:20 to 16:47** | 6 to 9 | Third test wallet delegated, funded 1.01 ETH, swept (0.01 ETH out), then withdraw() returns 1.0 ETH | @MetaFinancialAI 21:31 |
| **18:20:47** | (`0xe4F9`) | Operator receives 1.082 ETH, funding for the real run | not cited in any post |
| **20:20:59** | 10 | Type-4 tx to Binance 14 with 50 authorizations signed by Binance 14, nonces 18914775 to 18914824; one lands (block 26300753) | @odysseas_eth 20:54; @0xQuit 21:21; @blockaid_ 21:50 |
| **20:24:23** | 11 | sweep(): 63 tokens + 167,464 ETH to `0x5227` (block 26300770), gas $0.93 | @spreekaway 20:32; @TreeNewsFeed 20:39 |
| **20:41:23, 20:59:47** | 12, 13 | callExecute as owner of Hot Wallet 34: 780M then 43M USDC to `0x5227` | @0xfoobar 20:48 ('another $780M USDC clip'); @kethcode 22:08 |
| **21:04, 21:44, 22:39** | 14 to 16 | Re-sweeps: 3.9M USDT; 200.4M USDT and alts; a long-tail basket to a second receiver | @uttam_singhk 22:00 on the mechanism; no sampled post on the 22:39 sweep |
| **23:36 to 23:56** | 17 to 22 | Six empty sweeps | none |
| **Oct 30 00:10:35** | (Binance 14) | Binance 14 signs a type-4 revocation to the zero address (nonce 18914904) | ChainCatcher report, 00:44 UTC Oct 30 |

## WHAT THE POSTS SAID

> "The attacker didn't know Binance 14's live nonce. So they sprayed 50 EIP-7702 auths (18914775-18914824) in one type-4 tx. Only 1 of 50 was a hit.
> **@blockaid_ · 21:50 UTC · 159K**

> "...was rehearsed this afternoon on 2.54 USDT. Same operator EOA. Same sweep() selector. Same drainer kit.
> **@danupsher · 21:47 UTC · 3.9K**

> "The attacker left Binance wallet exactly 1.00 ETH after every sweep... The wallet stayed operational and kept receiving deposits the attacker could take again
> **@uttam_singhk · 22:00 UTC · 36K**

> "Binance 14 was the owner of Hot Wallet 34. once the sweeper could run as Binance 14, it could use that existing permission to pull another $823m USDC out of wallet 34.
> **@kethcode · 22:08 UTC · 12K**

TAKEAWAYS

### The posts were right, and early

Every on-chain claim checked in the sampled posts held up, and fast: the sweep was public in 8 minutes, the 780M USDC pull in 7, the delegation in 33 and the fifty authorizations in 60. Only the totals varied.

NEXT 24 TO 72 HOURS

1 Binance's post-mortem on how fifty authorizations came to be signed by Binance 14's key.

2 The receivers `0x5227` and `0xA97b`: at 03:20 UTC `0x5227` held 16,501 ETH and was still swapping long-tail tokens into ETH.

3 Binance 14's failed transfers after 00:47 UTC (USDT, SingularityNET, PlayDapp, WLFI): whether they become user-facing withdrawal delays.

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# Sources and definitions

| | |
|---|---|
| **Sources** | Social data: LunarCrush (X, TikTok, YouTube, Instagram, Reddit and about 10,000 news sites), pulled 01:00 to 01:30 UTC Oct 30. On-chain: Ethereum via public JSON-RPC and the Blockscout API; Act V (chapter 07) balances and transfers read live on Ethereum, Bitcoin, Tron, XRP Ledger, Solana and Arbitrum, 03:20 to 03:27 UTC Oct 30. Attribution of the Bitcoin, Tron, XRP and Solana senders to Binance: Whale Alert labels. Prices: CoinGecko. |
| **Engagements** | Likes, reposts, replies, comments and views-weighted interactions, summed across networks. |
| **Baseline** | The Binance topic's mean hour over the 162 full hours from 02:00 UTC Oct 23 to 19:00 UTC Oct 29: 1.0M engagements, 418 new posts, 293 first-time posters, sentiment 80. Multiples divide an hour by the topic's own mean hour over the same 162 hours; comparable events use the prior 14 days (Binance on Oct 29: its one-year median day). |
| **First-time posters** | Accounts posting on the topic for the first time in LunarCrush's lookback. |
| **Sentiment** | Of engagement on posts scored positive or negative, the share that was positive, 0 to 100. |
| **Sampled posts** | 686 top posts published between 20:14 UTC Oct 29 and 01:00 UTC Oct 30 that mention the event. Used for who-said-what, themes, account classes and timing. |
| **Comparables** | Bybit (Feb 21, 2025) hour for hour and daily; FTX (Nov 2022), Binance during FTX (Nov 2022) and the CZ plea (Nov 21, 2023) as daily series. |

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# Tables

## A1 · ATTENTION SPILLOVER, 20:00 TO 00:00 UTC

| TOPIC | MEAN/H | PEAK/H | PEAK X | PEAK HOUR | POSTS X | NEW X | SENT. MEAN | SENT. EVENT |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Tether (USDT) | 33.4K | 2.7M | 79.8x | 22:00 | 15.8x | 27.3x | 83 | 65 |
| Binance | 1.0M | 27.8M | 27.5x | 00:00 | 14.0x | 15.2x | 80 | 59 |
| USDC | 363K | 5.1M | 14.0x | 00:00 | 3.7x | 4.6x | 85 | 77 |
| Ethereum | 1.3M | 9.7M | 7.5x | 00:00 | 2.6x | 3.1x | 75 | 71 |
| Hyperliquid | 331K | 2.4M | 7.4x | 00:00 | 2.5x | 2.6x | 79 | 84 |
| $MSTR (Strategy) | 68.2K | 495K | 7.3x | 21:00 | 2.6x | 3.0x | 77 | 79 |
| BNB | 676K | 3.7M | 5.5x | 22:00 | 1.4x | 1.7x | 79 | 79 |
| Kraken | 110K | 577K | 5.2x | 21:00 | 0.9x | 1.0x | 81 | 91 |
| Bybit | 322K | 1.5M | 4.7x | 23:00 | 8.4x | 9.2x | 75 | 54 |
| Crypto (all) | 5.4M | 16.8M | 3.1x | 00:00 | 1.4x | 2.2x | 74 | 72 |
| Coinbase | 418K | 1.2M | 2.9x | 00:00 | 2.9x | 3.1x | 78 | 76 |
| Bitcoin | 5.1M | 14.4M | 2.8x | 00:00 | 1.8x | 2.2x | 69 | 68 |
| XRP | 443K | 1.2M | 2.6x | 21:00 | 1.7x | 2.2x | 79 | 75 |
| OKX | 311K | 582K | 1.9x | 00:00 | 1.2x | 1.3x | 77 | 80 |
| Solana | 922K | 1.6M | 1.8x | 21:00 | 0.8x | 1.1x | 81 | 80 |
| $HOOD (Robinhood) | 600K | 713K | 1.2x | 20:00 | 0.5x | 0.6x | 84 | 85 |
| Gold | 17.4M | 19.2M | 1.1x | 20:00 | 0.7x | 0.8x | 89 | 88 |

## A2 · KEYWORDS, ROLLING 24H VS PRIOR 24H

| PHRASE | POSTS, PRIOR 24H | POSTS, LAST 24H | CREATORS, PRIOR | CREATORS, LAST 24H |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| cz | 9,846 | 14,460 | 6,375 | 9,552 |
| withdraw | 5,267 | 6,770 | 4,552 | 5,798 |
| binance hack | 1 | 4,152 | 1 | 3,319 |
| SAFU | 722 | 2,438 | 544 | 1,967 |
| binance hacked | 0 | 1,935 | 0 | 1,804 |
| hot wallet | 227 | 1,680 | 177 | 1,354 |
| not your keys | 286 | 946 | 268 | 851 |
| crypto hack | 49 | 723 | 46 | 664 |
| largest hack | 1 | 403 | 1 | 362 |
| bank run | 164 | 236 | 155 | 215 |
| bybit hack | 19 | 163 | 18 | 148 |
| tether freeze | 3 | 54 | 3 | 52 |
| binance withdrawals | 1 | 47 | 1 | 45 |
| EIP7702 | 1 | 27 | 1 | 23 |
| binance down | 1 | 13 | 1 | 11 |

## A3 · TOP 40 SAMPLED POSTS BY ENGAGEMENT

| ACCOUNT | UTC | FOLLOWERS | ENG. | TEXT, AS POSTED (TRANSLATIONS MARKED) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| @cz_binance | 21:15 | 13.0M | 3.2M | User funds are safe! It does look like a hack on Binance. Appreciate the quick freeze from Tether (~$971m) and Circle… |
| @KobeissiLetter | 21:58 | 2.7M | 2.2M | BREAKING: Binance has been hacked with wallets across the Ethereum, Bitcoin, and TRON networks seeing outflows of… |
| @elonmusk | 22:33 | 242M | 2.1M | Everyday is Zeroday |
| @TreeNewsFeed | 21:05 | 198K | 2.0M | TETHER FREEZES $971M USDT IN LIKELY BINANCE HACK, WITH NO UPDATE FROM BINANCE STILL |
| @WatcherGuru | 21:42 | 4.9M | 2.0M | BREAKING: World's largest crypto exchange Binance hacked with over $5.6 billion stolen: • $1.45 billion $BTC • $875… |
| @spreekaway | 20:32 | 39.5K | 1.6M | Unconfirmed, but possibly massive binance hack. Entire Binance wallet drained into new EOA. Contract call was funded… |
| @paoloardoino | 21:25 | 362K | 1.0M | Tether froze more than 1.567B USDT related to a potential Binance exchange hack. Protecting the industry and our… |
| @cz_binance | 22:23 | 13.0M | 926K | Loss might be a bit higher than that, but will cover. |
| @binance | 21:29 | 16.1M | 904K | Our teams are aware of reports of a potential security issue and are actively investigating. User funds are… |
| @elonmusk | 23:04 | 242M | 886K | Exactly |
| @nikitabier | 22:00 | 1.4M | 732K | The largest crypto exchange in the world just experienced the largest robbery in human history, and the person running… |
| @cz_binance | 21:31 | 13.0M | 671K | life saver |
| @ASVPXILLZ | 20:42 | 54.1K | 664K | My Binance account appears to have been compromised just now, with approximately $3M USD in funds withdrawn without… |
| @0xngmi | 21:26 | 197K | 621K | Binance has 144bn of assets under custody, with USDT and USDC frozen the total loss now is around ~1bn, which is only… |
| @WatcherGuru | 21:08 | 4.9M | 605K | JUST IN: Tether freezes $971 million $USDT linked to suspected Binance hack. No official statement from Binance yet. |
| @KobeissiLetter | 21:14 | 2.7M | 584K | BREAKING: Tether has frozen $971 million worth of USDT which has been linked to a suspected Binance hack. This comes… |
| @spectatorindex | 21:46 | 3.6M | 577K | BREAKING: Reports that billions of dollars worth of crypto have been hacked from the world's largest exchange Binance |
| @TreeNewsFeed | 20:39 | 198K | 570K | POTENTIAL BINANCE HACK ONGOING - ONCHAIN |
| @ramonos | 21:04 | 178K | 540K | lets say you're the binance hacker you have $2B but your wallet is also blacklisted from every exchange the little… |
| @0xQuit | 21:09 | 113K | 492K | ok safe to say binance is pwned The biggest assets were approximately: • 1.615B USDT • 62.6M RLUSD • 29,934 wBETH •… |
| @StarPlatinum_ | 20:58 | 111K | 458K | Binance just got $2.7 BILLION out in 24 seconds If confirmed this could be the biggest hack of 2026 I've been looking… |
| @digitalbuzzfab | 21:31 | 20.7K | 454K | TAKE YOUR MONEY OUT OF BINANCE [translated from Spanish] |
| @BalaiBB | 22:09 | 19.2K | 451K | the binance hacker just did something genius and it should scare you tether froze $1.5 billion in stolen USDT. circle… |
| @crypto_banter | 20:43 | 442K | 433K | BREAKING: BINANCE HOT WALLET APPEARS TO BE DRAINED FOR ~$2.53B! On-chain data shows a large outflow from a Binance… |
| @cz_binance | 21:36 | 13.0M | 426K | Thank you! |
| @TreeNewsFeed | 20:41 | 198K | 406K | TreeAI flagged a possible theft from Binance Hot Wallets, withdrawing billions in over 60 tokens to an address funded… |
| @WatcherGuru | 22:46 | 4.9M | 401K | JUST IN: Elon Musk says "everyday is zeroday" following Binance hack. |
| @WatcherGuru | 21:20 | 4.9M | 390K | JUST IN: Binance Founder CZ says it "looks like" Binance has been hacked. |

| ACCOUNT | UTC | FOLLOWERS | ENG. | TEXT, AS POSTED (TRANSLATIONS MARKED) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| @binance | 00:13 | 16.1M | 378K | We are working non-stop to resolve this issue. Binance will cover all losses. As a precaution, all deposits and… |
| @Eyaaaad | 22:11 | 4.5M | 359K | Now... the announcement of the largest crypto theft in history. The victim? A hack of Binance, the largest exchange… |
| @binance | 22:33 | 16.1M | 351K | Our team is conducting security checks. Withdrawals will resume as soon as the security issue is fully resolved. User… |
| @heyibinance | 21:17 | 653K | 329K | We are aware of reports of a potential security issue and we are actively investigating. Our security teams are… |
| @coinbase | 22:43 | 7.2M | 329K | Coinbase is safe and secure. We're actively monitoring the Binance situation, and have reached out to their team to… |
| @WatcherGuru | 21:13 | 4.9M | 326K | JUST IN: Circle freezes $823 million $USDC linked to suspected Binance hack. |
| @WatcherGuru | 21:27 | 4.9M | 323K | JUST IN: Binance issues statement following suspected crypto hack. "Our teams are aware of reports of a potential… |
| @cz_binance | 23:09 | 13.0M | 321K | (emoji reply) |
| @_bolivian | 21:11 | 61.4K | 315K | LIST OF EXCHANGES HACKED TODAY - BINANCE - 3.5 BILLION - BYBIT - 1 BILLION - BITGET - 1 BILLION - SWYFTX - 10 MILLION |
| @AmirOrmu | 21:01 | 15.5K | 304K | Binance is 100% hacked the hacker has started selling the withdrawn USDT and USDC for ETH! if it was Binance… |
| @KobeissiLetter | 21:22 | 2.7M | 284K | BREAKING: Binance founder Changpeng Zhao (CZ) says it appears as though Binance has been hacked. CZ also says he… |
| @AshCrypto | 21:08 | 2.2M | 282K | BREAKING POSSIBLE BINANCE HACK HAPPENING RIGHT NOW. $3,500,000,000 has reportedly flowed out of Binance wallets.… |

ABOUT LUNARCRUSH

# LunarCrush measures what the internet is paying attention to

LunarCrush is a social intelligence platform for crypto and equities. It ingests tens of millions of posts an hour from X, TikTok, YouTube, Instagram, Reddit and news, scores engagement and sentiment, and rolls them up by asset, topic, creator and keyword into hourly time series and rankings. The same data behind this report powers the LunarCrush app, API, MCP connector and CLI, and is used by funds, exchanges and creators to measure attention across networks in real time.